PMP Exam 1

Question 1

Two team members continue to have arguments and opposing views on an issue. As a project manager, you are becoming concerned that their disagreement could affect their other tasks. You understand the issue but have not intervened hoping they can resolve the issue between themselves.

Which of the following is the most appropriate action to take?

A Meet with the two project members in an attempt to facilitate a solution

B As project manager make an immediate and final decision

C Escalate the issue to the sponsor

D Get stakeholder input

Answer: A

Hint:

Which approach is best to be used when there is a conflict that is not critical or immediate action is necessary?

Explanation:

The question should be read carefully to assess the situation being presented. Although the question states the two team members need to resolve the situation, the situation is not presented as critical, nor has the project manager attempted to facilitate a solution. When conflict arises, which becomes a negative factor or issue, the project team members are initially responsible for resolving the issue. If the team members fail to resolve their differences, it is the responsibility of the project manager to become involved and attempt to facilitate a solution. Using a force/direct approach, which involves pushing one's viewpoint at the expense of others results in a win-lose situation and may have a negative impact on the team if facilitation and compromise are not attempted first.

Details for Each Option:

A Meet with the two project members in an attempt to facilitate a solution

Correct. The question doesn't indicate the situation is critical or that the project manager has already attempted to facilitate a solution. When conflict arises, and the team members haven't been able to make progress themselves, it is the responsibility of the project manager to become involved and attempt to facilitate a solution.

B As project manager make an immediate and final decision

Incorrect. The question doesn't indicate the situation is critical or that the project manager has attempted to facilitate a solution so at this point it would be premature for the project manager to force a decision or make the decision independent of a discussion between the two project members. Facilitating a discussion in the hope of coming to a solution that results in a compromise should be attempted first.

C Escalate the issue to the sponsor

Incorrect. This is not a situation that requires the sponsor's input. It is an internal conflict within the team and is something that the project manager can address with the two team members. Also, the technical nature of the issue is not likely the domain of the sponsor.

D Get stakeholder input

Incorrect. As a project manager, you are expected to assess the situation and determine the best resolution. It is not responsible or appropriate to involve the stakeholders in such an issue or to be asked to intervene in the day-to-day decisions made on the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 348-349

PMP Exam 1

Question 2

You have been assigned to manage a project that is in execution. The previous project manager was transferred to another division within the company. As you review the documentation on the project, you realize that a project charter was never established.

What is your best course of action?

A Establish a project charter at the point where you entered the project

B Continue the project without a project charter

C Terminate the project because a project cannot exist without a project charter

D Wait and see if a project charter is necessary

Answer: A

Hint:

A project charter is an important part of a project.

Explanation:

The primary purpose of the charter is to formally authorize the project and, most importantly, provide the project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources to project activities. In this situation, the project has already begun without a charter. However, the scenario does not provide details about how well the project is progressing. Projects without charters can suffer for multiple reasons. A project charter defines what the project should deliver and sets out management's expectations for results. Therefore, without a charter, there are no clear expectations for project outcomes allowing the potential for the project to drift without any

real results. Also, the project can face roadblocks due to the unavailability of resources and the project manager not having the written authority to acquire resources. Since the scenario does not give any details on the project other than it does not have a charter, and the project charter has significant benefits, the best answer to the question asked is to develop a charter at the point where you entered the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Establish a project charter at the point where you entered the project

Correct. Although the project is in execution, establishing a project charter is still beneficial. The project charter legitimizes the project and your authority. The charter also ensures there is a common understanding by the stakeholders of what the project will deliver as well as the roles and responsibilities of everyone involved in the project.

B Continue the project without a project charter

Incorrect. Even though your project is in execution, establishing a project charter will be beneficial. Executives use the project charter to verify that the project is in line with corporate strategic goals. Project team members use the project charter to understand if the project is meeting the organization's business need.

C Terminate the project because a project cannot exist without a project charter

Incorrect. While it is important to have the project charter that authorizes the project and the project manager, terminating the project that is already in execution just because the project charter does not exist is an over-reaction.

D Wait and see if a project charter is necessary

Incorrect. Taking a 'wait and see' approach is essentially the same as continuing the project without a charter. There are benefits to having a project charter and if you 'wait and see,' chances are you will not have a charter when you need it.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 81

PMP Exam 1

Question 3

Which of the following would not be an effective strategy and the least likely choice for a project manager to promote the sharing of tacit knowledge on a project?

A Hosting workshops, seminars, and information sessions

B Providing work shadowing and reverse shadowing opportunities

C Promote attending knowledge-sharing events such as conferences and other networking events

D Create a lessons learned register for every project

Answer: D

Hint:

One of the answer choices is much less effective than others in capturing tacit knowledge.

Explanation:

The project manager is looking for a way to share her and others' experience, insights, opinions, and "know-how" or her tacit knowledge within the organization. Tacit knowledge is personal,

requires context, and is difficult to express. This differs from explicit knowledge that can be easily recorded using words, pictures, and numbers. This question asks, which is the least effective choice for capturing tacit knowledge. Using information management systems such as a lessons learned register may be a good way to capture explicit, codified knowledge gained after each project, but is the least effective method to capture and share tacit knowledge.

Details for Each Option:

A Hosting workshops, seminars, and information sessions

Incorrect. This answer choice is listed as one of many techniques that are used by projects to promote and share tacit knowledge within an organization or project team.

B Providing work shadowing and reverse shadowing opportunities

Incorrect. Providing work shadowing and reverse shadowing opportunities are listed as effective methods of tacit knowledge capture and transfer within a project. Since the correct answer will be the choice that is least likely to promote and improve tacit knowledge sharing, this is an incorrect choice.

C Promote attending knowledge-sharing events such as conferences and other networking events

Incorrect. Attending knowledge-sharing events such as conferences and networking events are listed in the PMBOK guide as examples of how to promote tacit knowledge sharing. Networking, including informal social interaction and online social networking, can be useful for starting knowledge-sharing conversations with specialists.

D Create a lessons learned register for every project

Correct. Of the answer choices, this is the least effective tool for capturing and sharing tacit knowledge. A lessons learned register is a great tool for capturing explicit, codified knowledge gained after each project, but that is not the primary objective in this situation.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 102-103, 100

PMP Exam 1

Question 4

You recently submitted a change request to the change control board (CCB) for an updated communications management plan to include more frequent and detailed project status updates with the intent of addressing declining stakeholder engagement.

Where is the best place to find the decision status of the change request?

A Change log

B Project charter

C Stakeholder register

D Lessons learned register

Answer: A

Hint:

What project document is updated with the status of change requests?

Explanation:

The project manager is conducting the project management process of Manage Stakeholder Engagement. As a result of this process, an issue has been identified which is negatively impacting stakeholder engagement, and a change request has been submitted to the change control board (CCB) to update the communications management plan. One of the outputs of the Manage Stakeholder Engagement process is document updates which include the change log among others. The change log is updated with the decision status of change requests, therefore, viewing the change log will allow you to determine if the request was approved.

Details for Each Option:

A Change log

Correct. The change log is the project document that is updated with the status of change requests. This is the best place to find the decision status of a change request.

B Project charter

Incorrect. The project charter is a document issued by the sponsor which formally authorizes the existence of a project. This document does not contain information on the status of change requests.

C Stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is a document that includes the identification, assessment, and classification of project stakeholders. This document does not contain information on the status of change requests.

D Lessons learned register

Incorrect. The lessons learned register is a document used to record lessons that have been learned during a project. This document does not contain information on the status of change requests.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 529

PMP Exam 1

Question 5

A_construction site is located in an earthquake-prone area. After spending considerable time discussing and analyzing this risk, the team agreed that the best way to deal with this risk was to build an earthquake-resistant foundation using a high-grade concrete. However, several weeks into construction, the project manager learns that this special type of concrete was never ordered, even though the risk response was documented in the risk register. The project will now have to be suspended.

What most likely went wrong?

A The project team failed to have a fallback plan.

B The risk was never documented in the risk register.

C No action has been taken to implement the risk response.

D The risk response was not approved by the change control board.

Answer: C

Hint:

It is not enough to only identify risk and plan its response.

Explanation:

The question states that the project team spent considerable time discussing and analyzing this risk event and had an agreed-upon risk response, and yet, the risk response was never implemented. This suggests that the project team rushed or overlooked the Implement Risk Responses process. This is a common problem in risk management, where project teams spend too much effort in identifying, analyzing, and documenting risks and risk responses, but then no action is taken to manage the risk. Giving proper attention to the Implement Risk Responses process is just as important as risk planning for addressing overall project risk exposure, minimizing individual project threats, and maximizing individual project opportunities.

Details for Each Option:

A The project team failed to have a fallback plan.

Incorrect. Having a fallback plan, or an alternative risk response, does not address the question of what caused this mistake to happen. The mistake was in failing to manage the risk proactively by implementing the planned risk response.

B The risk was never documented in the risk register.

Incorrect. The question states that the risk response has been documented in the risk register. Therefore, it is reasonable to assume that the risk itself was documented as well.

C No action has been taken to implement the risk response.

Correct. A common problem in risk management is that project teams may spend a lot of time and effort in identifying, analyzing, and documenting risks and risk responses, but then no action is taken to manage the risk. Since risk planning can be a time-consuming process, it is easy to overlook or rush the process of implementing risk responses, which is the most likely explanation for this scenario.

D The risk response was not approved by the change control board.

Incorrect. The change control board (CCB) is a formally chartered group responsible for reviewing, evaluating, approving, deferring, or rejecting changes to the project and for recording and communicating such decision. The CCB has nothing to do with the risks and/or their responses.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 449-450

PMP Exam 1

Question 6

For an upcoming project, a needs assessment and business case have been completed, and the project management office (PMO) is reviewing a draft of the benefits management plan. The PMO highlights an element of the benefits management plan and requests that the element be removed before the document is finalized.

Which of the following was most likely the element the PMO requested to remove?

A Expected tangible and intangible value to be gained by the implementation of the project

B A set of options to be considered for addressing the business opportunity

C A timeframe for realizing the benefits of the project

D Measures to be used to show benefits realized

Answer: B

Hint:

One of the options should have been included in the business case and not the benefits management plan.

Explanation:

The key elements of a benefits management plan include target benefits, strategic alignment, a timeframe for realizing benefits, benefits owner, metrics, assumptions, and risks. Identification of a set of options to be considered for addressing the business problem or opportunity is a key element of the project business case and should not be included in the benefits management plan. This element is most likely what was marked for removal by the PMO.

Details for Each Option:

A Expected tangible and intangible value to be gained by the implementation of the project

Incorrect. The expected tangible and intangible value to be gained by the implementation of the project is an example of the target benefits. The target benefits are a key element of the benefits management plan. Therefore, this is not the element that was marked for removal.

B A set of options to be considered for addressing the business opportunity

Correct. Identification of a set of options to be considered for addressing the business problem or opportunity is a key element of the project business case and should not be included in the benefits management plan. This element is most likely what was identified by the PMO.

C A timeframe for realizing the benefits of the project

Incorrect. A timeframe for realizing the benefits of the project is one of the key elements of the benefits management plan. Therefore, this answer choice can be eliminated.

D Measures to be used to show benefits realized

Incorrect. Metrics, the measures to be used to show the benefits realized, is a key element of the benefits management plan, making this answer choice incorrect.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 33

PMP Exam 1

Question 7

You are leading a project to write content in three different languages. The project team is colocated for greater effectiveness. Unfortunately, the only project team member who can translate the documents into French has a leg injury and is unable to commute to the office for the next three weeks.

What is the best course of action if you want to keep the project on track?

A Delay the French release until the team member is back to the office

B Hire an external firm to translate the content into French

C Run the Acquire Resources process to replace the team member

D Organize the project team members as a virtual team

Answer: D

Hint:

What is the best way to keep the project on schedule and budget in this situation?

Explanation:

One of the tools that a project manager can employ during the Acquire Resources process is the use of a virtual team. Allowing the team member to work remotely temporarily is the best solution of the available answer choices as it would have the least impact on project performance. There is not enough information in the question to determine if the colocation is mandatory per company policy. Therefore, organizing the project members as a virtual team to keep the project on track should have priority over a preference for colocation for greater effectiveness. Note, when only one team member works remotely, calling the entire team virtual can be a stretch. However, of the choices provided, organizing the project team members as a virtual team is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Delay the French release until the team member is back to the office

Incorrect. The French translation is reasonably assumed to be part of the project scope, and the question states you want to keep the project on track. Delaying the release may cause the project to be unsuccessful in achieving its objectives.

B Hire an external firm to translate the content into French

Incorrect. Procuring the work to produce the French translation would unnecessarily increase the expense of the project and will likely negatively affect the project schedule. Of the available choices, this is not the best solution if you want to keep the project on track.

C Run the Acquire Resources process to replace the team member

Incorrect. The question states that the team member will be unable to drive for three weeks. It is unlikely that a replacement can be acquired and brought up to speed in that time frame, especially if, according to the scenario described, you want to keep the project on track.

D Organize the project team members as a virtual team

Correct. Of the choices provided, allowing the team member to temporarily work remotely is the best solution as it would have the least impact on project performance. Allowing one team member to work remotely would make the team a virtual team even if the rest of the project team continues to be colocated.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 333

PMP Exam 1

Question 8

You are part of a small quality assurance team that is responsible for doing quality testing before each project deliverable is released to the customer. Your job is to confirm that the project processes are conforming to the company's quality standards and to identify areas for process improvement. As part of your analysis, your team makes use of flowcharts, matrix diagrams, audits, and affinity diagrams.

What quality process is your team performing?

A Plan Quality Management

B Control Quality

C Perform Quality Analysis

D Manage Quality

Answer: D

Hint:

Which of the following is the process of auditing quality requirements?

Explanation:

The team is analyzing the process to ensure the project's conformance to the company's quality standards and to identify areas for process improvement, which means they are performing Manage Quality. A hint is that audits are a tool listed only for the process of Manage Quality, whereas the other tools and techniques listed may be used in Manage Quality in addition to Plan Quality Management and Control Quality processes.

Details for Each Option:

A Plan Quality Management

Incorrect. This process involves identifying quality requirements and/or standards for the project and its deliverables, and documenting how the project will demonstrate compliance with quality requirements and/or standards. This planning has already been performed in this scenario, so it cannot be the correct answer choice.

B Control Quality

Incorrect. Control Quality is concerned with comparing the work results with the quality requirements to ensure the result is acceptable. The focus is more on looking at each deliverable to inspect it for defects. In this scenario, the team is focused on identifying areas for process improvement and verifying how well the deliverables conform to the company's overall quality standards and guidelines.

C Perform Quality Analysis

Incorrect. This is a made-up term, not one of the three PMI defined processes of Project Quality Management. This is not to be confused with data analysis - a tool and technique used in managing and controlling quality.

D Manage Quality

Correct. In this scenario, the team is analyzing the project processes to ensure conformance to company quality standards and to identify areas for process improvement, which means you are performing the Manage Quality process. A hint is that audits are a tool listed only for the process of Manage Quality, making this the only correct answer choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 288-297

PMP Exam 1

Question 9

Using the appropriate tools and techniques, the project team have collected a set of requirements for the project.

What is the next step in defining which requirements will be included as part of the project?

A Creating a work breakdown structure

B Developing a scope management plan

C Building a working prototype

D Performing the Define Scope process

Answer: D

Hint:

The project manager has just completed the Collect Requirements process. What process is next?

Explanation:

Since not all of the requirements identified in Collect Requirement process may be included in the project, the project team performs the Define Scope process to select the final project requirements from the requirements documentation that was created during the Collect Requirements process. One of the major outputs from the Define Scope process is the project scope statement which is the description of the project scope, the project's major deliverables, assumptions, and constraints. The Define Scope process formalizes what is included in the project scope and what is out of scope.

Details for Each Option:

A Creating a work breakdown structure

Incorrect. The work breakdown structure is created during the Create WBS process which is performed after the project scope is defined.

B Developing a scope management plan

Incorrect. The scope management plan is developed during the Plan Scope Management process which is performed before the Collect Requirements process.

C Building a working prototype

Incorrect. Prototyping, if appropriate, is one of the tools and techniques that would have been used to collect the requirements. According to the scenario, the requirements have already been collected.

D Performing the Define Scope process

Correct. The Define Scope process is performed after the Collect Requirements process is performed to determine which of the requirements collected will be included in or excluded from the project scope.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 150

PMP Exam 1

Question 10

You are leading a project to be developed incrementally in small releases. Requirements have been established for the initial release. Feedback from a focus group will determine the scope of each subsequent release. The client has established a strict budget for the entire project.

In this adaptive environment, which is the best way to proceed?

A Use a traditional waterfall approach for the project

B Add prioritized features to the project scope with each release until the budget is exhausted

C During initial project planning, develop a detailed budget for each release

D Use a change control board (CCB) to prevent scope creep

Answer: B

Hint:

In this scenario, the schedule and scope will be adjusted to stay within the cost constraint.

Explanation:

The question describes a project where the scope beyond the initial release is undetermined. In cases where the project scope will evolve throughout project execution, the scope and schedule may be adjusted to stay within the cost constraint. This approach is typically applied to projects lead using agile methods where the product backlog constitutes the project scope that is defined and redefined throughout the project. Thus, of the available choices, adding prioritized features with each release until the budget is exhausted is the correct answer.

Details for Each Option:

A Use a traditional waterfall approach for the project

Incorrect. The scenario in the question is that the project scope will evolve based on feedback from the focus group for each subsequent release. Since much of the scope is unknown at the start of the project, this is not suited to a traditional or predictive approach like waterfall.

B Add prioritized features to the project scope with each release until the budget is exhausted

Correct. With an adaptive approach where the cost is fixed, the schedule and scope must be adjusted to stay within the cost constraint.

C During initial project planning, develop a detailed budget for each release

Incorrect. The question describes that the project scope is not known and will be based on feedback from a focus group. As such, it will not be possible to develop a realistic budget for each release without knowing what features will be developed.

D Use a change control board (CCB) to prevent scope creep

Incorrect. The question implies that the project will use an agile or adaptive methodology. Agile projects do not use formal change control procedures as is done when using a traditional project management approach.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 234

PMP Exam 1

Question 11

As the project manager in your company, you have contacted the Project Management Office requesting their help in reviewing the results of the latest round of tests on the project's product. They look through the tests and make note of how frequently the tests were carried out to determine whether the team completed the required number of tests and followed proper procedures defined in the quality management plan.

What is being described here?

A The PMO is performing the Control Quality process

B The PMO is using statistical sampling

C The PMO is performing inspection

D The PMO is performing a quality audit

Answer: D

Hint:

What is the structured, independent process used to determine if project activities comply with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures?

Explanation:

Quality audits are one of the tools and techniques used in the Manage Quality process. An audit is a structured, independent process used to determine if project activities comply with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures. A quality audit is usually conducted by a team external to the project, such as the organization's internal audit department, PMO, or by an auditor external to the organization. In this scenario, the PMO office is reviewing the product test results to verify that the project is in compliance with organizational policies, making quality audit the best answer.

Details for Each Option:

A The PMO is performing the Control Quality process

Incorrect. Making sure the proper procedures took place is most closely aligned with a quality audit, which is a tool or technique of the Manage Quality process. If they had been focusing on comparing the actual test results with the acceptance criteria, then Control Quality would be correct.

B The PMO is using statistical sampling

Incorrect. Statistical sampling is a tool and technique used in the Control Quality process to measure controls and verify quality. In this scenario the PMO is more concerned with the frequency of tests than the actual test results and ensuring that the processes or procedures defined in the quality management plan have been followed, a process most closely aligned with a quality audit.

C The PMO is performing inspection

Incorrect. This may have looked like a good answer since inspections can also be referred to as audits. However, inspections are typically less formal and performed by the project team, not an external source, with an emphasis on verifying defect repairs and a product's conformance to documented standards.

D The PMO is performing a quality audit

Correct. The actions described in the question are most closely aligned with a quality audit. Since quality audits are often performed by someone external to the project, as it was in this scenario, this is a strong hint that quality audit was the correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 294

PMP Exam 1

Question 12

A_change request to repair a defect was submitted to the change control board (CCB) several days ago, but the project manager has not been informed of the decision. She wants to implement the change urgently to avoid schedule delays.

What should the project manager do next?

A Check the change log

B Review the issue log

C Ask a member of the CCB

D Implement the change

Answer: A

Hint:

Which project document contains the status of all change requests?

Explanation:

The question indicates that the project manager needs to know the status of a change request before performing a defect repair. Approved change requests are implemented through the Direct and Manage Project Work process. The change log is the input to the Direct and Manage Project Work process which contains the status of all change requests. Of the available choices, the project manager should next check the change log to see if the change request was approved.

Ideally, the question should have asked, "What should the project manager do next to find the status of the change request?" rather than just asking "What should the project manager do next?" The latter can be reasonably answered by at least three answer choices. However, the question is worded as it is. Prospective PMP aspirants should keep in mind that questions and answers on the real exam could be ambiguous. Therefore, it is recommended to make reasonable assumptions based on the available information provided in the question and, of the choices given, select the best answer to the question asked. In this question, the scenario states that the project manager wants to implement the approved changes as soon as possible to avoid any further delays in the project schedule. However, the project manager is not aware of the status of the change request. Therefore, it can be assumed that by asking "What should the project manager do next?" the question actually asks, "What should the project manager do next to find the status of the change request?"

Details for Each Option:

A Check the change log

Correct. The change log contains the status of all change requests. The project manager should check the change log to see if the change request was approved.

B Review the issue log

Incorrect. The issue log is a project document where information about issues encountered throughout the life cycle of a project is recorded and monitored. The issue log is not likely to have information regarding the status of the change request.

C Ask a member of the CCB

Incorrect. A member of the CCB may or may not remember the decision reached on a particular change request on a particular project. Even if the individual is aware of the change request status, asking for assistance is not the best use of time. The project manager should use the resources that are readily available to obtain the needed information.

D Implement the change

Incorrect. Implementing the change without knowing if it has been approved goes against project management best practices and likely against the change control procedures established or the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 120, 92

PMP Exam 1

Question 13

The contingency reserves in the project you are leading were initially set at $200,000. You perform an analysis every month to track the remaining reserve funds. After the first month, you determine that there is $190,000 of the original contingency reserves remaining. The second month shows $175,000, and the third month indicates $155,000. You now need to communicate this information to stakeholders in conformance with the communications management plan.

What should you do next?

A Capture the data in a burndown chart

B Use a tornado diagram to display the reserve information

C Utilize a Gantt chart to share with stakeholders

D Update the RACI chart with the remaining reserves

Answer: A

Hint:

What type of chart displays reserves remaining over time?

Explanation:

The question describes reserve analysis, which is performed during the Monitor Risks process. A reserve burndown chart is a graphical representation of the reserves remaining over time. The reserve burndown chart is a common method of capturing reserve information for communication to stakeholders. Once the reserve data has been collected, the next logical step is to capture the information in a burndown chart to share with stakeholders.

Details for Each Option:

A Capture the data in a burndown chart

Correct. A reserve burndown chart is a graphical representation of the reserves remaining over time and is a common method of capturing reserve information for communication to stakeholders.

B Use a tornado diagram to display the reserve information

Incorrect. A tornado diagram is a special type of bar chart used in sensitivity analysis for comparing the relative importance of the variables but is not typically used to communicate the status of reserve analysis.

C Utilize a Gantt chart to share with stakeholders

Incorrect. A Gantt chart is a bar chart of schedule information. However, the question is asking about representing reserve information rather than schedule information.

D Update the RACI chart with the remaining reserves

Incorrect. RACI chart is a common type of responsibility assignment matrix, but it is not used to capture reserve information.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 456

PMP Exam 1

Question 14

A_project charter has been approved, and the project manager has just completed the Identify Stakeholders process.

Before project planning begins, what should the project manager do?

A Conduct stakeholder analysis

B Hold a project kick-off meeting

C Inform the key stakeholders of the approved project charter

D Perform the Plan Stakeholder Engagement process

Answer: C

Hint:

Garner support for and ensure a common understanding of the project.

Explanation:

Once the project charter has been approved, the project manager should inform the key stakeholders that the project has received authorization. Informing stakeholders of the approved project charter helps maintain their support and is a declaration that the project manager can begin to use company resources to plan and execute the project. Announcing the approval of the project charter ensures the stakeholders are aware of their role and responsibilities, the key deliverables, and important project milestones.

Details for Each Option:

A Conduct stakeholder analysis

Incorrect. Stakeholder analysis is a technique used in the Identify Stakeholder process to systematically gather and analyze quantitative and qualitative information to determine whose interests should be taken into account throughout the project. In this situation, since project planning has not yet started, stakeholder analysis would have been performed as part of the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process, which the scenario states has already been completed, thus eliminating this answer choice from consideration.

B Hold a project kick-off meeting

Incorrect. The project kick-off meeting is usually associated with the end of planning and the start of executing. Its purpose is to communicate the project objectives, gain team commitment for the project, and explain the roles and responsibilities of each stakeholder. Since the scenario describes a project in initiating, this answer choice is incorrect. Note, when a small team will be both planning and executing the project, the kick-off meeting can start the Planning Process Group. Since the scenario states the planning process has not begun, this answer choice would still be incorrect.

C Inform the key stakeholders of the approved project charter

Correct. Once the project charter is approved, the identified stakeholders should be informed the project has received authorization to proceed. Informing stakeholders of the approved project charter ensures a common understanding of the key deliverables, milestones, and their roles and responsibilities.

D Perform the Plan Stakeholder Engagement process

Incorrect. The Plan Stakeholder Engagement process describes the approach to involve project stakeholders based on their needs, expectations, interests, and potential impact on the project. The Plan Stakeholder Engagement process is performed as part of planning. Since the scenario indicates the project is still in initiating, this answer choice is incorrect.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 53, 81, 561

PMP Exam 1

Question 15

During project planning, you review the stakeholder register with your project team to develop approaches for involving stakeholders in the project. You realize that one particular group of stakeholders may have a significant influence on the project and ask your team to start working with the group immediately.

What is the most likely reason for your decision?

A Stakeholders must authorize and approve all changes in the project work.

B Early involvement of the stakeholders may reduce the cost of changes.

C Stakeholder approval authorizes the project manager to start project work.

D Early involvement of the stakeholders may increase the cost of changes.

Answer: B

Hint:

How would stakeholder involvement in decisions at the beginning of the project positively benefit the overall project?

Explanation:

The question implies that you are carrying out the Plan Stakeholder Engagement process. The stakeholder register is an input to this process. You have identified an important group of stakeholders who may have a significant influence on the project and its expected outcomes. You are attempting to lessen the possibility of change requests or errors later in the project by engaging the stakeholders as early as possible. Including their input and involving them in the decisions at the start of the project decreases the impact on cost and schedule changes as the project progresses. Engaging stakeholders, particularly those with significant influence on the project, early and often increases stakeholder satisfaction and the potential for project success.

Details for Each Option:

A Stakeholders must authorize and approve all changes in the project work.

Incorrect. Change approval authority is typically identified in the project management plan, and the responsibility usually goes to the project sponsor, project manager or designated change control board (CCB).

B Early involvement of the stakeholders may reduce the cost of changes.

Correct. Soliciting stakeholder's input on project products or objectives early in the project life cycle decreases the potential impact on cost due to change requests later in the project. Engaging stakeholders, early and often throughout the project life cycle is key to project success. This includes appropriate stakeholder engagement and participation in project decisions and activities such as the process improvement objective described in the scenario.

C Stakeholder approval authorizes the project manager to start project work.

Incorrect. The project charter, not stakeholder approval, authorizes the project manager to begin project work.

D Early involvement of the stakeholders may increase the cost of changes.

Incorrect. Stakeholder input and influence on the project's outcome has less, not greater, impact on cost and schedule when provided early in the project. Input and influence later in the project can equal increased errors and change requests and impact to project cost and schedule.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 504-505, 549

PMP Exam 1

Question 16

A_system must be completed by October 31st or a penalty of $1,000 per day may be imposed. The table below reflects the current status of the project. At this point in the project, the system analysis, system design, and system development should have been complete. The method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete.

What is the current cost performance index?

Phase Name	Start Date	End Date	Duration (Days)	Planned Value	Actual Cost	Percent Complete
System Analysis	1/1	1/12	11	$ 5,000.00	$ 6,000.00	100%
System Design	1/13	3/15	61	$ 10,000.00	$ 10,000.00	100%
System Development	2/15	8/15	181	$ 50,000.00	$ 30,000.00	50%
System Testing	8/15	9/30	46	$ 10,000.00	$ -	0%
System Deployment	10/1	10/31	30	$ 5,000.00	$ -	0%

A 0.62

B 0.87

C 1.15

D -$6,000

Answer: B

Hint:

Cost performance index (CPI) is the earned value (EV) divided by the actual costs (AC).

Explanation:

Cost performance index (CPI) is the earned value (EV) divided by the actual costs (AC). The current earned value is the sum of the earned values for every activity that has either been completed or is in progress. Thus, the earned value can be calculated by multiplying the activity's percent complete by the activity's planned value. The actual costs are the total costs of the individual activities. Note, since the scenario mentions that the method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete, the earned value of a partially completed work package is calculated by multiplying the planned value of the work package by its the percent complete.

The calculations are shown below:

EV = EV of activity 1 + EV of activity 2 + EV of activity 3 = (1 x $5,000) + (1 x $10,000) + (.50 x $50,000) = $40,000

AC = AC of activity 1 + AC of activity 2 + AC of activity 3 = $6,000 + $10,000 + $30,000 = $46,000

CPI = EV / AC = $40,000 / $46,000 = 0.87

Therefore, the cost performance index (CPI) in this scenario is 0.87. Since the CPI is less than 1, the project is running over planned costs. Note that the information regarding the late penalty is not relevant to answer the question correctly. The actual PMP exam questions may contain superfluous information to disguise the correct answer.

Details for Each Option:

A 0.62

Incorrect. This answer choice represents the SPI which is calculated as SPI = EV / PV. However, the question is asking for the current CPI and not the SPI.

B 0.87

Correct. Cost performance index (CPI) is the earned value (EV) divided by the actual costs (AC). The current earned value is the sum of the earned values for every activity that has either been completed or is in progress. Thus, the earned value can be calculated by multiplying the activity's percent complete by the activity's planned value. The actual costs are the total costs of the individual activities. In this case, CPI = EV / AC = $40,000 / $46,000 = 0.87.

C 1.15

Incorrect. This answer choice represents an incorrect usage of the CPI formula where the numerator and denominator are transposed.

D -$6,000

Incorrect. This answer choice represents the cost variance (CV) which is calculated as CV = EV - AC. However, the question is asking for the CPI and not the CV.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 263, 267

Practice Standard for Earned Value Management - Second Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2011, Page(s) 38-39

https://www.project-management-prepcast.com/pmp-formulas

PMP Exam 1

Question 17

You are managing a big project. To direct, manage, monitor and control your project work more efficiently, you want the project key performance indicators to be gathered and reported automatically.

What is the best tool to use for this purpose?

A Project management information system

B Published estimating data

C Communication technology

D Performance reviews

Answer: A

Hint:

This tool is one of the enterprise environmental factors.

Explanation:

A project management information system is an enterprise environmental factor. The system can be used as a tool or technique of, or serve as an input to, many project management processes. The project management information system consists of the tools and techniques used to gather, integrate, and disseminate the outputs of project management processes. The system is used to support all aspects of the project from initiating through closing, for example providing access to tools such as a scheduling tool, a work authorization system, a configuration management system, an information collection and distribution system, or interface to other online automated systems. The project management information system can include both manual and automated systems. One of its capabilities is to automatically gather and report on key performance

indicators which is what the question asks. Therefore, a project management information system is the best answer to the question.

Details for Each Option:

A Project management information system

Correct. A project management information system can be used as a tool or technique of, or serve as an input to, many project management processes. Among other capabilities, the project management information system can automatically gather and report on project key performance indicators.

B Published estimating data

Incorrect. Published estimating data are among the inputs of the Estimate Activity Resources process. Some organizations publish data, such as production rates and unit costs of resources, while carrying out the Estimate Activity Resources process. Published estimating data is not relevant to the project key performance indicators.

C Communication technology

Incorrect. Communication technology is what enables information, such as key performance indicators, to be communicated to the project stakeholders. However, communication technology on its own does not automatically gather and report on project key performance indicators.

D Performance reviews

Incorrect. Performance reviews are among the tools and techniques of data analysis. Performance reviews do not gather and report key performance indicators, neither automatically nor manually.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 95

PMP Exam 1

Question 18

You are leading a project to replace an aging bridge spanning a river in a heavily populated area. The new bridge would include a pedestrian pathway, that is not a feature of the existing bridge. The bridge is well under construction when residents learn the pathway would allow strangers to enter their neighborhood at all times. The residents demand the elimination of the pathway.

What would have been the best course of action to avoid this situation?

A Identify the pathway as a possible point of contention with stakeholders early in the project

B Nothing could have been done differently because the project was authorized per the project charter

C Engage a public relations company to handle community outreach once local residents voiced their disapproval

D Reroute the pathway entrance during construction to an old railway trail instead of the local street

Answer: A

Hint:

The project manager should have been proactive.

Explanation:

The project team under the guidance of the project manager needs to be able to assess the project situation, balance the demands, and maintain proactive communications with stakeholders in order to deliver a successful project. In this case, a thorough assessment of the project's impact on all stakeholders early in the project life cycle may have identified the potential resistance of the local residents to the pathway. Identifying potential issues early allows the project team to proactively address the problems and implement strategies to resolve them to increase the prospect of project success.

Details for Each Option:

A Identify the pathway as a possible point of contention with stakeholders early in the project

Correct. By identifying the problem with the pathway early, the project team could have engaged the local residents proactively and worked out a possible win-win solution for both parties.

B Nothing could have been done differently because the project was authorized per the project charter

Incorrect. Just because the project was authorized does not mean steps could not have been taken to avoid the situation. The conflict could have been avoided if a proper assessment of the project's impact on the stakeholders was conducted early in the project before the project management plan was approved so that the stakeholders' concerns could have been heard and addressed.

C Engage a public relations company to handle community outreach once local residents voiced their disapproval

Incorrect. This answer choice is not the best answer because engaging a public relations company after the local residents voice their disapproval is reactive and would not have 'avoided' the situation. The project manager and team should be proactive whenever possible in identifying potential issues and dealing with them.

D Reroute the pathway entrance during construction to an old railway trail instead of the local street

Incorrect. Rerouting the entrance and exit points to another location may or may not resolve the local residents immediate concern and very well could lead to another conflict with the local community. Therefore, this choice is not the best answer to the question asked.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 35

PMP Exam 1

Question 19

The client contends that the project's deliverables do not meet the agreed-upon specifications and have to be reworked. The client shows the meeting minutes to the project manager saying that the standard for the acceptance of the deliverables was discussed earlier in the project, during one of the status calls.

What should the project manager do first?

A Check the project charter for the contract terms

B Agree to rework the deliverables to meet the requirements as requested by the customer

C Review the agreements for the acceptance criteria

D Tell the customer to proceed with claims administration to resolve the issue

Answer: C

Hint:

Where are the agreed-upon acceptance criteria found?

Explanation:

The premise of the question is taken from the perspective of the seller, which is providing the deliverables to the buyer. The buyer conducted a procurement process and contracted with the seller to deliver the product and/or service. The contract contains the terms and conditions of the agreement including the agreed-upon acceptance criteria. The agreements serve as an input for the Collect Requirements process, and the acceptance criteria are then used during the inspection in the Validate Scope process to ensure that the contractual obligations have been met. The meeting minutes provided by the customer may very well contain some criteria for the deliverables, but the agreed-upon acceptance criteria are derived from the contract which is the mutually binding agreement. Of the available choices, the project manager should first check the agreements to understand the acceptance criteria.

Details for Each Option:

A Check the project charter for the contract terms

Incorrect. The project charter will contain high-level information about the project but is not a source for acceptance criteria.

B Agree to rework the deliverables to meet the requirements as requested by the customer

Incorrect. It is not known from the question what information was captured in the meeting minutes, and the meeting minutes may contain some requirements for the deliverables. However, the meeting minutes are not the legally binding agreements made by the parties.

C Review the agreements for the acceptance criteria

Correct. The project manager must first understand the agreed-upon acceptance criteria. The acceptance criteria will be contained in the terms and conditions of the contract, and a contract is an example of a mutually binding agreement.

D Tell the customer to proceed with claims administration to resolve the issue

Incorrect. Claims administration is the process of processing, adjudicating, and communicating contract claims. Proceeding with claims administration is a premature action as the project manager should first seek to understand the agreed-upon acceptance criteria.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 489, 141, 166

PMP Exam 1

Question 20

Which of the following would be one of the last tasks for a project manager to perform as part of the administrative closure of a project?

A Obtaining formal acceptance of the project deliverables

B Conducting earned value analysis

C Evaluating stakeholder satisfaction with the project

D Verifying the correctness of the deliverables

Answer: C

Hint:

The term "administrative closure" is sometimes used to describe what process?

Explanation:

A project is considered a success when the project objectives have been achieved. One important objective established early in the project's planning is stakeholder satisfaction. Stakeholder satisfaction should be monitored throughout the project and finally used as a measure of project success at the end of the project. The question surrounds the administrative closure of a project implying the answer choice should be one of the activities carried out during the Close Project or Phase process. One of the last tasks of the project manager during this process is measuring stakeholder satisfaction for the project as a whole.

Details for Each Option:

A Obtaining formal acceptance of the project deliverables

Incorrect. Obtaining formal acceptance of the deliverables is done as part of the Validate Scope process. In the Close Project or Phase process implied by the scenario, acceptance of the deliverables is 'confirmed', not 'obtained'. While the difference is subtle, it is strong enough to make this choice an incorrect answer.

B Conducting earned value analysis

Incorrect. Earned value analysis compares the performance measurement baseline to the actual scope, schedule, and cost performance and is typically used as one of the tools and techniques in the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group. Earned value analysis would not be performed as part of the Close Project or Phase process described by the question.

C Evaluating stakeholder satisfaction with the project

Correct. Measuring and evaluating stakeholder satisfaction is one of the last tasks performed during the Close Project or Phase process suggested by the scenario. Stakeholder satisfaction is one of the main objectives established early in project planning, monitored throughout the project, and finally used as a measure of success at the end of the project.

D Verifying the correctness of the deliverables

Incorrect. Verifying the correctness of deliverables is a function of the Control Quality process, while the question is asking about the administrative closure of a project, thus referring to the Close Project or Phase process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 123, 166, 305, 505, 552

PMP Exam 1

Question 21

You have just drafted a document which, at a high level, will ensure a common understanding by the stakeholders of key deliverables, milestones, and the roles and responsibilities of everyone involved in the project.

Before you wrap up the current process, what should you do?

A Obtain approval of the document you have drafted

B Conduct a project kick-off meeting

C Obtain approval of the project management plan

D Pre-assign key project team members

Answer: A

Hint:

You have just drafted the project charter.

Explanation:

The question suggests that you have just drafted the project charter, which is the main output of the Develop Project Charter process. The project charter is a document which, at a high-level, ensures a common understanding by the stakeholders of key deliverables, milestones, and the roles and responsibilities of everyone involved in the project. Although a project manager may assist with the development of the project charter, the charter must still be formally approved by an initiating entity such as a sponsor, project management office (PMO), or authorized representative. Therefore, before wrapping up the Develop Project Charter process, you should obtain approval of the project charter.

Details for Each Option:

A Obtain approval of the document you have drafted

Correct. The question suggests that the project charter has just been drafted. The project charter must be formally signed-off by the project initiator before the Develop Project Charter process described by the scenario can be completed.

B Conduct a project kick-off meeting

Incorrect. The question indicates that the project still needs to be formally authorized through the approval of the project charter, which means that conducting a project kick-off meeting at this point would be premature. A kick-off meeting typically takes place at the end of planning and the start of executing. According to the scenario, the project is in initiation.

C Obtain approval of the project management plan

Incorrect. The question implies that the project charter has just been drafted. Before the development of the project management plan can begin, the project charter should be approved as it serves as an input to the Develop Project Management Plan process.

D Pre-assign key project team members

Incorrect. When physical or team resources are determined in advance, before the actual process of acquiring project resources begins, the resources are considered pre-assigned. There is not enough information in the question to determine if any resources should or could be pre-assigned. Additionally, pre-assignment can take place later in the project life cycle, not necessarily during project initiation.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 77, 81

PMP Exam 1

Question 22

The project charter for a project in the initiation stage provides an initial budget estimate of $1,000,000. The project will take four years to complete, and the revenues will be realized at the

end of the project when the property is sold at the anticipated selling price of $1,100,000. You are of the opinion that the project should proceed since it is profitable, but the director of finance disagrees.

What might have you done wrong?

A Neglected opportunity costs in the calculation

B Did not account for project risk

C Used nominal dollars instead of net present value (NPV)

D Failed to account for sunk costs

Answer: C

Hint:

What role might inflation play in this scenario?

Explanation:

The question indicates that costs will be incurred throughout the project, but the revenue will only be received at the end of the four-year-long project. The anticipated nominal selling price of $1,100,000 does not take into account the effect of inflation over the four-year period of the project. Using net present value (NPV) adjusts for inflation to get a more accurate assessment of the true value of future revenues. If the majority of the expense is incurred up front, then even a modest inflation rate of 3% could make the project unprofitable in terms of real value. Had you, as the project manager, used NPV in your calculation for net profit instead of nominal dollars, you would not have advocated for the project based on an anticipated profit of $100,000. The incorrect answer choices are all viable options for mistakes that may have been made, but there is no information from the description provided by the question to indicate such one way or another. Therefore, of the available choices, the only clear mistake that was made was the use of nominal dollars instead of NPV.

While the topic of this question is just briefly mentioned in the PMBOK® Guide, the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, June 2015, covers knowledge and skills with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Project finance principles are among these knowledge and skills.

Details for Each Option:

A Neglected opportunity costs in the calculation

Incorrect. Opportunity cost is the value of the best alternative given up when a choice is made, in which the choices must be mutually exclusive owing to limited resources. There is no information presented by the question that another project is being considered. Even if there were a more lucrative opportunity available, this does not affect the potential profitability of the project described by the question.

B Did not account for project risk

Incorrect. High-level risks are captured in the project charter and included in the cost estimates based on what is known at this early stage of the project. During project planning, a more detailed analysis will be performed to account for project risks in the form of reserves. Even if project risks were not included in the initial estimate in the project charter, there is another more obvious problem represented by another answer choice.

C Used nominal dollars instead of net present value (NPV)

Correct. The anticipated nominal selling price of $1,100,000 does not take into account the effect of inflation over the four-year period of the project. Using net present value (NPV) adjusts for inflation to get a more accurate assessment of the true value of future revenues.

D Failed to account for sunk costs

Incorrect. Sunk costs are the costs that have already been incurred which cannot be recovered. With the project in the initiation stage, money spent on the project thus far would be minimal. Additionally, all costs associated with the project should have been included in the project budget. Even if the costs incurred thus far in the project were not accounted for in the budget, there is another answer choice that represents a more significant issue and a better answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 34

PMP Exam 1

Question 23

You are managing a project with key stakeholders representing 15 different countries, and feedback from your video conferences has been negative. One of the stakeholders says you don't take the business seriously enough because you always open the discussion with a joke. One of the stakeholders says you speak too loudly and he feels like you are yelling. Another stakeholder says you are too serious because you only talk about the business.

What part of planning communications was missed?

A Performing a communications requirement analysis

B Planning for cultural diversity

C Reviewing the stakeholder engagement plan

D Performing a communication styles assessment

Answer: B

Hint:

Managing a project with stakeholders from 15 countries is likely to involve differences in their ways of communicating and their expectations from leadership. How can you plan for this?

Explanation:

As a project manager, you must be culturally aware and adapt your project's communication strategy to minimize misunderstandings, miscommunications, and conflict that may result from cultural differences. While the stakeholder engagement plan does address communications with stakeholders, the emphasis is on how sharing information will help in managing stakeholder engagement. In this scenario, you realize that your communication with some stakeholders is unproductive and you are trying to determine the reasons. Planning for cultural diversity or cultural awareness is understanding differences exist between ages, nationalities, ethnicities, races, or genders. Different cultures see, hear, and interpret the world differently and these differences affect the way cultures process verbal and nonverbal communication. Therefore, planning for cultural diversity in your communications management plan is the best answer.

Details for Each Option:

A Performing a communications requirement analysis

Incorrect. A communications requirement analysis will help you determine the information needs of the stakeholders as well as the best type of format to use for distribution of the information. In this scenario, you have chosen a video conferencing service to utilize for communications with stakeholders. The communications requirement analysis has already been completed and therefore is not the correct answer.

B Planning for cultural diversity

Correct. Cross-cultural communication presents challenges to effective communication. Differences in communication styles can arise from differences in age, nationality, ethnicity, race, or gender. As the project manager, you need to be culturally aware and adapt the project's communication strategy to minimize misunderstandings and miscommunications that may result from your culturally diverse group of stakeholders.

C Reviewing the stakeholder engagement plan

Incorrect. The stakeholder engagement plan identifies strategies that can be used to involve stakeholders in decision-making and execution effectively. While the stakeholder engagement plan does address communications with stakeholders, the emphasis is on how sharing information will help in managing stakeholder engagement. In this scenario, you are discovering why communication isn't as expected and what you may have missed during planning communication that would have prevented the miscommunication. Therefore, this is not the best answer.

D Performing a communication styles assessment

Incorrect. A communication styles assessment is a technique used to determine stakeholders' preferred methods and formats of communication. In this scenario, the chosen method of video conferencing is not the problem. It is the cultural differences that exist between you and some of your stakeholders.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 373, 376

PMP Exam 1

Question 24

Which of the following processes is responsible for verifying that the project deliverables are ready for inspection and acceptance by the customer?

A Direct and Manage Project Work

B Control Procurements

C Manage Quality

D Control Quality

Answer: D

Hint:

Which process results in verified deliverables?.

Explanation:

The documented quality specifications and metrics described and required by the customer for deliverable approval are achieved by activities of the Control Quality process. It is only after these activities have been performed, can a deliverable be considered verified and ready for customer inspection and approval in the Validate Scope process. Verified deliverables are an output from the Control Quality process and an input into the Validate Scope process where they are provided to the customer for an inspection and, hopefully, acceptance, becoming the accepted deliverables.

Details for Each Option:

A Direct and Manage Project Work

Incorrect. The Direct and Manage Project Work process provides overall management of the project work and the deliverables produced. These deliverables must subsequently satisfy the quality specifications and metrics defined by the customer for acceptance to be considered verified.

B Control Procurements

Incorrect. The question indicates that this is an internal project and there is no mention that procurement from either an internal or external supplier was required. Therefore, the Control Procurements process is not involved.

C Manage Quality

Incorrect. The Manage Quality process is the process of translating the quality management plan into quality activities that when executed increase the probability of meeting the quality objectives of the project and organization. Often these activities determine process optimizations and the source and causes of poor quality. This process is not responsible for producing verified deliverables to be inspected during the Validate Scope process.

D Control Quality

Correct. The Control Quality process executes the quality management activities that ensure the project outputs are complete, correct, and meet the quality specifications and metrics defined by the customer. The deliverables that satisfy these criteria are referred to as verified deliverables which are used in the Validate Scope process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 299, 305

PMP Exam 1

Question 25

A_project manager has completed a project. A couple of months later, a vendor contacts the project manager stating that their invoice has not been paid and is past due, but the project manager believes that all invoices from the project have been paid and the procurements have been closed out.

What should the project manager do next?

A Tell the vendor that all invoices have been paid since the procurements have been closed

B Check with the accounts payable department to see if anyone remembers paying the invoice

C Check the records in the procurement documentation

D Proceed with claims administration to resolve the dispute

Answer: C

Hint:

Where is the best place to find invoices and payment records?

Explanation:

It can be inferred from the question that the Control Procurements process had been performed and procurements closed out as part of the process. One of the outputs of the Control Procurements process is procurement documentation updates. Procurement documentation includes all documents used in signing, executing, and closing an agreement. Included among these documents will be the invoices and payment records for the project. Based on the scenario described by the question, the next action for the project manager should be to check the procurement documentation for invoices and payment records.

Details for Each Option:

A Tell the vendor that all invoices have been paid since the procurements have been closed

Incorrect. The project manager should research the matter further to be certain of the status of the invoice so it can be paid or provide the vendor with proof of payment.

B Check with the accounts payable department to see if anyone remembers paying the invoice

Incorrect. It is possible, but not likely, someone in accounts payable would remember paying a particular invoice. Even if someone does remember the payment, the project manager needs to find proof of the payment to settle the dispute with the vendor. Therefore, this is not the best answer choice of the available options.

C Check the records in the procurement documentation

Correct. Procurement documentation includes all documents used in signing, executing, and closing an agreement. Included among these documents will be the invoices and payment records for the project.

D Proceed with claims administration to resolve the dispute

Incorrect. Proceeding with claims administration is a premature action. The project manager should first review the invoices and payment records for this vendor to settle the dispute.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 499

PMP Exam 1

Question 26

In which process should the risk response owners periodically report to the project manager on the effectiveness of their assigned risk response plans?

A Plan Risk Responses

B Identify Risks

C Monitor Risks

D Audit Risks

Answer: C

Hint:

What is the last process in the Project Risk Management Knowledge Area?

Explanation:

Risk should be monitored and assessed as the project progresses to manage the impact of risks and opportunities on the project. During the Monitor Risks process, the risk response owner periodically monitors the implementation of the risk response plans and reports on how their risk plan strategy is performing. The risk owner uses performance information generated during the project execution to determine if implemented risk responses are effective, whether or not the status of identified risks has changed, and if project risk strategy is still valid. Therefore, to periodically report to the project manager on the effectiveness of their assigned risk response plan, the risk response owners should use the Monitor Risks process.

Details for Each Option:

A Plan Risk Responses

Incorrect. In the Plan Risk Responses process risk owners are assigned responsibility for individual project risks and charged with identifying ways to address the risks assigned to them. Plan Risk Responses is not the process where the risk owners report on the effectiveness of their plans.

B Identify Risks

Incorrect. Identify Risks is the process of identifying individual project risks. Risk owners may be nominated during that process. However, the Identify Risks process is part of the Planning Process Group, while reporting on the effectiveness of the risk response plan is done while carrying out processes of the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group, such as Monitor Risks, making the Identify Risks process an incorrect answer.

C Monitor Risks

Correct. The Monitor Risks process monitors the implementation of risk response plans, tracks identified risks as well as identifies and analyzes new risks. The Monitor Risks process is where risk owners evaluate and report on their risk plan effectiveness throughout the project, making this choice the best answer to the question asked.

D Audit Risks

Incorrect. 'Audit Risks' is a made-up term based on the Monitor Risks technique called 'risk audits.' 'Audit Risks' is not a process specified in the PMBOK® Guide.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 453-454

PMP Exam 1

Question 27

You have been assigned project manager for a new software project and have finished the scope statement. You want to ensure that all scope and project deliverables are identified and can be effectively managed.

What method would you use in developing your WBS to ensure that all parts of the project are captured?

A Bottom-up estimating

B Rolling wave planning

C Decomposition

D Checklist analysis

Answer: C

Hint:

What method would you use to divide and subdivide the project scope to achieve a manageable work package level where cost and duration can be estimated?

Explanation:

As a project manager on a new project you want to ensure that the WBS is established with the appropriate level of detail to manage scope through the duration of the project. Decomposition allows for dividing and subdividing the effort into smaller, more manageable parts. Activities such as developing organizational structure, identifying codes of the WBS, and identifying and analyzing the deliverables are all key components of decomposition within the WBS.

Details for Each Option:

A Bottom-up estimating

Incorrect. The method of bottom-up estimating is used to estimate by aggregating cost at the lower-level components of the work breakdown structure. This method does not include the development of the WBS structure.

B Rolling wave planning

Incorrect. Rolling wave planning is a process in which near-term effort is planned at the lower level of detail, and future effort is at the higher level. Future work will be planned once more information becomes available and can be more accurately defined.

C Decomposition

Correct. The method of decomposition is used to break down the scope and deliverables to a manageable level of detail to the degree needed to control the project cost and duration.

D Checklist analysis

Incorrect. Checklist analysis is a method for systematically reviewing materials using a list for accuracy and completeness. The checklist analysis is particularly used for identifying risk in a project management plan.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 158

PMP Exam 1

Question 28

As a project manager, you are leading a project, where you have twelve programmers. Two of them have just handed in their letters of resignation. This realized risk had been identified and accounted for during the planning stage of the project. If no action is taken, you will not meet your deadlines.

What should you do next?

A Crash the schedule

B Submit a change request to update the schedule baseline

C Review the risk register

D Perform the Plan Risk Responses process

Answer: C

Hint:

What project document serves as an input to the Implement Risk Responses process, and contains the agreed-upon risk responses?

Explanation:

The question implies that the project manager is about to carry out the Implement Risk Responses process. The risk register is one of the inputs to the Implement Risk Responses process. The risk register records the agreed-upon risk responses for each individual risk and the nominated owners for each response plan. The next thing you need to do is review the risk register so you can implement the agreed-upon risk response.

Details for Each Option:

A Crash the schedule

Incorrect. Crashing is a schedule compression technique which adds resources to an activity on the critical path. There is not enough information from the question to determine if crashing is part of the response plan for this risk. You should review the risk register first to understand the agreed-upon risk response before implementing a risk response.

B Submit a change request to update the schedule baseline

Incorrect. There is no information in the question to indicate that the schedule cannot be brought back into alignment with the project management plan. First, you need to review the risk register to learn the agreed-upon risk response.

C Review the risk register

Correct. The risk register records the agreed-upon risk responses for each individual risk and the nominated owners for each response plan. The next thing you need to do is review the risk register so you can implement the agreed-upon risk response.

D Perform the Plan Risk Responses process

Incorrect. The question suggests that the project is in the execution stage. The Plan Risk Responses process is completed during project planning rather than project execution.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 450

PMP Exam 1

Question 29

You and the project management team have been vigilant about observing different aspects of the project to ensure the project is progressing as planned. Currently, you are using performance data generated during project execution to determine if the status of overall project risk has

changed, if the project assumptions are still valid, if contingency reserves for cost or schedule require modification, and if project strategy remains valid.

What process are you performing?

A Plan Risk Responses

B Monitor Risks

C Plan Risk Management

D Identify Risks

Answer: B

Hint:

This process is the only answer choice not contained in the Planning Process Group.

Explanation:

The Monitoring and Controlling Process Group uses work performance data which is generated during project execution and analyzed in context to track, review, and regulate the progress and performance of the project as well as identify any areas that require change. The scenario described a list of aspects of a project that a project manager would want to monitor for effectiveness during the Monitor Risks process.

Details for Each Option:

A Plan Risk Responses

Incorrect. Plan Risk Responses is a planning process that identifies appropriate ways to address both individual and overall project risks. This scenario describes an analysis of work performance data generated during project execution to monitor risk aspects of the project. Therefore, you are in the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group and not in the Planning Process Group to which the Plan Risk Responses process belongs.

B Monitor Risks

Correct. The Monitor Risks process uses work performance data to determine whether different aspects of the risk planning and responses are performing as expected or whether adjustments need to be made.

C Plan Risk Management

Incorrect. Plan Risk Management is a planning process that defines how risk management will be conducted during the project. In this scenario, you are in the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group because you are using work performance data to examine different aspects of the project risks.

D Identify Risks

Incorrect. Identify Risks is a planning process where individual and overall project risks are identified and documented. You are monitoring aspects of project risks in this scenario; therefore, this is an incorrect answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 454

Question 30

Technical requirements on a website development project specify that the system should be able to handle 100,000 transactions per day without performance being affected. The team recently measured technical performance of the system and determined the system was experiencing deterioration already at 80,000 user transactions per day. The project manager has noted the discrepancy in the issue log.

What process has the project manager just performed?

A Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

B Plan Risk Responses

C Monitor Risks

D Control Quality

Answer: D

Hint:

Where are performance measurements compared with project requirements?

Explanation:

Part of the Control Quality process entails documenting when a deliverable does not meet quality requirements. In this scenario, the observation that user transactions were 20,000 below the requirement of 100,000 is a variation that needs to be recorded. By recording the discrepancy in the issue log the project manager was creating an output of the Control Quality process, making Control Quality the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. The Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis process prioritizes risks for further analysis based on their probability of occurrence and impact on the project. While these actions may need

to be performed when a new risk is identified, this scenario does not indicate a new risk, it reveals an issue with performance.

B Plan Risk Responses

Incorrect. The Plan Risk Responses process involves developing options, selecting strategies, and agreeing on actions to address overall risk exposure as well as to treat individual project risks. The scenario describes an issue with performance identified during project execution and not a risk that needs to be planned for during project planning.

C Monitor Risks

Incorrect. The Monitor Risks process is where the implementation of agreed-upon risk response plans is monitored, identified risks are tracked, new risks are identified and analyzed, and the effectiveness of risk management is evaluated. Since the project manager is recording observations of a discrepancy between quality control measurements and quality requirements, he is performing an activity of the Control Quality process, not the Monitor Risks process.

D Control Quality

Correct. Control Quality is the process of monitoring and recording results of executing the quality management activities to assess performance against the quality requirements set in the quality management plan. By adding the discrepancy to the issue log, the project manager was creating an output of the Control Quality process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 298-299, 305-306

PMP Exam 1

Question 31

In the midst of project execution, a member of your team has suggested a change to a project artifact that would affect the final product. You ask her to determine if the artifact has been defined as a formally controlled item that requires a change request.

Where will she find this information?

A Configuration management plan

B Performance measurement baseline

C Change management plan

D Requirements management plan

Answer: A

Hint:

The answer defines the components needed to maintain the setup and consistency of the product or outcome.

Explanation:

The configuration management plan is a component of the project management plan that defines the applicable project artifacts and determines which of those artifacts if changed, could affect or alter the project product or outcome. The plan defines the items that are configurable and then defines those configurable items that require formal change control and the process for controlling the changes.

Details for Each Option:

A Configuration management plan

Correct. The configuration management plan defines which project artifact will be formally controlled and therefore require a change request to make modifications. It also describes how the project artifact information will be recorded and updated to ensure the project remains consistent and/or operative.

B Performance measurement baseline

Incorrect. The performance measurement baseline integrates the scope, schedule, and cost baselines. That integration is then measured against project performance and execution. It does not identify which project artifacts are controlled.

C Change management plan

Incorrect. The change management plan does not identify which project artifacts are controlled. Instead, this plan defines how change requests will be managed, approved and incorporated.

D Requirements management plan

Incorrect. The requirements management plan defines how the project requirements will be managed, however, it does not identify which project artifacts are controlled.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 88, 115, 169

Question 32

The project sponsor has initiated a study in which participants would be evaluated in company facilities across the country. As the project manager, you are helping the sponsor with project initiation.

When proposing an implementation strategy for the project, what would you consider the company facilities?

A Enterprise environmental factors external to the organization

B Enterprise environmental factors internal to the organization

C Organizational process assets external to the organization

D Organizational process assets internal to the organization

Answer: B

Hint:

Enterprise environmental factors (EEFs) are not under the control of the project team.

Explanation:

Task 4 of the Initiating Domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline states, "Identify high-level risks, assumptions, and constraints based on the current environment, organizational factors, historical data, and expert judgment, in order to propose an implementations strategy." Enterprise environmental factors (EEFs) refer to conditions, not under the control of the project team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project. EEFs can be internal and/or external to the organization. In the scenario described, the company facilities are an example of an internal EEF which is a constraint that must be considered when proposing an implementation strategy for the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Enterprise environmental factors external to the organization

Incorrect. EEFs refer to conditions, not under the control of the project team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project. There can be both external and internal EEFs. Company facilities are considered an internal EEF, making this answer choice incorrect.

B Enterprise environmental factors internal to the organization

Correct. EEFs that may enhance or constrain project management options can be internal and/or external to the organization. The geographic distribution of company facilities is an internal EEF.

C Organizational process assets external to the organization

Incorrect. Organizational process assets (OPAs) include any artifact, practice, or knowledge from any or all the performing organizations involved in the project that can be used to execute or govern the project. There are no external OPAs. OPAs are always internal to an organization.

D Organizational process assets internal to the organization

Incorrect. Organizational process assets (OPAs) are the plans, processes, policies, procedures, and knowledge bases specific to and used by the performing organization. OPAs are always internal to the organization. While company facilities are internal to the organization, they are not considered OPAs because they are not under the direct control of the project team.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 38; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain 1, Task 4

PMP Exam 1

Question 33

You are managing a project to build 100 site towers, and you have just completed building the 50th tower. To mark the successful completion of this first significant milestone, you hold a celebration where you share the developments, challenges, and lessons learned so far on the project.

In what process will you use this information and knowledge gained so far to improve the future performance of the project?

A Control Quality

B Perform Continuous Improvement

C Manage Quality

D Direct and Manage Project Work

Answer: D

Hint:

You are gathering lessons learned and using them to improve the future performance of the project.

Explanation:

This scenario showcases the iterative nature of a project. Work performance data, collected during project execution, is transformed into work performance information and is used as an input to the Monitor and Control Project Work process which provides feedback into the lessons learned register. The lessons learned from which the project can benefit are then translated into

change requests which are subsequently implemented in the Direct and Manage Project Work process to improve the future performance of the project. You are using the celebration of the first milestone to reflect on the lessons learned to date and to highlight how to incorporate them into the remainder of the project. Therefore, it is the Direct and Manage Project Work process where information and knowledge gained throughout the project will be used to improve the future performance of the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Control Quality

Incorrect. Control Quality is the process of determining the correctness of the deliverables. Some of the improvement suggestions presented at the celebration may have come from the Control Quality process; however, they will be implemented as part of the Direct and Manage Project Work process.

B Perform Continuous Improvement

Incorrect. 'Perform Continuous Improvement' is not a process specified in the PMBOK® Guide.

C Manage Quality

Incorrect. Manage Quality focuses on whether the processes in use are effective in meeting the quality requirements needed to satisfy the customer. This process is not used to implement improvement suggestions that come from project execution.

D Direct and Manage Project Work

Correct. The Direct and Manage Project Work process involves not only the implementation of planned project activities but also any approved changes submitted as a result of improvement suggestions identified throughout the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 92, 298

PMP Exam 1

Question 34

During the development of the project management plan and before establishing baselines, the project manager is asked by a key stakeholder to add a critical feature that will slightly extend the project schedule and cost.

What should the project manager do?

A Ask the stakeholder to submit a change request to change control board

B Submit a change request on behalf of the stakeholder and ask them to sign it

C Reject the stakeholder's request

D Update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder

Answer: D

Hint:

The project is in its planning and the baselines have not been established.

Explanation:

The project management plan is baselined and approved before the project enters its execution. Baselines (scope, cost, schedule) are part of the project management plan. As long as the baselines are not established, as in this situation, the project management plan can be modified as many times as necessary. No change request is needed in this situation. Therefore, among the choices provided, updating the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Ask the stakeholder to submit a change request to change control board

Incorrect. The project management plan is being developed, and the baselines (scope, cost, schedule) have not been finalized nor has the project management plan been approved. Before baselining and the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan.

B Submit a change request on behalf of the stakeholder and ask them to sign it

Incorrect. The project management plan is being developed, and the baselines (scope, cost, schedule) have not been finalized nor has the project management plan been approved. Before baselining and the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan.

C Reject the stakeholder's request

Incorrect. While it is the project managers job to monitor and control changes in project scope, there is no indication where in the planning process the project is and more importantly before the baselining and the approval of the project management plan, requests of this type are typical and should be expected.

D Update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder

Correct. The scenario describes a project in planning where neither the project management plan nor the baselines (which are the components of the plan) have been approved. Before the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan as many times as needed. Therefore, the project manager can update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 83

PMP Exam 1

Question 35

In the midst of the software development project, one of the five programmers working on the project has been reassigned. If not addressed, this situation will cause the project to miss the delivery date. The only available options at this point are to crash the schedule by paying overtime to the remaining four programmers or pay the penalty for late delivery as outlined in the contract.

What is the best data analysis tool or technique to use to determine whether to crash the schedule or pay the penalty?

A Performance reviews

B Alternatives analysis

C Trend analysis

D Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis

Answer: B

Hint:

During the Control Resources process, what data analysis technique can be used to select the best resolution between two choices?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the Control Resources process is carried out. Data analysis techniques including alternatives analysis may be used during the Control Resources process. Alternatives can be analyzed to select the best resolution for correcting variances in resource utilization. In the situation described in the question, the alternatives of paying the overtime can be weighed against the penalty for delivering late. Therefore, alternatives analysis would be the best data analysis technique to use in this situation.

Note, the Control Resources process is concerned with physical resources, while the Develop Team focuses on human resources. Technically speaking, the alternatives analysis is one of the tools/techniques of the Control Resources process and not the Develop Team process. However, this does not mean the alternatives analysis cannot be applied in other circumstances or processes. As we frequently recommend in the explanations to our questions, the goal is to select the best answer among the choices given. It will not always be the ideal/perfect answer that you would prefer to see as the correct choice. Sometimes you will have to eliminate the worst three choices and stay with a bad one, but it should be better than the others, the lesser of four evils if you wish. Other times, all four choices may seem correct, so, again, you would have to select the one which is better than the others. Under the circumstances described in this particular scenario and with the given set of the answer choices, alternatives analysis is the best answer to the question asked. I hope this clarifies the question and the correct answer to your satisfaction.

Details for Each Option:

A Performance reviews

Incorrect. Performance reviews can be used in the Control Resources process to measure, compare, and analyze planned resource utilization to actual resource utilization. The question describes a situation where one can select from two alternatives to resolve the issue. Performance reviews would not help in this situation.

B Alternatives analysis

Correct. Alternatives can be analyzed to select the best resolution for correcting variances in resource utilization. In the situation described in the question, the alternatives of paying the overtime can be weighed against the penalty for a later delivery. Therefore, alternatives analysis would be the correct data analysis technique in this scenario.

C Trend analysis

Incorrect. Trend analysis can be used in the Control Resources process to determine the resources needed at upcoming stages of the project based on current performance information. This is not what is described in the question.

D Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis is a project management process and not a tool or technique.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 356

Question 36

A_project manager who is in drafting the project charter for a new project, recalls a similar past project that was terminated early. The project manager thinks that the details of the past project's performance may be beneficial for this project.

What is the best course of action for the project manager?

A Research the organizational process assets (OPAs)

B Every project is unique, so information from previous projects is irrelevant

C Review the lessons learned register of the current project

D Check the enterprise environmental factors (EEF)

Answer: A

Hint:

How is historical information about past projects including the lessons learned repository stored for future reference?

Explanation:

The question states that the project manager is developing the project charter for a new project and suggests that information from a previous project may be beneficial in this process. The OPAs should contain historical information from past projects, including project performance and knowledge gained. Knowledge gained from past projects is captured in the lessons learned repository as an OPA. Understanding the reasons for the previous project's early termination may help the project manager avoid the same fate for the current project. Therefore, of the available options, the best course of action for the project manager is to check the OPAs to glean any information from the past project which may benefit the current project.

Details for Each Option:

A Research the organizational process assets (OPAs)

Correct. The OPAs should contain historical information from past projects including project performance and lessons learned.

B Every project is unique, so information from previous projects is irrelevant

Incorrect. Every project is unique, but many projects may have similarities. Knowledge is gained during the execution of every project, and this information can be used to improve the performance of future projects. Ignoring lessons learned from past projects will likely result in repeating the same mistakes.

C Review the lessons learned register of the current project

Incorrect. The lessons learned register might contain knowledge gained from the current project which may be beneficial in improving the future performance of the project. However, since the project has not yet been authorized, a lessons learned register is unlikely to exist at this point and would not have information regarding the performance of past projects.

D Check the enterprise environmental factors (EEF)

Incorrect. A project manager is seeking historical information that is typically contained in the organizational process assets (OPAs), and are not EEFs, which are conditions, not under the immediate control of the team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 79

Question 37

A_company wants to change its product packaging from less expensive plastic to a biodegradable material. As the project manager reads the business case for the project, it becomes clear that the project is not mandatory and will incur costs, but the stated goal is something other than generating additional revenue or improving profitability.

What is the most likely justification outlined in the business case?

A Legal requirement

B Ecological impact

C Market demand

D Organizational need

Answer: B

Hint:

Why would a company fund a project that is not required and will not be profitable?

Explanation:

There are many reasons for a company to authorize a project, and most of those justifications are either mandated or provide financial benefits. However, a project to lessen environmental impacts is an example of a project that a company may choose to authorize even though it may not be profitable. In this question scenario, the company wants to change its product packaging from less expensive plastic to a biodegradable material. Of the available choices, ecological impact is the best answer for a justification of a discretionary project that will incur costs but does not have a stated goal of generating revenue or improving profitability.

Details for Each Option:

A Legal requirement

Incorrect. Meeting a legal requirement will incur costs and may not generate revenue. A legal requirement would typically force a company to undertake a mandatory project which is not the case described in the scenario.

B Ecological impact

Correct. A company authorizing a project to lessen its environmental impact is an example of a project that will incur costs and may not have a stated goal of generating revenue or improving profitability. While a "side effect" of being an environmentally-friendly company is potential additional revenue from the environmentalists, increased revenue or improved profitability are not the stated objectives of the project.

C Market demand

Incorrect. Responding to a market demand is a common justification for a project. For example, an automobile manufacturer may authorize a project to create an electric car in response to increasing gasoline prices. Although a project in response to market demand is not mandatory, the justification is based on an additional revenue or increased profitability.

D Organizational need

Incorrect. An example of an organizational need is a project to restructure a company to reduce redundant activities and streamline processes. While the project itself may incur costs and not generate revenue, the goal is to improve profitability.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 77, 78

PMP Exam 1

Question 38

You are managing a project that is currently in the closing stage. You want to confirm that all deliverables were accepted, validate that the exit criteria have been met, evaluate the satisfaction of stakeholders, and gather lesson learned.

What should you do?

A Conduct data analysis

B Obtain expert judgment

C Hold meetings

D Validate scope

Answer: C

Hint:

What is the best method of obtaining feedback from several groups of people?

Explanation:

The scenario suggests the Close Project or Phase process is underway. Meetings are one of the tools and techniques of this process and can be used to confirm that the deliverables have been accepted, to validate that the exit criteria have been met, to evaluate the satisfaction of the stakeholders, to gather lessons learned, and to celebrate success. Types of meetings include but are not limited to close-out reporting meetings, customer wrap-up meetings, lessons learned meetings, and celebration meetings. Meetings may include several groups of people such as stakeholders and project team members. Therefore, of the choices provided, to confirm that all

deliverables were accepted, validate that the exit criteria have been met, evaluate the satisfaction of stakeholders, and gather lesson learned, holding a meeting is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Conduct data analysis

Incorrect. Data analysis can be used in project closeout as one of the tools or techniques of the Close Project or Phase process. However, data analysis is a tool which is specific to analyzing and evaluating information that can further be used to improve performance on future projects. Data analysis is unlikely to help you to confirm that all deliverables were accepted, validate that the exit criteria have been met, and evaluate the satisfaction of stakeholders.

B Obtain expert judgment

Incorrect. Expert judgment is among the tools and techniques that can be used during the Close Project or Phase project to obtain expertise on the topics such as management control, audit, legal and procurement, and legislation and regulation. While expert judgment may help you confirm some of the points requested in the scenario, expert judgment will likely not help you to evaluate the satisfaction of stakeholders.

C Hold meetings

Correct. Meetings are an effective technique used in the closing stage to confirm that the deliverables have been accepted, to validate that the exit criteria have been met, to evaluate the satisfaction of the stakeholders, to gather lessons learned, and to celebrate success. This description closely matches what you want to achieve in the scenario described. Therefore, holding a meeting is the best answer to the question asked.

D Validate scope

Incorrect. You are in the closing phase of your project. You would have already validated the scope and formalized acceptance of project deliverables during the monitoring and controlling stage of your project. Therefore, validating scope at this point would be a redundant and unnecessary action.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 127

PMP Exam 1

Question 39

Halfway into a software development project, your most experienced programmer resigns leaving only two programmers. The previously planned response to this risk is to acquire a programmer from another project manager, with whom you are not well acquainted.

What is the best way for you to handle this situation?

A Escalate to the project sponsor

B Ask the remaining two programmers to work overtime to cover the gap

C Use your soft skills

D Use your authority as a project manager and demand the release of the other programmer

Answer: C

Hint:

What tool or technique of the Implement Risk Responses process is helpful to encourage someone to take necessary action?

Explanation:

The question implies that the Implement Risk Responses process is being conducted. One of the tools and techniques used as part of the Implement Risk Responses process is that of interpersonal and team skills including influencing. Interpersonal and team skills are also known as soft skills. As the project manager, you will need to demonstrate your influencing skills in order to encourage the other project manager to take the necessary action of releasing a programmer to cover the gap created by the resignation. While there is no guarantee that the other project manager will agree to release the resource, using your soft skills is the best way to handle this issue.

Details for Each Option:

A Escalate to the project sponsor

Incorrect. Escalating to the project sponsor is a premature action. Project managers should first try to resolve the issue directly with the involved party, and only when no options are found, resort to escalation.

B Ask the remaining two programmers to work overtime to cover the gap

Incorrect. Acquiring a programmer from another project, not paying overtime, is the response planned for this risk. Therefore, this choice is not the best answer to the question asked. If the planned risk response does not work, you can explore other options, including paying overtime.

C Use your soft skills

Correct. Interpersonal and team skills are sometimes known as soft skills. In this situation, the interpersonal and team skill of influencing can be used to gain the release of a programmer for the project.

D Use your authority as a project manager and demand the release of the other programmer

Incorrect. The question does not suggest that you have any authority over the other project manager. Additionally, it is unlikely that demanding the release of the resource will work better than politely requesting this using your soft skills.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 451, 357

PMP Exam 1

Question 40

A_client was very specific about what they wanted to be included in the final product. While reviewing the schematics, the project manager notices some features that she doesn't recall being part of the project scope.

What analysis should be undertaken to determine if the features in question are in line with the project's scope baseline?

A Alternative analysis

B Variance analysis

C Cost-benefit analysis

D Value analysis

Answer: B

Hint:

What technique used in the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group is concerned with maintaining scope baseline integrity and preventing scope creep?

Explanation:

Variance analysis is a technique used in the Control Scope process to identify differences between the scope baseline and actual output. Think of the Control Scope process as an ongoing internal mechanism for the project manager to monitor any variation in the project's scope, not only to avoid scope creep but to ensure any change goes through the proper change control procedure. Therefore, variance analysis is the best tool to use to determine if the features in question are in line with the project's scope baseline.

Details for Each Option:

A Alternative analysis

Incorrect. An alternative analysis is a technique used to evaluate options in order to select the best approach to execute and perform the work of the project. An alternative analysis is not used to assess whether the project is deviating from the scope baseline.

B Variance analysis

Correct. Variance analysis is a popular technique for determining the cause and degree of difference between the scope baseline and actual performance.

C Cost-benefit analysis

Incorrect. Cost-benefit analysis is a financial method used to weigh the project's benefits versus its cost. It is not used to assess whether the project is deviating from the scope baseline.

D Value analysis

Incorrect. Value analysis is an example of product analysis. It is not used to assess whether the project is deviating from the scope baseline.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 111, 170

PMP Exam 1

Question 41

In the design phase, external experts verified that the team's blueprints for a new crane complied with requirements. During the build phase, the customer performed a walkthrough and found that some welding joints on the crane were defective. The crane needs to be reworked to ensure it can be operated safely.

How could this situation have been avoided?

A Outsourcing the welding to an external vendor

B Testing the welding before the customer walkthrough

C Using the requirements traceability matrix

D Defects are part of any project and cannot be avoided.

Answer: B

Hint:

The team built the product after receiving authorization. They should have prevented the customer from finding defects.

Explanation:

The question describes a situation in which the project team completed the design phase of the project and began building the product. However, it appears the team did not sufficiently test the work done on the welding, which is part of the Control Quality process. This process is carried out to ensure the project outputs are complete, correct, and meet customer expectations before the customer accepts the deliverables as part of the Validate Scope process. As a result of not performing the Control Quality process, defects were found in the crane when the customer held a walkthrough. If the team carried out the Control Quality process properly, it is likely the defective welding would have been discovered, corrected, and the situation described in the scenario avoided.

Details for Each Option:

A Outsourcing the welding to an external vendor

Incorrect. There is not enough information in the question to determine if outsourcing welding to an external vendor would have avoided the situation described in the question.

B Testing the welding before the customer walkthrough

Correct. Testing the welding is part of the Control Quality process, which is the process of monitoring and recording the results of executing the quality management activities to assess performance and ensure the project outputs are complete, correct, and meet customer expectations. It should be performed before the customer accepts the deliverables during the Validate Scope process described in the scenario, thus preventing the issue presented by the question.

C Using the requirements traceability matrix

Incorrect. A requirements traceability matrix is a grid that links product requirements from their origin to the deliverables that satisfy them. The matrix is good for tracking stakeholder requirements throughout the life of the project but does not list the 'total' scope of work to be carried out by the team to accomplish project objectives, nor does it ensure the work is performed to the quality standards.

D Defects are part of any project and cannot be avoided.

Incorrect. While it is true that defects are likely to happen in almost any project, there are many tools and techniques that may proactively help the project team to detect defects and fix them before the customer accepts the deliverables.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 298, 303-304

PMP Exam 1

Question 42

Late in a project, a key team member leaves the company. The project manager realizes that he does not have enough team members to meet the hard deadline. At a weekly status meeting, the project manager discusses several options with his project team, including authorizing additional overtime, hiring subcontractors, or bringing in additional resources from another project team within the company.

Which resource management technique does the project manager use?

A Cost-benefit analysis

B Alternatives analysis

C Problem solving

D Interpersonal skills

Answer: B

Hint:

Which technique involves the evaluation of the different choices available to achieve a particular project management objective?

Explanation:

After analyzing several different options to determine which of those options will most help the team meet the objectives of the project, the project manager is selecting a corrective action to address his resource needs. This method is an example of alternatives analysis - a technique used in the Control Resources process. The other answer choices are also techniques used in the Control Resources process but based on the specific actions being described in this scenario; alternatives analysis emerges as the best choice.

Note, the PMBOK® Guide refers to Control Resource as a process concerned with physical resources, while the question describes a scenario with human resources which is typically addressed by the Manage Team process. The fact the alternatives analysis technique is associated with the Control Resource process and not the Manage Team process does not mean the technique cannot be used in other processes to resolve issues the project manager is facing. In the scenario provided, the discussion the project manager is having with the team members regarding different options such as authorizing additional overtime, hiring subcontractors, or bringing in additional resources from another project team within the company is best described by the alternatives analysis technique. Therefore, among the available choices, alternatives analysis, while not ideal, is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Cost-benefit analysis

Incorrect. This type of analysis focuses on determining the best corrective action in terms of cost, but there is no indication from the question that cost was the major determining factor in the decision.

B Alternatives analysis

Correct. Alternatives analysis is a technique of the Control Resources process used to select the best resolution for correcting variances in resource utilization. Alternatives may include paying additional for overtime or additional team resources and weighing these alternatives against a late delivery or other factors.

C Problem solving

Incorrect. Problem solving involves taking methodical steps to deal with a problem. Those steps include: identifying, investigating, and analyzing the problem; choosing a solution; and checking the solution to determine if the problem has been fixed. In the scenario, the project manager is simply discussing various options. Nothing in the scenario indicates that methodical steps to deal with a problem have been taken.

D Interpersonal skills

Incorrect. Interpersonal skills, which include negotiation and influencing skills, are not the primary techniques being used in this scenario. The project manager is not negotiating with anyone for additional project resources or using influencing to solve the problem. Therefore, this is not the best answer choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 356-357

Question 43

At the end of a design project, a competitor has gained market share with a new technology that has rendered the project's deliverable obsolete. The project sponsor is pleased with the work of the project team who finished within budget and on time but thinks that the project should have been terminated much sooner.

What might have the manager of the project done differently in this situation?

A Used phases and phase gates

B Established a change control board (CCB) to review and render decisions for all submitted change requests

C Terminated the project when the new technology was introduced

D Scheduled more frequent lessons learned meetings with the project team

Answer: A

Hint:

How might the project manager have introduced a periodic structured review of the viability of the project?

Explanation:

During project integration, a project manager needs to consider how to tailor the way that Project Integration Management processes are applied. Among these considerations is the project life cycle including the appropriate use of phases and phase gates. A phase gate is a review at the end of a phase in which a decision is made to continue to the next phase, to continue with modification, or to end a project. During a phase gate, the business case should be examined to determine if it is still valid or needs to be modified. In some cases, for example, changes in the competitive landscape may lead to a decision to terminate the project as the business case has been invalidated. In this scenario, the business case is no longer valid due to new technology, which was introduced in the marketplace and rendered the current product in development obsolete. Of the available options, only using a phased approach with phase gates introduces a periodic structured review of the viability of the project, making this the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Used phases and phase gates

Correct. A phase gate is a review at the end of a phase in which a decision is made to continue to the next phase, to continue with modification, or to end a project.

B Established a change control board (CCB) to review and render decisions for all submitted change requests

Incorrect. A CCB is established to review and render decisions regarding submitted change requests. However, the question does not indicate that scope creep was an issue, and a CCB does not have the authority to terminate a project.

C Terminated the project when the new technology was introduced

Incorrect. If the underlying business case for the project is no longer valid, the project manager may recommend that the project is canceled or terminated, but it is the project sponsor, not the project manager, who must determine if/when the project should be terminated.

D Scheduled more frequent lessons learned meetings with the project team

Incorrect. Lessons learned meetings should be used during project execution to improve performance for the remainder of the project. However, the question does not describe a situation where project performance was an issue. Additionally, the viability of a product in the marketplace is not the focus of a lessons learned meeting and is not likely to be discussed.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 21, 74

PMP Exam 1

Question 44

Your current project is coming to a close. You are highly satisfied with the performance of the vendors and consider to create a database of pre-qualified vendors for use in future similar projects. You have delivered the product and received formal acceptance from your customer. You are also finalizing the contractual agreements with your vendors.

In addition to these activities, what else might you do as part of this process?

A Thank all vendors for the work performed and add incentives to the payment

B Update the procurement documents with vendor details and their performance

C Capture the vendor details and their performance in the project management plan

D Issue a final report and transfer its contents to the project charter

Answer: B

Hint:

What action is required while closing procurements?

Explanation:

Based on the scenario described, you are closing procurements, an activity which is performed as part of the Control Procurements process. All procurement documentation is collected, indexed, and filed when a contract is closed. The question implies the company has plans for creating a vendor database with pre-qualified vendors. Details of these vendors such as contract, schedules, scope, quality, cost performance, payment details, and inspection details are included in the procurement documents. All this information can be used for evaluating vendors for future contracts and for building a database as suggested by the scenario.

Details for Each Option:

A Thank all vendors for the work performed and add incentives to the payment

Incorrect. While thanking the vendors for the work performed is never a bad idea, especially if you are highly satisfied with their performance, adding incentives to the vendor's final payments would only be done as outlined in the contract. There is no mention of incentives in the scenario and therefore not enough information for this to be the correct answer.

B Update the procurement documents with vendor details and their performance

Correct. The scenario mentioned that your firm is creating a database that would be used to identify pre-qualified vendors for future use on similar projects. As part of project closure, procurement documents including information on contracts, schedule, scope, quality, and inspection results are cataloged. This information can be used as a basis for evaluating vendors for future projects or creating a database of pre-qualified vendors.

C Capture the vendor details and their performance in the project management plan

Incorrect. One of the components of the project management plan is the procurement management plan. The latter contains information on how procurements will be handled during the project. The plan does not include any actual performance information, making this choice an answer incorrect.

D Issue a final report and transfer its contents to the project charter

Incorrect. A final report provides a summary of the project performance. It is issued at the end of a project and includes information on what the various criteria of the project were and how those requirements were met. The final report is an independent document whose contents are not supposed to be transferred to the project charter.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 125, 499

PMP Exam 1

Question 45

As a project manager for a small company, you have been responsible for negotiating and issuing contracts. Although your company has pre-qualified vendors, and the agreements are standard, you think the procurements should be handled by someone with more knowledge on the subject rather than the project managers.

Which of the following will you recommend?

A Decentralized purchasing

B Centralized purchasing

C Pre-qualified vendors

D Supply chain management

Answer: B

Hint:

The project manager wants to recommend a separate purchasing department.

Explanation:

For smaller organizations or startup companies and those without a purchasing, contracting, or procurement department, the project manager may assume the purchasing authority role to

negotiate and sign contracts directly. This is called decentralized purchasing and is the situation described in the scenario. More mature organizations have a separate department responsible for the actual procurement and contracting functions which is referred to as centralized purchasing. Even though the organization described in the scenario is small, implying procurements can be managed by project managers, you feel there is a lack of relevant knowledge in procurement among the project managers. Therefore, under the circumstances provided in the question, it is reasonable for you to recommend that the organization switch to a centralized purchasing environment.

Details for Each Option:

A Decentralized purchasing

Incorrect. In a company using decentralized purchasing, there is no purchasing, contracting, or procurement department. The project manager may assume the purchasing authority to negotiate and sign contracts directly. This is the type of environment described in the scenario; therefore, it would not be an improvement, nor a change.

B Centralized purchasing

Correct. In a centralized purchasing environment, the actual procurement and contracting functions are carried out by a separate department with the specific role and authority to purchase, negotiate, and sign contracts. Project managers would not be responsible for conducting procurements in this type of organizational structure.

C Pre-qualified vendors

Incorrect. The company already uses pre-qualified vendors as described in the scenario. Therefore, this would not be the change you are seeking.

D Supply chain management

Incorrect. Supply chain management is an emerging practice in procurement management responding to the global nature of projects and the use of international suppliers. In this scenario, there is no mention of foreign suppliers. You want someone instead of the project manager to conduct procurements. Therefore, this is not a correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 462, 464

PMP Exam 1

Question 46

One of the key deliverables on a project has been found to contain a defect, and it does not meet the project requirements. To scrap the deliverable and replace it would cost $12,000 and take five days to complete. To repair the defect would cost $4,000 and take two days to complete.

What should the project manager do first?

A Submit a change request

B Repair the defective deliverable as it will have the least impact on the budget and schedule

C Consult with the project sponsor

D Scrap and replace the defective deliverable as it will increase customer satisfaction

Answer: A

Hint:

Which output of the Direct and Manage Project Work process would be applicable in this scenario?

Explanation:

In this scenario, a key deliverable does not meet project requirements. Whether the deliverable is replaced or repaired, a change request is required. In the scenario provided, only cost and schedule constraints have been analyzed so far. Additional project aspects, such as risk, quality, customer satisfaction, etc. should be considered to render a decision. Therefore, in this situation, of the choices provided, a change request should be submitted first to conduct further analysis and assess the impacts of the change on all project constraints.

Details for Each Option:

A Submit a change request

Correct. If the deliverable is replaced, a change request is required. If the deliverable is repaired, the change request may be required depending on the change management process defined for the project. Since there is no answer choice that makes this differentiation, of the available options, submitting a change request is the best answer to the question asked.

B Repair the defective deliverable as it will have the least impact on the budget and schedule

Incorrect. Regardless of what action, either a replacement or a repair of the deliverable, has the least impact on the budget and schedule, the action cannot be approved without submitting a change request first and assessing the impacts of the change on all project constraints.

C Consult with the project sponsor

Incorrect. There is not enough information in the question suggesting that the involvement of the project sponsor is required. Therefore, consulting with the project sponsor is not the first thing the project manager should do.

D Scrap and replace the defective deliverable as it will increase customer satisfaction

Incorrect. There is not enough information in the question to determine whether or not the replacement deliverable will increase customer satisfaction. Regardless of what action, either a replacement or a repair of the deliverable, will increase customer satisfaction, the action cannot be approved without submitting a change request first and assessing the impacts of the change on all project constraints.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 96

PMP Exam 1

Question 47

The project you are leading is in planning, and you know that some of the stakeholders are unsupportive.

What is your best course of action to increase the support of these stakeholders?

A Perform a communication styles assessment

B Remove the unsupportive stakeholders from the project

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

D Update the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix

Answer: A

Hint:

Understanding the way people interact and share information will likely improve your ability to influence non-supportive stakeholders.

Explanation:

According to the scenario, the project is in planning. A communication styles assessment is one of the tools and techniques that can be employed as part of the Plan Communications Management process. Often used with unsupportive stakeholders, a communication styles assessment may follow a stakeholder's engagement assessment to identify gaps in stakeholder engagement. As a result, communications can be tailored to the stakeholders' preferences. The adjustment in communications can lead to more positive interactions, build trust, increase support, minimize resistance and thereby influence the stakeholders in a positive way. For those reasons, performing a communication styles assessment is the best answer among the choices given.

Details for Each Option:

A Perform a communication styles assessment

Correct. A communication styles assessment is a technique that used to assess communication styles and identify the preferred communication method, format, and content for planned communication activities. By understanding the stakeholders' communication styles, you can tailor project communications to meet the needs of the unsupportive stakeholders and hopefully improve their support for the project.

B Remove the unsupportive stakeholders from the project

Incorrect. This action seems neither reasonable nor realistic. It is unlikely that the project manager has the authority to 'remove' stakeholders from the project. Instead of thinking about how to isolate the unsupportive stakeholders, the project manager should act towards engaging them.

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

Incorrect. The escalation to the project sponsor is premature. This action may actually have a negative effect and make the situation worse. It is the responsibility of the project manager to

engage with the stakeholders and make the necessary efforts to increase their support of the project.

D Update the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix

Incorrect. A stakeholder engagement assessment matrix shows the current level of engagement by stakeholders compared with the desired level of engagement necessary for successful project completion. The question is asking about how to increase the support of the stakeholders. While the matrix should be updated to reflect the engagement level of the unsupportive stakeholders, a mere update to the matrix would not increase their support.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 375, 521

PMP Exam 1

Question 48

A_project manager presents a project status update in a steering committee weekly meeting. A senior executive who attends the meeting for the first time, asks various questions about all

aspects of the project and insists on extensive changes. After the meeting, the sponsor informs the project manager that the senior executive joined the company just a few days ago.

What should the project manager do first?

A Ask the sponsor to increase management reserves to cover the cost of the changes requested by the executive

B Update the stakeholder register and power/interest grid to account for changes in the stakeholder community

C Instruct the project team to implement all the changes that have been requested by the senior executive

D Look for ways to limit the senior executive's involvement since she was not involved in the initial planning

Answer: B

Hint:

Record any changes or issues that arise through the course of the project.

Explanation:

Part of the Monitor Stakeholder Engagement process is updating project documents. At the steering committee meeting, when the project manager presented the project update to keep the stakeholders informed, engaged, and supportive, the project manager identified the senior executive as a new stakeholder. The senior executive appears to be an interested and influential stakeholder that has joined the company just a few days ago and obviously had not been part of the project earlier during the Identify Stakeholders process. Therefore, the first thing the project manager should do after the meeting is to add the senior executive to the stakeholder register and record her power and influence.

Details for Each Option:

A Ask the sponsor to increase management reserves to cover the cost of the changes requested by the executive

Incorrect. Management reserves are used to cover the cost of unknown unknowns, which are typically associated with risks. While the changes requested by the executive may introduce new unidentified risks to the project, or even be considered unknown unknowns as by themselves, increasing management reserves without analyzing the impact of the changes on project constraints is a premature action.

B Update the stakeholder register and power/interest grid to account for changes in the stakeholder community

Correct. Based on the scenario described, the senior executive has been identified as a new stakeholder. The project manager should first add the senior executive to the stakeholder register and record his interest and influence on the project so that his expectations can be appropriately managed.

C Instruct the project team to implement all the changes that have been requested by the senior executive

Incorrect. Implementing changes without submitting corresponding change requests first goes against proper project management practices.

D Look for ways to limit the senior executive's involvement since she was not involved in the initial planning

Incorrect. The project manager must monitor and manage stakeholder engagement. The project manager should be looking for ways to engage stakeholders and meet their expectations, not to limit or avoid their involvement.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 530, 536

PMP Exam 1

Question 49

The project manager arranges a series of planning meetings with the functional manager, project sponsor, and key project team members to determine the type and quantity of materials and hardware needed to complete the project. They also discuss the required skill levels of each team resource to be brought to the project and the level of effort needed to complete each activity in the work packages.

Which of the following documents is the project team least likely to produce as a result of these planning meetings?

A Resource requirements

B Project team assignments

C Basis of estimates

D Resource breakdown structure

Answer: B

Hint:

Find three outputs of the Estimate Activity Resources process and eliminate them as incorrect answer choices.

Explanation:

According to the scenario, the team is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process by holding planning meetings to determine resource needs for the project. Project team assignments, however, are a key output of the Acquire Resources process which is carried out later in the project life cycle, as part of project execution. Project team assignments is a project document that records the team members and their roles and responsibilities for the project. Recording this information can only be done after the team is acquired. Since the project is still in planning, and no information is provided in the scenario as to whether or not pre-assignment took place earlier

in the project, it can be assumed that the project team assignments document cannot be created at this point, making it the least likely outcome of the planning meetings described in the scenario. All of the other answer choices are key outputs of the Estimate Activity Resources process and can, therefore, be eliminated.

If you have selected an incorrect answer, this could be because you may have missed the word 'least' in the last sentence of the question. This could be a frustrating experience. However, it is important to understand that these types of questions may appear on the actual exam. Therefore, carefully reading the question text is an important part of practicing and preparing for the exam.

Details for Each Option:

A Resource requirements

Incorrect. The project manager is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process by holding planning meetings to determine the resources needed for the project. Resource requirements are one of the outputs of the Estimate Activity Resources process.

B Project team assignments

Correct. The team is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process by holding planning meetings to determine the resources needed for the project. Project team assignments, however, are a key output of the Acquire Resources process. The project team would have to acquire the team members first, then they could record the team members and their roles and responsibilities for the project.

C Basis of estimates

Incorrect. The scenario implies that the Estimate Activity Resources process is carried out. Basis of estimates is one of the outputs of this process.

D Resource breakdown structure

Incorrect. According to the scenario, the project manager is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process by holding planning meetings to determine the resources needed for the project. The resource breakdown structure is one of the outputs of this process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 325-326, 334

PMP Exam 1

Question 50

Which statement would you use to correctly explain the tools and techniques of the Manage Communications process to your project team?

A Political awareness can be useful in helping the project manager maintain stakeholder support throughout a project.

B An organization's culture is not a factor that influences the organization's communication technology.

C Once a communication method is established with the membership of the stakeholder community, it should not be changed.

D Presentations should consider the needs and expectations of the audience rather than the needs of the project team.

Answer: A

Hint:

Effective communication should involve flexibility in methodology and awareness of an organization’s environment and should take the needs of all involved in the project into consideration.

Explanation:

The key benefit to properly managing project communication is that it enables an efficient and effective flow of information between the project team and stakeholders. This often requires effective use of interpersonal and team skills such as political awareness to understand the power structures and relationships and how to work within them. These skills can assist project managers in properly engaging stakeholders to maintain their support throughout the project. When managing communication, a project manager must take into account the flexibility and possible adjustments that may be required to accommodate the needs and maintain the support of the stakeholder community.

Details for Each Option:

A Political awareness can be useful in helping the project manager maintain stakeholder support throughout a project.

Correct. Political awareness involves the recognition of power relationships and the ability to work within those structures. This would include understanding the power structure of the stakeholder community on any project and fostering relationships accordingly. All of which will assist in maintaining stakeholder support throughout the project lifecycle.

B An organization's culture is not a factor that influences the organization's communication technology.

Incorrect. There are several factors that influence technology within an organization including its culture and the culture's influence on how meetings and discussions are normally conducted.

C Once a communication method is established with the membership of the stakeholder community, it should not be changed.

Incorrect. Options for communication methods during the Manage Communications process should be flexible in the event of changes in the needs and expectations of the stakeholder community.

D Presentations should consider the needs and expectations of the audience rather than the needs of the project team.

Incorrect. During presentations, the audience, their needs and expectations, as well as the needs and objectives of the project and project team should be taken into account.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 386, 383, 376

PMP Exam 1

Question 51

During the closure of an internal process improvement project, the project manager confirms that one of the improved processes transitioned into operations resulted in a significant improvement in that unit's efficiency.

In which of the following would the project manager record this information?

A The benefits management plan

B The project management plan

C The final report

D The business case

Answer: C

Hint:

What document is compared with business documents created during initiation to help to determine project success?

Explanation:

According to the question, the project is in the Close Project or Phase process. The final report is an output of this process and provides the summary of the project performance, including information such as the summary level description of the project or phase, scope, cost, schedule, and quality objectives, and the summary of how the final product, service or result achieved the business needs identified in the business plan. Since news of this benefit/objective was received during project closure, it is recorded in the projects final report as a tangible benefit and an example of project success. The final report is reviewed with business documents created during initiation to aid in determining overall project success.

Details for Each Option:

A The benefits management plan

Incorrect. The benefits management plan is created before the project is initiated and is commonly referenced during the project, i.e., to identify a stakeholder such as a benefits owner, etc. This plan and business case are reviewed during and after the project closure to assess the project's success. The plan is not modified to record benefits achieved as they are recorded in the final report and subsequently compared to the benefits management plan and business case.

B The project management plan

Incorrect. The project management plan is created during the planning phase and describes how the project will be executed, monitored and controlled and closed. The plan can and is often updated to reflect changes in the project which are approved through change management procedures. The project management plan, however, is not updated during project closure to record benefits realized as a result of the project.

C The final report

Correct. The final report is prepared during project closure and provides a summary of the project performance. The final product(s), services delivered, and other results are recorded and summarized to demonstrate how these accomplishments achieved the benefits and objectives described in the business case and the benefits management plan.

D The business case

Incorrect. The business case is an economic feasibility and cost-benefit study used to identify reasons and benefits to the organization that justifies initiating the project. While the business case is used and referenced throughout the project, it is not used to record business benefits realized at project closure. These are recorded in the final report which is reviewed with the business case and benefits management plan as a measure of overall project success.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 127-128

PMP Exam 1

Question 52

A_project manager is about to start the process of identifying quality requirements and standards for an infrastructure project. The project manager examines the project charter to gain a high-level understanding of project objectives and reviews relevant information from the available components of the project management plan.

What else should the project manager do to gather inputs to the process?

A Review the requirements documentation to gain an understanding of the project and product quality requirements

B Conduct a brainstorming session with the project team and subject matter experts to develop the quality management plan

C Perform a cost-benefit analysis to determine if the planned quality activities are cost-effective

D Update the lessons learned register with information on challenges encountered in the quality planning process

Answer: A

Hint:

What action that serves as an input to the Plan Quality Management process still needs to be completed?

Explanation:

Plan Quality Management is the process of identifying quality requirements and standards for the project and its deliverables which is what is described in the scenario provided. The project charter and components of the project management plan are inputs to the Plan Quality Management process, which have already been reviewed as per the scenario. Project documents including the requirements documentation are also inputs to the Plan Quality Management process. Project management best practices include gathering all relevant information in the form of inputs before applying the tools and techniques to produce the outputs. Therefore, of the available options, to begin the Plan Quality Management process, reviewing the requirements documentation is the next logical step for the project manager to take.

Note, requirements documentation is not a component of the project management plan. Rather, requirements documentation is considered a project document. Therefore, this part of the question text, "The project manager has reviewed... relevant information from the available components of the project management plan." refers only to the components of the project management plan, not the project documents, implying requirements documentation has not yet been reviewed.

Details for Each Option:

A Review the requirements documentation to gain an understanding of the project and product quality requirements

Correct. The question suggests that the Plan Quality Management process is about to begin. Project documents including the requirements documentation are inputs to this process.

B Conduct a brainstorming session with the project team and subject matter experts to develop the quality management plan

Incorrect. A brainstorming session is one of the tools and techniques of the Plan Quality Management process implied by the scenario. However, before a brainstorming session can begin, the actions related to collecting the process inputs should be completed. Then, information gained from the inputs will likely be used during the brainstorming session.

C Perform a cost-benefit analysis to determine if the planned quality activities are cost-effective

Incorrect. One of the tools and techniques used during the Plan Quality Management process suggested by the scenario is a cost-benefit analysis. A cost-benefit analysis is used to determine if the planned quality activities are cost-effective. The question indicates that a review of project documents that serve as inputs into this process have yet to be completed. Hence, quality activities have yet to be planned, and, therefore, a cost-benefit analysis would not be possible.

D Update the lessons learned register with information on challenges encountered in the quality planning process

Incorrect. The question implies that the Plan Quality Management process is underway, and the project manager is still gathering the inputs for this process. It is unlikely that any lessons learned have been gained at this point in the process. Additionally, updating project documents including the lessons learned register are outputs of the Plan Quality Management process, while the question is looking for an additional input.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 280, 89

PMP Exam 1

Question 53

You are the project manager for a project that is in its early stages. During a meeting, your boss informs you that senior management would like you to include a particular staff member on your project team because of their necessary expertise. You have not recruited any other team members, and the project has not even been formally authorized yet.

How should you handle senior management's request?

A Deny the request because the project manager should be the one to acquire project resources.

B Accept the request, since identifying specific resources for the project can occur as part of the early planning process.

C Accept the request only after you have finished creating the project management plan.

D Deny the request since you have not had an opportunity to verify that the individual has the proper skills.

Answer: B

Hint:

Pre-assignment is when physical or team resources for a project are determined in advance, often as part of a competitive proposal or if the project is dependent upon the expertise of particular persons.

Explanation:

Pre-assignment is a formally defined tool of the Acquire Resources process. It involves identifying physical or team resources for a project in advance and is often used when a project is dependent upon the expertise of particular persons. In this scenario, senior management has requested a particular individual for the project team because of their necessary expertise. Therefore, the project manager should accept the request. Although denying the request until the project manager has had a chance to verify the skills of a pre-assigned resource may seem like

the best answer of those provided, it is not. The project manager can make that assessment if necessary without denying the pre-assignment request and it shouldn't be assumed the project manager has the expertise to verify the resources expertise.

Details for Each Option:

A Deny the request because the project manager should be the one to acquire project resources.

Incorrect. Pre-assignment may occur as part of the Acquire Resources process, even before the project management plan has been completed. Assigning resources to a project is not necessarily the sole responsibility of the project manager.

B Accept the request, since identifying specific resources for the project can occur as part of the early planning process.

Correct. This scenario describes pre-assignment, which is the act of determining physical or team resources for a project in advance. This can occur during the Develop Project Charter process or other processes before the initial resource management plan has been completed.

C Accept the request only after you have finished creating the project management plan.

Incorrect. Pre-assignment is a technique that can be used during the initial stages of a project to identify specific resources, before the project management plan or project charter has been completed.

D Deny the request since you have not had an opportunity to verify that the individual has the proper skills.

Incorrect. Though there is merit to questioning whether or not a resource has the proper skills, there is nothing stated in the question that implies this would be necessary. There will be times when the project manager will need to defer to the expertise of others, such as senior management, SMEs, etc.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 333

PMP Exam 1

Question 54

You are selecting the appropriate contract agreement for your project. The services to be provided will be well-defined. The schedule and price will be agreed up front. You expect that there will be no significant change in the work to be performed. The contract will include criteria that you and the seller agree on that will allow the seller additional earnings for completing the project work early.

What type of contract should you select?

A Firm fixed price (FFP)

B Cost plus incentive fee (CPIF)

C Cost plus award fee (CPAF)

D Fixed price incentive fee (FPIF)

Answer: D

Hint:

Which contract type is based on a fixed-price and incentive amount for additional earnings?

Explanation:

Contract types are split into two broad categories, fixed-price and cost-reimbursable. A third hybrid contract type, time and material, combines aspects of both fixed-price and cost-reimbursable. The elements described in this question point to the fixed price incentive fee (FPIF) contract as the most appropriate selection. This type of contract involves the buyer and the seller agreeing on a set price for the work to be performed at the outset of the contract and ties incentives to achieving agreed-upon performance metrics. Under this contract type, a price ceiling can be set, and the seller is responsible for costs that exceed the ceiling.

Details for Each Option:

A Firm fixed price (FFP)

Incorrect. The firm fixed price (FFP), the most commonly used contract type, involves setting a fixed total price for a defined product, service, or result but does not include the incentive option described in this question.

B Cost plus incentive fee (CPIF)

Incorrect. The cost plus incentive fee (CPIF) contract type is used when the scope of work is expected to change significantly during the project and involves reimbursements for allowable costs for work performed by the seller versus a set price.

C Cost plus award fee (CPAF)

Incorrect. The cost plus award fee (CPAF) contract type is used when the scope of work is expected to change significantly during the project and is not based on a fixed price as described in this question. Instead, it involves reimbursements for actual costs incurred for work completed and award fees are earned solely on the buyer's subjective determination of the seller's performance.

D Fixed price incentive fee (FPIF)

Correct. The question references elements of the fixed price incentive fee (FPIF) contract including an agreed upon or fixed price for services, no expected change in work to be performed and criteria that will allow the seller to earn additional funds or incentive. This fixed price contract type allows the buyer and seller flexibility in performance deviation, tying incentives to cost, performance or as in this case, schedule.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 471

PMP Exam 1

Question 55

Which of the following, once approved, does not require an approved change request to be modified?

A Policies or procedures in the project management plan

B Contract terms

C Cost, scope, or schedule baselines

D Project charter

Answer: D

Hint:

Which of these project components is created early in the project and is not changed once the final version has been approved and signed?

Explanation:

This question is tricky and counter-intuitive because the project charter once completed and signed typically does not change except under very unusual circumstances; for example, the change of a project sponsor or project manager mid-project, both of which are rare occurrences. In those instances, however, typically an addendum is added to the project charter rather than a change made to the charter. The addition reflects the change, and all project stakeholders should be informed. Before signature, the project charter can and will change, but these changes do not require change control procedures either as the charter is not final until it is signed.

A change request is required to modify formally controlled project documents, typically the components of the project management plan. Table 4-1. Project Management Plan and Project Documents, specifies the list of the components of the project management plan as well as project documents. Unless stated otherwise in the scenario, the components of the project management plan require a change request to be modified, while an update to the project documents does not require a change request. Since the project charter is not a component of the project management plan, a change request is not required to modify the project charter.

Details for Each Option:

A Policies or procedures in the project management plan

Incorrect. As part of the Perform Integrated Change Control process, any changes to the project management plan require an approved change request.

B Contract terms

Incorrect. Changes to contract terms could impact other parts of the project such as the performance measurement baseline or project risk and needs to be considered in an integrated manner. Therefore, a change to contract terms would require an approved change request.

C Cost, scope, or schedule baselines

Incorrect. Changes to any one of these baselines will most certainly impact the others. Changes need to be considered in an integrated manner and therefore would require an approved change request.

D Project charter

Correct. The project charter is created as part of the Initiating Process Group at the beginning of the project. Typically, the charter is not changed once its final version has been approved and

signed. The question asks which document would 'not' require an approved change request. Since the project charter is not a controlled document, unlike the project management plan with all its components, it would not require approval, and therefore, is the correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 114-115, 89, 93

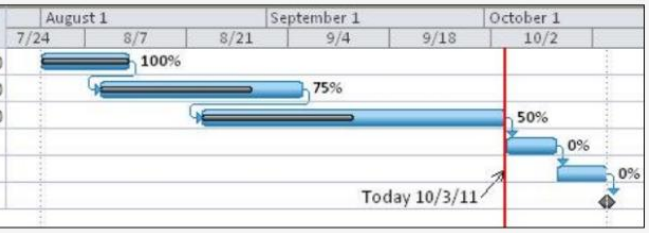
PMP Exam 1

Question 56

On October 3rd (represented by the red line on the Gantt chart below), the project sponsor asks you to provide a progress report including the CPI for a project status meeting the following morning. You update the project schedule management tool, which produces the following chart. The method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete.

What are the project's current CPI and status?

Task Name	Duration (days)	Start	Finish	Planned Value	Actual Cost
System Analysis	10	8/1/2011	8/12/2011	$500	$600
System Design	20	8/9/2011	9/5/2011	$1,000	$500
System Development	30	8/23/2011	10/3/2011	$5,000	$2,000
System Testing	5	10/4/2011	10/10/2011	$1,000	-
System Deployment	5	10/11/2011	10/17/2011	$500	-
Project Complete	-	10/17/2011	10/17/2011	-	-



A The CPI is $650, and the project is running under planned costs.

B The CPI is 0.83, and the project is running over budget.

C The CPI is 1.21, and the project is running under planned costs.

D The CPI is 1.0, and the project is on budget.

Answer: C

Hint:

The current cost performance index (CPI) can be calculated by dividing current earned value (EV) by the current actual costs (AC).

Explanation:

The current cost performance index (CPI) can be calculated by dividing the current earned value (EV) by the current actual costs (AC). Because the question is asking for the current CPI, only the activities (tasks) that should have been completed by the end of October 3rd should be considered, which are the first three activities.

Since the scenario mentions that the method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete, the earned value of a partially completed work package is calculated by multiplying the planned value of the work package by its the percent complete. The EV is the sum of the planned work completed for each activity multiplied by the percentage of completion of the corresponding activity, which, in this case, is:

- 100% for System Analysis
- 75% for System Design
- 50% for System Development

EV = (100% * $500) + (75% * $1,000) + (50% * $5,000) = $500 + $750 + $2,500 = $3,750

The AC is the sum of the costs for the first three activities:

- $600 for System Analysis
- $500 for System Design
- $2,000 for System Development

AC = $600 + $500 + $2,000 = $3,100

Therefore, the CPI can be calculated as:

CPI = EV / AC = $3,750 / $3,100 = 1.21

Since the CPI of 1.21 is greater than 1.0, the project is running under planned costs.

Details for Each Option:

A The CPI is $650, and the project is running under planned costs.

Incorrect. The cost variance (CV) can be calculated as earned value (EV) minus actual costs (AC) which is $650. However, the question is asking for the CPI and not the CV.

B The CPI is 0.83, and the project is running over budget.

Incorrect. The current cost performance index (CPI) can be calculated by dividing current earned value (EV) by the current actual costs (AC). If EV and AC are transposed in the formula, the result is 0.83, making this choice an incorrect answer.

C The CPI is 1.21, and the project is running under planned costs.

Correct. The current cost performance index (CPI) can be calculated by dividing current earned value (EV) by the current actual costs (AC). The EV is the sum of the planned work completed, which, in this case, is 100% of activity 1, 75% of activity 2, and 50% of activity 3. The AC is the sum of the costs for the first three activities. CPI = EV / AC = $3,750 / $3,100 = 1.21. Since the CPI of 1.21 is greater than 1.0, the project is running under planned costs.

D The CPI is 1.0, and the project is on budget.

Incorrect. If the CPI were at 1.0, then the project would be on budget. However, when calculated correctly, the CPI is 1.21 meaning the project is currently running under planned costs.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 263

Practice Standard for Earned Value Management - Second Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2011, Page(s) 38-39

https://www.project-management-prepcast.com/pmp-formulas

PMP Exam 1

Question 57

During a daily stand-up meeting, one of the programmers mentions that she had some extra time and added functionality, which was not included in the original design. She believes the customer will appreciate the added functionality.

What is your best course of action?

A Remove the added functionality and ensure that the project team builds the software as designed going forward

B Thank the programmer for the extra effort and notify the customer of the new functionality that has been added

C Update the cost baseline since the project will run over budget due to the cost of adding new functionality

D Accept the added functionality, but ask the programmer to build only what has been designed going forward

Answer: A

Hint:

How should scope creep be addressed?

Explanation:

The extra code that was written to add the functionality should be removed from the build, and the project manager should ensure software is written as designed going forward. Adding unplanned functionality, sometimes referred to as gold plating, will increase the overall project risk. For example, there may have been a good reason the client did not want this added functionality. Perhaps the client's computer system cannot support more advanced functionality. Additionally, the added code may interfere with other functionality since it was not integrated with the original build plan. Of the available choices, the best course of action is to remove the added functionality and ensure that the design plan is followed in the future. Note that if the project manager believes that this added functionality would benefit the customer, then the suggestion can be made to the customer. The customer can then decide whether or not to add the functionality and accept any impact on other project constraints. If the customer approves the added functionality, a change request should be submitted and processed through the Perform Integrated Change Control process.

Ideally, a risk of removing the functionality should be assessed first including the impact on all project constraints, and then a decision would have to be made accordingly. However, this answer choice is not provided. Therefore, as we always recommend, we have to select the best answer of those provided, even if it does not look/sound like the perfect/ideal answer or the answer one would want to see among the options.

Details for Each Option:

A Remove the added functionality and ensure that the project team builds the software as designed going forward

Correct. The added software code should be removed, and the project manager should ensure that the code is written as planned in the future. Removing the extra software code will reduce the overall project risk introduced with the added functionality. The project manager should control the scope and ensure all changes are processed through the Perform Integrated Change Control Process.

B Thank the programmer for the extra effort and notify the customer of the new functionality that has been added

Incorrect. Adding functionality, as is described by the question, is sometimes referred to as gold plating. Gold plating should be avoided as it adds unnecessary risk to the project, and the customer may reject the deliverable since it is not built as specified in the contract.

C Update the cost baseline since the project will run over budget due to the cost of adding new functionality

Incorrect. There is not enough information in the scenario to determine if the added functionality will cause the project to run over budget. Therefore, updating the cost baseline is unlikely to be your best course of action. Additionally, an approved change request is required to modify any of the project baselines.

D Accept the added functionality, but ask the programmer to build only what has been designed going forward

Incorrect. This answer choice might be tempting, but this action may have unintended consequences. The client may reject the deliverables since it is not built according to the original agreement. Adding the functionality brings unnecessary risk to the project which should be avoided.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 168

Question 58

Your project has just begun its execution when hurricane warnings are issued for the area. The possibility of a hurricane was one of the risks identified during risk management planning.

Which of the following should you review first to determine how to address this risk?

A Risk register

B Risk management plan

C Risk audit

D Risk contingency plan

Answer: A

Hint:

Where are details of individual project risks documented?

Explanation:

As risks are identified, they are analyzed, and responses are planned and implemented. The resulting information from each risk management process is recorded in the risk register. During execution, the risk register has the response plan for any identified risk. Therefore, the risk register would be the place to find the response to be implemented in the case of a hurricane.

Details for Each Option:

A Risk register

Correct. The risk register is where the details of identified individual risks are documented. The risk details include items such as risk owners, agreed-upon responses, contingency plans, and risk triggers. In this scenario, the chance of a hurricane has been identified as a risk. Therefore, the agreed-upon risk response will be recorded in the risk register making this the correct answer.

B Risk management plan

Incorrect. The risk management plan defines how risk management will be performed. Individual risks are not addressed in the plan, but rather the methods by which they will be identified and categorized. Therefore, this is not the correct answer.

C Risk audit

Incorrect. Risk audits are used to consider the effectiveness of the risk management process. In the scenario, you are looking for a project artifact that can help address the specific risk rather than consider the effectiveness of the process. Additionally, the way the question is worded, "Which of the following should you review first", invalidates the risk audit as the correct answer choice, since the risk audit is something that is conducted (or performed, or carried out) rather than reviewed. "Reviewing risk audit" makes no sense.

D Risk contingency plan

Incorrect. A contingency plan (or fallback plan), can be developed if the selected strategy turns out not to be effective or if an accepted risk occurs. In this scenario, however, developing a contingency plan is premature as the response originally planned for this risk (if one exists) has yet to be implemented. If the response exists and is implemented, but turns out not to be fully effective, developing the contingency plan can be considered.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 450

PMP Exam 1

Question 59

You are managing a project for a customer with whom you have signed an Intellectual Property (IP) agreement requiring that the component design be unique. When the vendor to whom you outsourced the design makes a delivery, you are surprised to see that it is the same as one that the vendor had delivered to another of your clients. You review your contract with the vendor and realize that it does not include the uniqueness clause that would protect your customer's IP.

Which of the following actions should you take to resolve this situation?

A Include the vendor in client meetings and make them realize the importance of protecting intellectual property

B Use the contract change control system

C Show the designs to the customer to get approval before beginning the manufacturing of the components

D Cancel the contract with the vendor

Answer: B

Hint:

Contracts can be amended at any time by mutual consent before contract closure.

Explanation:

In this scenario, you are a project manager at the company executing the project. Your contract with the customer includes specific conditions to ensure that the IP for the design is protected. You have outsourced the design work to a vendor. Unfortunately, your contract with the vendor does not specify the conditions that establish and protect the customer's IP. The vendor has done nothing wrong by submitting the previous design to your company, and nothing in the question indicates that you have either discussed or by contract bound the vendor to protect the client's IP. Therefore, it was a lapse on the part of your company not to inform or contractually bind the vendor to the same IP restrictions that your company agreed to protect. You need to use your company's contract change control system to modify the contract to include the IP considerations of your customer and present the amendment to your vendor for approval.

Details for Each Option:

A Include the vendor in client meetings and make them realize the importance of protecting intellectual property

Incorrect. The vendor likely understands the importance of protecting IP in general. However, in this scenario, your contract with the vendor did not include an IP clause, so they are not obligated to protect your customer's IP. Therefore, including the vendor in client meetings without adding the IP clause into the contract is unlikely to resolve the issue at hand.

B Use the contract change control system

Correct. The contract change control system, part of your company's enterprise environmental factors, is used to collect, track, arbitrate, and communicate changes to a contract. The design, submitted by the vendor, violates one of the IP restrictions you agreed to in the contract with your customer. You need to inform the vendor about the IP protection clause with your customer, update the existing contract, and gain the vendor's approval of the revised agreement requiring the vendor to adhere to your customer's IP protection clause.

C Show the designs to the customer to get approval before beginning the manufacturing of the components

Incorrect. Showing the designs to the customer to get approval before beginning the manufacturing of the components is unethical; you know the designs are not unique and violate the contract with the customer.

D Cancel the contract with the vendor

Incorrect. There is nothing in the scenario that indicates that the vendor is bound by an IP clause or is sharing a design that is protected by the intellectual property of another client. In the described scenario, your company failed to obtain assurance from the vendor you outsourced the design work to that your customer's design would be unique and become part of your customer's IP. Canceling the contract with the vendor would be a rash and groundless decision that could result in delays due to the time required to identify and contract with another vendor for the design.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 494-495, 497, 702

PMP Exam 1

Question 60

An organization has established a threshold for all projects that the expected incremental revenue must exceed costs by at least 25%. The current project is projected to have a benefit-cost ratio (BCR) of 1.75.

Based on this information, what can be said about the project?

A The BCR does not meet the minimum threshold established by the organization; therefore, the project should not be undertaken.

B The BCR meets but does not exceed the minimum threshold; therefore, the project should not be undertaken.

C The BCR exceeds the minimum threshold and is in alignment with corporate strategy; therefore, the project can be undertaken.

D There is not enough information in the question to calculate the BCR and make an informed decision about the project.

Answer: C

Hint:

The benefit-cost ratio (BCR) represents the benefits divided by the costs.

Explanation:

In order to correctly answer the question, one must understand benefit-cost ratio. The benefit-cost ratio (BCR) represents the benefits divided by the costs. In this case, the benefits are the expected incremental revenues from the project, and the costs are represented by the project budget. Typically, the revenues and costs are adjusted for inflation by using the net present value (NPV), but that is not stated in the question. In this scenario, the organization has established a threshold for all projects that the expected incremental revenue must exceed costs by at least 25%. Therefore, the project's BCR must exceed 1.25. Since the project's anticipated BCR of 1.75

exceeds the minimum threshold of 1.25, the project is in alignment with the organization's strategic goals and can be undertaken.

While the topic of this question is just briefly mentioned in the PMBOK® Guide, the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, June 2015, covers knowledge and skills with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Project finance principles are among these knowledge and skills.

Details for Each Option:

A The BCR does not meet the minimum threshold established by the organization; therefore, the project should not be undertaken.

Incorrect. A BCR of 1.75 means that projected revenues will exceed costs by 75% for the project. Therefore, the project's BCR exceeds the minimum threshold established by the company of 25%. Note, if the project has not yet been authorized, for example, if the project charter has not yet been approved, then there is nothing to terminate. However, the question describes a project in initiation which may mean the project charter has already been approved and the project authorized. In any case, this answer choice can be eliminated based on the math.

B The BCR meets but does not exceed the minimum threshold; therefore, the project should not be undertaken.

Incorrect. The question states that the organization has established a threshold for all projects that the expected incremental revenue must exceed costs by at least 25%. This threshold translates to a BCR of 1.25. The projected BCR of 1.75 exceeds the threshold of 1.25, so the project should not be terminated based on the information presented by the question.

C The BCR exceeds the minimum threshold and is in alignment with corporate strategy; therefore, the project can be undertaken.

Correct. The BCR of 1.75 indicates that the expected revenues from the project exceed the costs by 75%. 75% exceeds the minimum threshold of 25% established by the company.

D There is not enough information in the question to calculate the BCR and make an informed decision about the project.

Incorrect. A BCR of 1.75 means that projected revenues for the project will exceed costs by 75%. Therefore, the project's BCR exceeds the minimum threshold established by the company of 25%.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 34-35; see also https://www.pmi.org/learning/library/benefit-cost-ratio-inaccurate-individual-5104

PMP Exam 1

Question 61

A_request for proposal (RFP) which includes a procurement statement of work (SOW) has been prepared and forwarded to three of the prospective sellers. You have just received the last of the seller responses, and after reviewing all three responses, you see there is a 100% difference between the lowest and highest estimates.

What should you do first?

A Select the seller with the highest estimate

B Take the seller with the highest estimate to court

C Select the seller with the lowest estimate

D Review the procurement statement of work

Answer: D

Hint:

What procurement document provides sellers with the requirements for the outsourced product?

Explanation:

The procurement SOW is developed from the project scope baseline and describes the item of acquisition in sufficient detail to allow prospective sellers to provide an estimate for the work. A significant discrepancy between sellers' responses suggests the information furnished to them did not wholly or clearly describe the procurement item. The prospective sellers either misunderstood or failed to respond adequately to the procurement SOW. Expert judgment and data analysis can be used as tools and techniques to evaluate the seller responses during the Conduct Procurement process described in the scenario. The procurement SOW can be reviewed, revised and refined as required until it has been incorporated into a signed agreement with a seller. The variance in the received seller responses strongly suggests a review of the procurement SOW is conducted prior to taking further action.

Details for Each Option:

A Select the seller with the highest estimate

Incorrect. The large discrepancy between the estimates suggests there is something wrong with the quotes; perhaps there was not a clear understanding of the requirements by the sellers. In addition, there is not enough information provided in the question to suggest that the seller with the highest estimate is better than the other quotes. With the highest estimate, you need to ensure that the cost is justified and evaluate all the proposals based on source selection criteria before deciding.

B Take the seller with the highest estimate to court

Incorrect. Taking the seller to court is an example of claims administration tools and techniques that can be used as part of the Control Procurements process to resolve contested changes between a buyer and a seller. Not only this action is extreme, but it is also premature as the scenario does not describe any conflict between the parties.

C Select the seller with the lowest estimate

Incorrect. The large discrepancy between the estimates suggests there is something wrong with the quotes; perhaps there was not a clear understanding of the requirements by the sellers. If the seller with the lowest estimate is chosen, it may end up costing more in the future when change orders are needed to meet the desired requirements.

D Review the procurement statement of work

Correct. Significant differences in the estimates can suggest that the procurement SOW was incomplete or that the prospective sellers did not fully understand the requirements. The procurement SOW must be clear and describe all the work the seller is required to complete. Since there is a significant discrepancy in the received seller responses, reviewing the procurement SOW is the best choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) - Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 487, 477-479

PMP Exam 1

Question 62

As a project manager, you monitor resource availability and determine that a machine, which is needed for the testing is down for unscheduled maintenance, which will cause a two-day delay. To avoid the delay, you check alternatives and discover that you can swap this type of test with another activity.

What tool or technique did you use?

A Acquire Resources

B Problem solving

C Contingency reserve

D Control Resources

Answer: B

Hint:

What tool or technique of the Control Resources process is used to address issues?

Explanation:

The question implies that the Control Resources process is underway in this scenario. Problem solving is one of the tools and techniques that can help the project manager solve problems that arise during the Control Resources process. Problem solving involves identifying the problem, defining the problem, investigating, analyzing, solving, and checking the solution. Although the question does not explicitly describe these steps, it is reasonable to assume that the project manager has applied the problem solving set of tools, and therefore, of the choices given, problem solving is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Acquire Resources

Incorrect. The question is asking for a tool or technique. Acquire Resources is a process rather than a tool or technique.

B Problem solving

Correct. Problem solving is a set of tools and techniques that can help the project manager solve problems that arise during the Control Resources process. The project manager has identified the problem, checked alternatives, and found the solution that may resolve the problem.

C Contingency reserve

Incorrect. A contingency reserve represents time or money allocated in the schedule or cost baseline for known risks with active response strategies. The question states that the problem was solved by adjusting activities within the schedule rather than using the contingency reserve. Also, contingency reserve is not a tool or technique.

D Control Resources

Incorrect. The question does suggest that Control Resources is the process being performed. However, Control Resources is a process and not a tool or technique.

Reference:

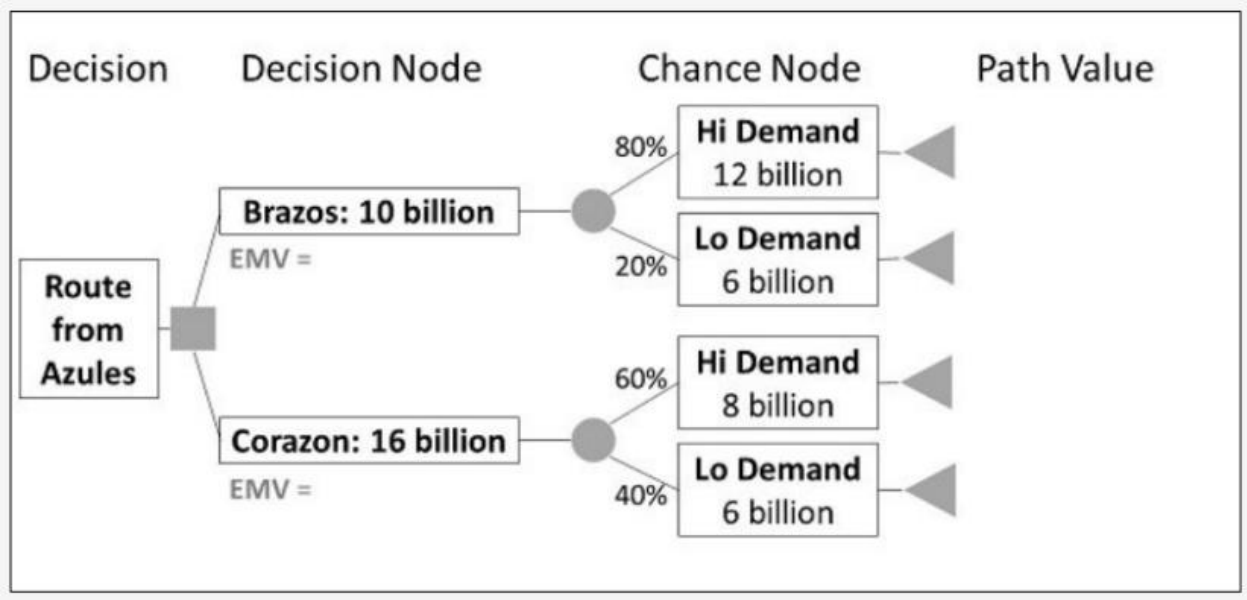
A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 356

PMP Exam 1

Question 63

Your sponsor has committed to building a high-speed rail from one major inland city, Azules, to the coast. You have two possible routes, either Brazos or Corazon.

Given each route's costs, odds, and rewards of high demand and low demand in this decision tree, how would you quantify the expected monetary value of the route to Corazon?



A 7.2 billion

B -4.8 billion

C -18 billion

D -8.8 billion

Answer: D

Hint:

part of the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process. You must account for not only the cost of the decision but the probability and payoff for each effect.

Explanation:

The expected monetary value is an important calculation in performing decision tree analysis as part of the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process. You must account for not only the cost of the decision but the probability and payoff for each effect.

In a decision tree, the EMV for a decision is calculated by multiplying the value of each possible profit outcome by its probability of occurrence and adding the products together.

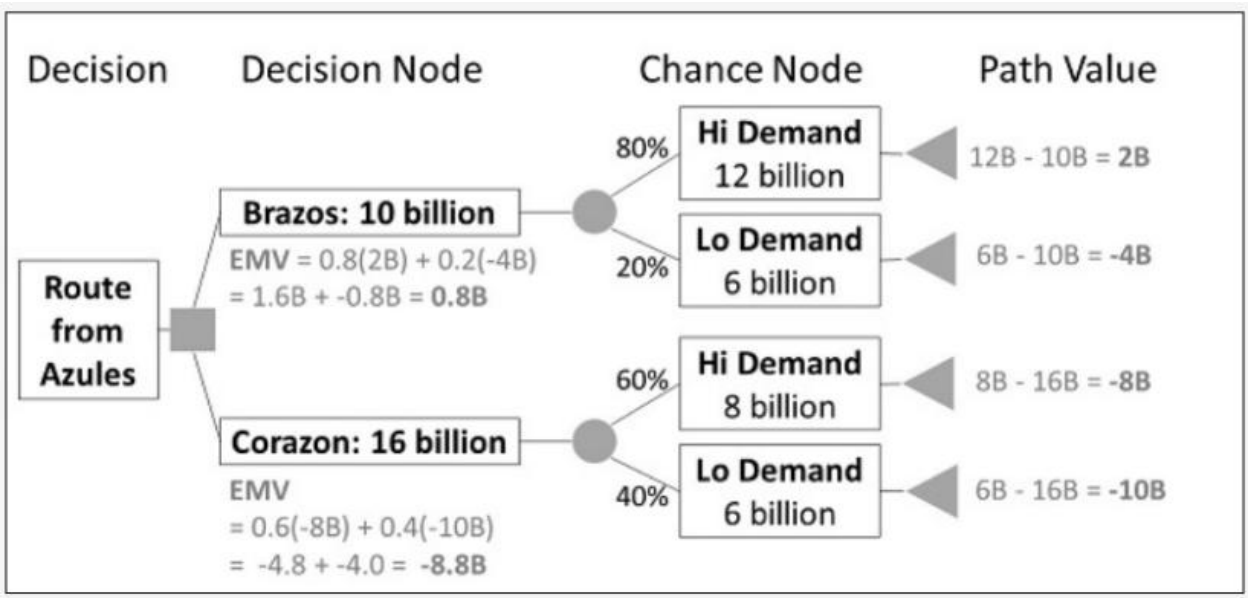
The value of each possible outcome is the net path value. Remember: when you net something, you must consider all positive & negative flows.

The formula to compute net path value is to subtract the path reward minus the cost of its decision. For building the route to Corazon, here are the steps to compute the expected monetary value:

EMV = 0.6(-8B) + 0.4(-10B) = -4.8B + (-4.0)B = -8.8B

Other answer choices do not properly factor the net path value (the payoff minus the cost of the decision) and sum the effects.

Below is the completed decision tree with all the net path values and the resulting expected monetary value of each choice. The EMV for the Corazon route is -8.8 billion (note this is a negative number). The EMV for the Brazos route is 0.8 billion. Since the path with the largest expected monetary value is the Brazos route at 0.8 billion, that is the best choice.



Details for Each Option:

A 7.2 billion

Incorrect. You might have chosen this answer if you merely multiplied the probability by the payoff (e.g., 0.6*8+0.4*6). However, you must also account for the cost of the decision to build the route to Corazon, so this is not the best answer.

B -4.8 billion

Incorrect. You might choose this answer if you merely multiply the more probable path's chance by its net path value. However, for each decision branch, all effects must be added to determine the expected monetary value.

C -18 billion

Incorrect. You might choose this answer if you merely added the net path values to Corazon. However, to compute the expected monetary value, you must factor the probability for each payoff occurring.

D -8.8 billion

Correct. To calculate the expected monetary value of the route to the Corazon, you multiply each path's chance by its net path value and sum the results. EMV = 0.6(-8B) + 0.4(-10B) = -4.8B + -4.0B = -8.8B

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 435

PMP Exam 1

Question 64

A_project has just completed the first of three phases. During a recent meeting with the customer, the project manager learns that the customer is concerned that the quality process, as

laid out in the quality management plan, is not being followed. As a result, the customer is thinking about canceling the project.

What is the best way for the project manager to verify the customer's claim?

A Conduct a quality audit

B Check the quality metrics

C Run statistical sampling

D Carry out a performance review

Answer: A

Which technique used in the Manage Quality process is concerned with how the work being performed complies with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures?

Explanation:

Audits are performed as part of the Manage Quality process to make sure that the work is being performed in accordance with the required quality standards as laid out in the quality management plan. Since the quality process is what the customer is concerned about, the project manager's best course of action is to perform an audit to verify the customer's claim.

Details for Each Option:

A Conduct a quality audit

Correct. An audit is a structured, independent process used to determine if project activities comply with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures. Since the customer has raised concerns about the quality process not being followed in accordance with the quality management plan, an audit would be an appropriate way to verify the customer's claim.

B Check the quality metrics

Incorrect. Quality metrics are verified as part of the Control Quality process. The Manage Quality process uses these quality metrics as a basis for the development of test scenarios for the project and its deliverables and as a basis for improvement initiatives. Since the customer is more concerned about the project's compliance with required quality standards and procedures, an audit would be the better answer choice.

C Run statistical sampling

Incorrect. Statistical sampling involves choosing a part of a population of interest for inspection. It is a technique used in the Control Quality process to measure controls and verify quality.

D Carry out a performance review

Incorrect. Performance reviews measure, compare, and analyze the quality metrics defined by the Plan Quality Management process against the actual results. However, in this scenario, the project manager is more concerned with ensuring the quality process is being followed in accordance with company standards rather than measuring, comparing, and analyzing the quality metrics against the actual results.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 294-295, 291, 303

PMP Exam 1

Question 65

A_roject manager wants to take advantage of knowledge available within the organization to better manage their current project.

What is the best course of action for the project manager in order to achieve this goal?

A Make sure the knowledge management plan is agreed upon by all project stakeholders

B Document lessons learned in the lessons learned register throughout the project life cycle

C Create an atmosphere of trust so that people are motivated to share their knowledge

D Empower your project team and encourage them to be self-organizing and self-managing

Answer: C

Hint:

Some knowledge resides in the minds of people.

Explanation:

From an organizational perspective, knowledge management is about making sure the skills, experience, and expertise of the project team members and other stakeholders are used before, during, and after the project. Knowledge resides within organizational knowledge bases and in the minds of people. Organizational knowledge bases can be accessed and the information retrieved. However, people cannot be forced to share what they know. Ideally, to take advantage of knowledge available within the organization to better plan and manage their upcoming project, the project manager should do both: retrieve the knowledge from the knowledge base and create an atmosphere of trust so that people are motivated to share their knowledge. However, no answer choice with both options is available. Therefore, creating an atmosphere of trust so that people are motivated to share their knowledge, is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Make sure the knowledge management plan is agreed upon by all project stakeholders

Incorrect. The knowledge management plan is not a document associated with the PMBOK Guide, Sixth Edition.

B Document lessons learned in the lessons learned register throughout the project life cycle

Incorrect. Lessons that are learned throughout the project life cycle are documented in the lessons learned register and then transferred to the lessons learned repository, which is a part of the corporate knowledge base. While documenting lessons learned in the lessons learned register is a good practice, the question asks how to take advantage of knowledge 'already available' within the organization, not how to add new knowledge to the knowledge base.

C Create an atmosphere of trust so that people are motivated to share their knowledge

Correct. Because knowledge resides in the minds of people and people cannot be forced to share what they know, the most important part of knowledge management is creating an atmosphere of trust so that people are motivated to share their knowledge.

D Empower your project team and encourage them to be self-organizing and self-managing

Incorrect. Even the most empowered, self-organizing, and self-managing teams do not hold all knowledge available in the organization.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 100

PMP Exam 1

Question 66

A_large project will be broken down into four phases. The project sponsor is very enthusiastic about the project and asks the project manager when the project kick-off meeting will be held.

What is the best response to the project sponsor's question?

A During execution of the first phase

B As part of the Planning Process Group of the first phase

C At the start of each phase

D As part of pre-project work

Answer: C

Hint:

Each phase of a project is treated much like an individual project.

Explanation:

The scenario describes a large project which will be conducted in four phases. Multiphase projects, like the one described by the question, will typically include a kick-off meeting at the beginning of each phase. Consider that each phase of a multiphase project is treated much like an individual project in that most or all of the processes are repeated for each phase. Therefore, the best response to the project sponsor's question is to conduct a kick-off meeting at the start of each phase.

Details for Each Option:

A During execution of the first phase

Incorrect. The project kick-off meeting may be conducted during project execution for a large project. However, this answer choice is incomplete as a multiphase project will typically have a kick-off meeting at the beginning of each phase. Therefore, this is not the best answer of the available choices.

B As part of the Planning Process Group of the first phase

Incorrect. A project kick-off meeting might be conducted during project planning, particularly for a small project. However, the scenario indicates that this is a large multiphase project, and a multiphase project will typically have kick-off meetings at the start of each phase.

C At the start of each phase

Correct. Multiphase projects, like the one described by the question, will typically include a kick-off meeting at the beginning of each phase, making this choice the best answer to the question asked.

D As part of pre-project work

Incorrect. During pre-project work, the business case and the benefits management plan are developed. The project isn't even authorized until the project charter is drafted and approved as

part of project initiation. Therefore, during pre-project work is not an appropriate time to conduct a project kick-off meeting.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 86

PMP Exam 1

Question 67

Your project to build a new production line is in execution. A change request was submitted and approved to apply corrective action to an element of the new production line. The implementation of the change request requires technical knowledge that no one on the project team has.

What should the project manager do to resolve this situation?

A Bring in a qualified consultant

B Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

C Defer the change request

D Document the issue in the issue log

Answer: A

What tool or technique associated with the Direct and Manage Project Work process would be helpful in this scenario?

Explanation:

Approved change requests are implemented through the Direct and Manage Project Work process. Expert judgment is one of the tools and techniques associated with the Direct and Manage Project Work process. Specialized knowledge or training is an example of expert judgment. Since the project team members do not possess this technical knowledge, the project manager should seek out someone that has the technical knowledge to implement the corrective action described by the question. Of the available options, only bringing in a qualified consultant would resolve the issue in a timely manner and is, therefore, the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Bring in a qualified consultant

Correct. Specialized knowledge or training is an example of expert judgment. Since the project team members do not possess this technical knowledge, the project manager should seek out someone that has the technical knowledge to implement the corrective action by bringing in a qualified consultant.

B Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

Incorrect. The project sponsor provides funding to the project and supports the project manager when issues cannot be resolved within the authority of the project manager. The project manager should have the authority to secure the required resources to execute the project. Only if the project manager does not succeed, and there is no other way to resolve the issue, should the project manager escalate the issue to the project sponsor. However, at this point, escalation is a premature action.

C Defer the change request

Incorrect. A change request can be approved, rejected, or deferred. The question states that the change request has already been approved. Therefore, unless the project manager is the only individual authorized to decide on changes (which cannot be determined from the information provided in the question), the project manager cannot defer the change request at-will after it has already been approved. The project manager can defer the ‘implementation’ of the change

request if an individual with the necessary expertise to implement it is unavailable but deferring the change request and deferring the implementation of the change request are two different things.

D Document the issue in the issue log

Incorrect. While documenting the issue in the issue log is probably the first step the project manager should take in this scenario, the question is asking what the project manager should do to ‘resolve’ this situation. Just documenting the issue in the project documents would not resolve it. Eventually, the resolution will be recorded in the issue log. However, the focus of the question is on 'resolving' the issue rather than 'documenting' it.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 110; see also https://www.projectmanagement.com/wikis/344587/Expert-judgment

PMP Exam 1

Question 68

During your most recent conference call, the key stakeholders suggest that it would be more helpful to them if the status reports were sent via email instead of the weekly call.

What area of communications management will you have to change to address the stakeholders' request?

A The communication method

B The communication model

C The project communications

D The communication channels

Answer: A

What area of communication management involves interactive communication, push communication, and pull communication?

Explanation:

Communication methods describe how information is transferred one-to-one or to groups of individuals. These methods are grouped into the following categories: interactive communication, push communication, and pull communication. Email is an example of push communication. When choosing a communication method, it is advisable to include the stakeholders in the final decision, so their communication needs will be met. Communication models describe the process by which information is shared and has three main parts: the sender, the message, and the receiver. Considering both communication models and communication methods will lead to the most effective communication. In the scenario provided, the stakeholders are requesting the project manager to use email as a method in which the information is shared with them. Therefore, of the choices given, the communication method is the best answer.

Details for Each Option:

A The communication method

Correct. Communication methods describe the way information is transferred and can be grouped into the following categories: interactive communication, push communication, and pull communication. In this scenario, the stakeholders are requesting you to switch the method used to share information with them from conference calls to email, or from an interactive method to a push method. Since the communication method is changing, this choice is correct.

B The communication model

Incorrect. Communication models describe the process of communication in its most basic form: the sender, the message, and the receiver. In this scenario, the process of communication is not changing as it still involves the sender, message, and receiver, but the way the information is transferred is switching from phone to email. Therefore, the communication model is not the correct choice.

C The project communications

Incorrect. The project communications are all project documents and artifacts created during the project lifecycle. Sending the status reports via email instead of having a weekly call does not change all project documents and artifacts created during the project lifecycle, making this choice an incorrect answer.

D The communication channels

Incorrect. The communication channels are the paths of communication that exist in your project. Knowing the number of communication channels can be helpful in identifying and planning project communications. However, communication channels do not involve actual methods of communication; therefore, this choice is incorrect.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 383, 374

Question 69

As an experienced project manager, you are aware there are potential risks that could impact the success of your project. You want to ensure there is a process in place to identify and manage risks throughout the project life cycle.

Where will you document this process?

A Risk register

B Risk management plan

C Issue log

D Risk report

Answer: B

What is an output of a Plan Risk Management process that defines how risk management activities will be structured and performed?

Explanation:

All projects contain an inherent set of risks. A risk management plan is developed to ensure there is a process in place to manage risks on a project. The risk management plan provides guidelines on how risk management will be structured and performed throughout the project and defines an approach to managing risk. Therefore, of the choices offered, the risk management plan is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Risk register

Incorrect. The scenario suggests you are in the Plan Risk Management process where you will define how risk management activities will be conducted on your project. The output of the Plan Risk Management process is the risk management plan where your approach to managing risks on the project is detailed. The risk register contains details of identified risks but not the plan for managing risk. Also, the risk register is created as part of the Identify Risks process, not the Plan Risk Management process.

B Risk management plan

Correct. The risk management plan, a component of the project management plan, describes how risk management activities will be structured and performed over the duration of the project.

C Issue log

Incorrect. The issue log tracks conditions or situations that may have an impact on the project and its objectives. The issue log is created during project execution, not project planning. Even if the issue log existed in the scenario, it does not describe how to manage risks throughout the project life cycle.

D Risk report

Incorrect. The risk report is a project document developed and updated progressively throughout the project life cycle. The risk report summarizes information on individual project risks and the level of overall project risk. In the scenario, you are in the Plan Risk Management process where you develop the risk management plan which defines how risk management will be performed on your project. It is the risk management plan, not the risk report, that describes your approach to managing risk.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 405

PMP Exam 1

Question 70

Your project is midway into execution when a new executive joins the company. The sponsor tells you the executive will play a significant role in your project.

What should you do first?

A Perform the Develop Project Management Plan process

B Record the new executive as an issue in the issue log

C Meet with the executive to review the project charter

D Update the resource breakdown structure

Answer: C

Hint:

What would ensure common understanding of the project?

Explanation:

Meeting with stakeholders as early as possible helps ensure the stakeholders understand how the project will impact them, which reduces the likelihood of conflict during or after the project. Therefore, of the choices provided, meeting with the executive to review the project charter and ensure a common understanding of the key project deliverables and milestones is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Perform the Develop Project Management Plan process

Incorrect. The Develop Project Management Plan process defines, prepares, and coordinates all the plan components and consolidates them into an integrated project management plan. Since the scenario states the project is being executed, it can be inferred the Develop Project Management Plan process has already been performed.

B Record the new executive as an issue in the issue log

Incorrect. The issue log is a project document where information about issues is recorded and monitored. One may argue that a new executive joining the project as a key stakeholder midway into project execution may be considered an issue. However, before jumping to conclusions, a stakeholder analysis should be performed. Who knows, maybe the new executive is very supportive.

C Meet with the executive to review the project charter

Correct. Meetings can be used to update and inform stakeholders about project status. Meeting with the new executive to review the project charter will help to ensure a common understanding of the key deliverables, milestones, as well as the roles and responsibilities of the stakeholders on the project.

D Update the resource breakdown structure

Incorrect. The resource breakdown structure is a hierarchical representation of resources by category and type. While it is possible that the new executive will play a role in the project and may even be considered a resource, thus warranting an update to the resource breakdown structure, a meeting with the stakeholder is required first to understand the roles and responsibilities of the executive.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 53, 81, 561

PMP Exam 1

Question 71

You have been provided a list of concerns some stakeholders have with your project. You meet with them to address the concerns in hopes of gaining their support and cooperation. You pay close attention by actively and effectively listening. You focus on each person's input to ensure

you are aware of and are taking all perspectives into consideration. You then clearly articulate your point and your position and ask for their support.

Which tool or technique best describes the skills you are using?

A Influencing

B Team performance assessments

C Conflict management

D Emotional intelligence

Answer: A

The question references key skills included in this technique which can assist project managers in resolving issues promptly and obtaining needed resources.

Explanation:

Influencing skills is a component of interpersonal and team skills which is a tool and technique used in the Manage Team process. Influencing skills are often critical to the success of a project in a matrix environment because of the limited authority project managers have in those environments. Influencing skills can help the project manager obtain resources and solve issues promptly. Vital influencing skills include an ability to be persuasive, clearly articulating points and positions, high levels of active and effective listening, awareness of, and consideration for, the various perspectives in any situation, and gathering relevant information to address issues and reach agreements while maintaining mutual trust.

The PMBOK® Guide groups many process tools and techniques, like influencing skills, based on their purpose. Useful information and tables that categorize these tools and techniques by group and tie them to their respective process can be found using the included page reference.

Details for Each Option:

A Influencing

Correct. Influencing is one of 17 interpersonal and team skills tools and techniques within the Manage Team process. This question demonstrates the use of many of the key influencing skills,

including but not limited to, active and effective listening, clearly articulating points and positions, and others.

B Team performance assessments

Incorrect. Team performance assessments are tools used by the project manager in the Manage Team process to assess how the team is performing on the project. This question does not suggest that you are assessing team performance in your meeting.

C Conflict management

Incorrect. Conflict management is a tool or technique in the Manage Team process. When conflict is appropriately managed, it can lead to improved productivity and working relationships. However, this question does not indicate that there is conflict, it merely describes a meeting to address stakeholder concerns.

D Emotional intelligence

Incorrect. Although emotional intelligence can be used as a tool in this situation, it is not the 'best' answer. Actions described in the question go beyond the definition of emotional intelligence, assessing and managing emotions, and apply more specifically to characteristics of the influencing tool or technique.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 350, 685-694

Question 72

Early into a project, the project manager is frustrated with the slow progress the project team is making.

Which of the following theories or models may alleviate his frustrations by clarifying how a team develops throughout the project?

A Theory X

B Hierarchy of needs

C Three needs theory

D Tuckman ladder

Answer: D

Hint:

What are the stages of team development a team may go through?

Explanation:

The Tuckman ladder includes five stages of development that teams may go through. The stages include: forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. Understanding the Tuckman ladder concept is an important concept of the Develop Team process because the project manager's management style can change from stage to stage. The project manager's frustrations may be alleviated by understanding the natural progression of the Tuckman ladder, especially team development efforts that are typical at the beginning of a project.

Details for Each Option:

A Theory X

Incorrect. Theory X was conceived by Douglas McGregor and describes a management style where workers need a lot of direction and oversight. Although the project manager may practice McGregor's theory, it is not a theory about a project team's development stages, but a theory concerning management style.

B Hierarchy of needs

Incorrect. Hierarchy of needs is Abraham Maslow's idea that humans are motivated by five different layers of motivational factors ranging from basic needs to self-actualization. Hierarchy of needs concerns an individual's motivational factors and has little relevance to the development of a project team.

C Three needs theory

Incorrect. The three needs theory from David McClelland has the premise that workers are motivated by three factors: achievements, affiliation, and power. It is a motivational theory that can be used in managing a team member but does not concern the progressions a team may go through during the project.

D Tuckman ladder

Correct. Developed by Bruce Tuckman, the Tuckman ladder is a model used to describe the development phases a team goes through and helps direct the management style of the group. The five phases of a team's development are named Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing and Adjourning. Knowing these phases may help alleviate the project manager's frustrations.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 338

PMP Exam 1

Question 73

You have been assigned to a large and complex project, and you are in the process of monitoring the overall progress of project work. During this process, you have captured details of an effective response to a variance encountered on the project.

What is the main reason for documenting this knowledge gained during the project?

A To ensure project goals remain aligned with business needs

B To keep stakeholders engaged and informed

C To support continuous improvement efforts

D To satisfy requirements set forth by the project management office (PMO)

Answer: C

Hint:

What is the main purpose of the lessons learned register?

Explanation:

The Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline contains a list of tasks for each domain, with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Task #6 from the Monitoring and Controlling domain states, "Capture, analyze, and manage lessons learned, using lessons learned management techniques in order to enable continuous improvement." The question implies that the lessons learned register had been updated with an effective response to a variance encountered during the Monitor and Control Project Work process. Lessons learned during the project should be captured in the lessons learned register where it can be used to improve performance on the current project. At the end of the project, the information documented in the lessons learned register is then transferred to an organizational process asset called the lessons learned repository, where the information can be used to benefit future projects. Therefore, of the available choices, the main reason for documenting knowledge gained during the project is to support continuous improvement efforts.

Details for Each Option:

A To ensure project goals remain aligned with business needs

Incorrect. The question suggests the lessons learned register had been updated with a best practice for addressing a variance encountered on the project. This answer choice represents the main purpose of the change management plan rather than documenting lessons learned.

B To keep stakeholders engaged and informed

Incorrect. Keeping stakeholders engaged is the main purpose of following the communications management plan. The question is asking about documenting knowledge gained during the project rather than following the communications management plan to keep stakeholders engaged.

C To support continuous improvement efforts

Correct. Knowledge gained during the project should be documented in the lessons learned register so that the information can be used to improve performance on the current project as well as future projects.

D To satisfy requirements set forth by the project management office (PMO)

Incorrect. Maintaining a lessons learned register, as implied by the question, may or may not be required by the performing organization. While this answer choice may represent a valid reason for maintaining the lessons learned register, the documentation of knowledge gained during the project serves a greater purpose than mere compliance. Another available option provides a better reason to document lessons learned during the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 113, 104; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain IV, Task 6

Question 74

You are managing a project to develop an application on two platforms. Your team has been struggling with the functionality of the application on one of the platforms. This issue has been identified as a possible risk during risk management planning. Now that the risk is realized, the agreed-upon risk response plan is being implemented.

What should be your next step?

A Determine and document individual project risks and sources of overall project risk that may affect the project

B Observe the implementation of risk response plans, track identified risks, and identify and analyze new risks

C Define how to conduct risk management activities for a project

D Assess the priority of identified risks using their probability of occurrence and impact

Answer: B

Hint:

The process of implementing agreed-upon risk response plans is an executing process.

Explanation:

After carrying out the Implement Risk Responses process, where agreed-upon risk responses are executed to address overall project risk exposure, individual project threats are minimized, and individual project opportunities are maximized, you would monitor the actions to see if they were effective. Monitor Risks is the process of monitoring the implemented risk response plans, tracking identified risks, identifying and analyzing new risks, and evaluating risk process effectiveness throughout the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Determine and document individual project risks and sources of overall project risk that may affect the project

Incorrect. This answer describes the Identify Risks process. In the scenario, you have already identified the lack of functionality on a particular type of tablet as a risk making this an incorrect response.

B Observe the implementation of risk response plans, track identified risks, and identify and analyze new risks

Correct. After implementing the agreed-upon risk response plan, your next step would be monitoring the implementation of the plan to determine if it has been effective. These monitoring activities are carried out in the Monitor Risks process which is what is described in this choice making it the best answer to the question asked.

C Define how to conduct risk management activities for a project

Incorrect. This answer defines the Plan Risk Management process. If you are implementing a risk response plan, as described in this scenario, you have already planned how you will conduct risk management.

D Assess the priority of identified risks using their probability of occurrence and impact

Incorrect. Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis is the process defined by this answer. The risk mentioned in the scenario already has an agreed-upon response plan. Therefore, the risk has previously been analyzed.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 453, 449, 419, 409, 401

Question 75

While updating the monthly cost reports, you have discovered that an error was made in the original funding request. The budgeted amount approved was based on salary rates instead of the billing rates causing a $20,500 overstatement of budgeted cost. You understand that the cost baseline should be updated.

What should you do next?

A Issue a change request

B Update the cost baseline

C Prepare cost estimates

D Issue work performance reports

Answer: A

Hint:

What is required to modify a controlled document, deliverable, or baseline?

Explanation:

When issues are found while project work is being performed, change requests can be submitted to modify some of the project artifacts, for example, the cost baseline. In this scenario, you have found an error in the original funding request, which has caused the cost baseline to be erroneously increased. The next step required to correct the cost baseline and realign it with the correct budgeted amounts would be to issue a change request.

Details for Each Option:

A Issue a change request

Correct. In the scenario described the overstatement of the estimated costs resulted in an erroneously increased cost baseline. A change request is required to modify a controlled document, deliverable, or baseline. Therefore, submitting a change request for processing

through your organization's formal change control procedures would be the next step required to resolve the overstated cost baseline.

B Update the cost baseline

Incorrect. An update to the cost baseline, regardless of the reason, requires a change request to be submitted and the change to be handled by the company's formal change control procedures. Therefore, merely updating the baseline is not the next step in resolving the issue described in the scenario.

C Prepare cost estimates

Incorrect. Cost estimates are quantitative evaluations of the probable costs required to complete project work. Cost estimates for the various project activities are added together to determine the cost baseline. In this scenario, the cost estimates are completed since you already have a cost baseline, therefore, preparing cost estimates would not be the next step to correct the cost baseline.

D Issue work performance reports

Incorrect. Work performance reports are the physical or electronic representation of work performance information. Work performance reports are distributed to create awareness of project activities in order to generate decisions. Work performance reports would be used to share the revised cost baseline but cannot be used to change the cost baseline. Therefore, issuing work performance reports is not the best answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 96

Question 76

A_project manager is planning an infrastructure project and has just completed developing the project management plan.

What should the project manager do next?

A Present the project management plan to relevant stakeholders to obtain approval

B With planning complete, proceed with project execution

C Begin the process of Identify Stakeholders

D Submit a change request to update the project management plan with the finalized version

Answer: A

The correct answer can be found in the planning domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline.

Explanation:

The Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline contains a list of tasks for each domain, with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Task #11 of the planning domain states, "Present the project management plan to the relevant stakeholders according to applicable policies and procedures in order to obtain approval to proceed with project execution." Therefore, presenting the project management plan to relevant stakeholders to obtain approval is what the project manager should do next.

Details for Each Option:

A Present the project management plan to relevant stakeholders to obtain approval

Correct. Task #11 of the planning domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline states, "Present the project management plan to the relevant

stakeholders according to applicable policies and procedures in order to obtain approval to proceed with project execution."

B With planning complete, proceed with project execution

Incorrect. While starting project execution is a plausible option, there is another answer choice which more accurately addresses the question asked. The project management plan must be reviewed and approved before project execution can begin.

C Begin the process of Identify Stakeholders

Incorrect. The Identify Stakeholders process is part of the Initiating Process Group, which should have been completed prior to project planning including the development of the project management plan.

D Submit a change request to update the project management plan with the finalized version

Incorrect. Change requests are not required until the project management plan has been finalized and approved. The question states that the project management plan has just been completed and does not indicate that it has been approved.

Reference:

Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain II, Task 11

Question 77

You have taken over a project that is in the middle of executing after the previous project manager left the company. You begin receiving numerous change requests from the sponsor and various stakeholders, but you are unaware of how to process these incoming change requests.

Which of the following sources would be most helpful to you?

A The project management plan

B The project scope statement

C The project charter

D The project sponsor

Answer: A

Which project artifact is a formal, approved document that defines how the project is managed, executed, and controlled?

Explanation:

The project management plan is a formal, approved document that defines how the project should be managed, executed, and controlled. As such, it contains information about the methods for processing change requests, making this the correct answer choice.

Details for Each Option:

A The project management plan

Correct. The project management plan details how change requests to the project should be processed.

B The project scope statement

Incorrect. The project scope statement is the document that describes the project requirements, such as key objectives, deliverables, and acceptance criteria.

C The project charter

Incorrect. The project charter is simply the document that officially starts the project. It is a high-level document that does not include project details, such as information about the methods for processing change requests.

D The project sponsor

Incorrect. Project managers should consult the project management plan, which was approved by the project sponsor, for information about how the project should be managed, executed, and controlled. Though project managers can go to the project sponsor for key questions, calls for decisions, sign-offs, and escalation of issues, it is ultimately the project manager's responsibility to gather the information needed to successfully manage the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 82-88

PMP Exam 1

Question 78

You are managing a project that is nearing its end. You have been reviewing the project management plan to ensure that all the project work is completed and that the project has met its objectives. The next thing you need to do before moving on to the next project is to complete the administrative closure of the project.

Which of the following activities will not be performed as part of this process?

A Closing seller contracts

B Transferring of project product, services, or results to operations

C Gathering and recording of project lessons learned

D Measuring stakeholder satisfaction

Answer: A

One of the answer choices is done during the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group and not during the Close Project or Phase process.

Explanation:

The scenario implies the project manager is performing the Close Project or Phase process which involves finalizing all activities for the project or phase. During this process information is archived, organizational resources are released, and the final deliverable is transferred to operations for ongoing support and maintenance. The administrative closure of a project includes the activities necessary to satisfy the completion or exit criteria for the project. All of the answer choices except closing seller contracts are involved in the administrative closure of a project. Closing seller contracts is performed during the Control Procurements process, not Close Project or Phase. Since the question asks which answer is 'not' included in the administrative closure of a project, closing the seller contracts is the correct answer.

Details for Each Option:

A Closing seller contracts

Correct. Closing seller contracts is performed during the Control Procurements process, not as part of the Close Project or Phase process, making this choice the correct answer.

B Transferring of project product, services, or results to operations

Incorrect. Once delivered by a project, the final deliverable may be handed over to a different group or organization that will support, operate, and maintain it throughout its lifecycle. This process is included in the administrative closure of a project and therefore is an incorrect answer.

C Gathering and recording of project lessons learned

Incorrect. Lessons learned and knowledge gained throughout the project are gathered and transferred to the lessons learned repository at the end of a project and are therefore part of the Close Project or Phase process.

D Measuring stakeholder satisfaction

Incorrect. Soliciting feedback from stakeholders about both the project and the product is highly beneficial to a project manager and is an important part of project closure. Therefore, this answer is incorrect.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 123

PMP Exam 1

Question 79

You are managing a project in which many independent contractors are being hired to complete project work. As you receive the completed contracts with the electronic signature of the independent contractors, you upload each of the contracts to a project file where they wait for approval by an appointed member of senior management. The onboarding process is much slower than anticipated, and your project starts out behind schedule.

What was the most likely cause of the problem?

A Noise between encoding and decoding of the message

B Lack of test and evaluation documents

C The use of push communications

D The use of pull communications

Answer: D

Hint:

What communication method was used?

Explanation:

The question indicates that the contracts are uploaded to a project file where the appointed member of senior management must retrieve them to provide the approval. The delay is caused by the contracts sitting in the project file until they are proactively pulled for approval. Of the available choices, using pull communications instead of a more appropriate method of communication is what most likely caused the problem.

Details for Each Option:

A Noise between encoding and decoding of the message

Incorrect. Noise includes interference or barriers that might compromise the understanding of the message. There is no indication of interference or barriers from the content of the question.

B Lack of test and evaluation documents

Incorrect. Test and evaluation documents are an output from the Manage Quality process and are used to evaluate the achievement of quality objectives. The scenario describes an issue with project communications rather than the quality of project deliverables.

C The use of push communications

Incorrect. If the contracts were sent directly to the appointed senior manager, then it is an example of push communications, but that is not the situation presented by the question.

D The use of pull communications

Correct. The question states that the contracts are uploaded to a project file where the appointed member of senior management must pull them to provide the approval. Of the available choices, using pull communications instead of a more appropriate method of communication is what most likely caused the problem.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 374

PMP Exam 1

Question 80

Early in project initiation, the sponsor contacts the project manager and asks them to provide a quick cost estimate for the project. The sponsor needs the estimate by the next morning before the meeting with the customer's senior management team.

How should the project manager address this situation?

A Provide an estimate based on a previous similar project

B Provide a random number

C Sum up the cost estimates of the individual work packages

D Develop the cost management plan

Answer: A

Hint:

The project is in initiation, and the sponsor needs the answer urgently.

Explanation:

Based on the information available in the question, the project is in its initiation. Therefore, it is reasonable to assume that there is a limited amount of detailed information about the project. In such instances, the analogous cost estimating technique can be used. Analogous cost estimating uses historical information from previous similar projects. Even though there is not enough information in the question to determine whether such historical information exists, of the choices provided, this is the best answer. Ideally, the analogous cost estimating technique can be applied after the cost management plan has been developed. However, the sponsor needs the information quickly. Therefore, it is better to provide a rough estimate rather than providing a random number or nothing at all.

Details for Each Option:

A Provide an estimate based on a previous similar project

Correct. Whenever available, historical information from previous similar projects is used in analogous estimating. While not ideal, of the choices provided, this is the best answer.

B Provide a random number

Incorrect. Providing a random number is an irresponsible action.

C Sum up the cost estimates of the individual work packages

Incorrect. Based on the question text, the project is in its initiation. Therefore, cost estimates of the individual work packages do not yet exist.

D Develop the cost management plan

Incorrect. It does not sound reasonable to develop the cost management plan overnight. Even if created, the cost management plan alone does not include any cost estimates.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 240-241

PMP Exam 1

Question 81

A_project team is about to start the process of translating the quality management plan into executable quality activities that incorporate the organization's quality policies into the project.

Which of the following must the team have to begin this process?

A Work performance data

B Work performance information

C Verified deliverables

D Quality control measurements

Answer: D

Hint:

Which answer choice describes an input to the Manage Quality process?

Explanation:

Translating the quality management plan into executable quality activities that incorporate the organization's quality policies into the project is the definition of the Manage Quality process. By asking "Which of the following must the team have to begin this process?" the question is ultimately suggests selecting an answer choice that represents an input to the Manage Quality

process. Of the options provided, quality control measurements are the only input to the Manage Quality process.

Details for Each Option:

A Work performance data

Incorrect. Work performance data are the raw observations and measurements collected during project work or in other words an output from the Manage and Direct Project Work process. The work performance data then become an input to the controlling processes to produce work performance information as an output. The question implies the project team is about to start the Manage Quality process, an executing process. Work performance data are not used as an input to an executing process.

B Work performance information

Incorrect. Work performance data are an input to the controlling processes where the data are analyzed in context and result in work performance information as an output from the controlling processes. The question suggests the team is about to start the Manage Quality process, an executing process. Work performance information is not used as an input to an executing process.

C Verified deliverables

Incorrect. Verified deliverables are completed project deliverables that have been checked and confirmed for correctness through the Control Quality process. The verified deliverables are an output from the Control Quality. The question is asking about an input to the Manage Quality process, making this choice an incorrect answer.

D Quality control measurements

Correct. Quality control measurements are an output from the Control Quality process. The quality control measurements then become an input to the Manage Quality process which, based on the scenario described, is the process that the team is about to undertake. The Manage Quality process uses quality control measurements to evaluate the quality of the processes and deliverables against specified requirements.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 288-291, 26

PMP Exam 1

Question 82

As part of the Estimate Costs process, you have instructed a team member to complete cost estimates by calculating the cost of each work package and then summarizing the estimates.

Based on your instructions, what method should the team member use?

A Analogous estimating

B Parametric estimating

C Bottom-up estimating

D Cost aggregation

Answer: C

This method calculates costs at the lowest level of the work breakdown structure (WBS) and rolls up or summarizes the costs to higher levels.

Explanation:

Bottom-up estimating calculates cost estimates using the low-level components of the work breakdown structure (WBS) within the project. Those calculations are then rolled up or summarized to higher levels and used for reporting and tracking throughout the project. Detailing

costs to this level can improve estimate accuracy. However, size and other work package elements will typically be the ultimate accuracy influencing factors.

Details for Each Option:

A Analogous estimating

Incorrect. Analogous estimating uses costs from previous projects of a similar nature to estimate current project costs rather than a breakdown of cost per task in each work package.

B Parametric estimating

Incorrect. Parametric estimating uses relevant historical data and other project specific variables to calculate a cost estimate versus using the cost per task in each work package.

C Bottom-up estimating

Correct. Bottom-up estimating, a method used to estimate costs, involves the calculation of the decomposed components of the work breakdown structure (WBS). Using this method of dissecting the WBS to its the lowest levels (work packages) can lead to improved estimate accuracy. The results are then summarized and used for reporting and tracking.

D Cost aggregation

Incorrect. Cost aggregation is one of the tools used during the Determine Budget process, while, according to the scenario described, the team member is involved in the Estimate Costs process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 244

PMP Exam 1

Question 83

An accounts payable manager withholds the payment for the rental of a piece of equipment. The rental company claims the money is due in full because the piece of equipment was necessary to fulfill the objectives of the statement of work defined in the contract. Further talks lead nowhere as both parties cannot come to an agreement.

What is the next step for them to take in this situation?

A Attempt alternative dispute resolution

B Go to court

C Approach local government officials

D Start direct negotiations

Answer: A

Hint:

fail, ADR is the next step. Litigation in courts is the last resort. Try to determine what step the parties have already taken in this scenario.

Explanation:

In this case, the organization for which the accounts payable manager works is the buyer and the rental equipment company is the seller. Settling claims and disputes through direct negotiation between the involved parties is the preferred method. Knowing this fact may lead you to believe that starting negotiations is the correct answer, so that the two sides can resolve the issue without outside assistance. However, based on the scenario described, the parties have already attempted to negotiate directly to no avail. If the parties involved cannot resolve a claim themselves, it may have to be handled in accordance with alternative dispute resolution (ADR) procedures, usually

defined in the project contract. ADR typically uses a third-party negotiator, mediator or arbitrator to settle disagreements to avoid litigation. Litigation is often not advantageous to either party, so going to court is not the first method to pursue when the buyer and seller are unable to resolve a claim. Therefore, of the choices provided, ADR is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Attempt alternative dispute resolution

Correct. When the buyer and seller cannot reach an agreement on compensation for a contested change, also known as a claim, they should try alternative dispute resolution (ADR) first to resolve the issue. ADR follows procedures established in the contract instead of taking the dispute to court.

B Go to court

Incorrect. ADR procedures are put in the contract to avoid often lengthy and expensive legal means of settling disagreements. Going to court is not the settlement method the parties should pursue first if they are unable to resolve the dispute themselves.

C Approach local government officials

Incorrect. Disputes on projects are typically resolved by either direct negotiations, ADR, or litigation in court. Approaching local government officials sounds ambiguous. It is not clear what the parties would exactly try to achieve by approaching local government officials, making this choice an incorrect answer.

D Start direct negotiations

Incorrect. Direct negotiations between the involved parties is a preferred method to settle claims and disputes. However, based on the scenario described, the parties have already attempted to negotiate directly without success. The next step is the ADR.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 489, 498

PMP Exam 1

Question 84

A_project manager has compiled a project performance report as requested by the project sponsor. The project manager prepares an email to communicate her findings. She is careful to format the report in a way that can be easily understood by the sponsor once received.

Which of the following components of a basic communication model will be used by the project manager and the sponsor?

A Encode and decode

B Choice of media

C Interactive communication

D Writing style

Answer: A

One of these options contains steps that are part of a basic communication model, describing how information is sent and received between two parties.

Explanation:

Encoding is defined as translating thoughts or ideas into language by the sender. the project manager is preparing an encoded message by translating the information into language which could be understood by the receiver. The email will then be transmitted, which is the second step

in the basic communication model. Once received, the email will be decoded or translated into a useful form by the sponsor.

Details for Each Option:

A Encode and decode

Correct. Encoding and decoding are components of a basic communication model. In preparing the email, the project manager is the sender encoding information in a manner that can be understood by the sponsor, and as the receiver, the sponsor will decode the message once received. An additional component transmits the message (sending the email). Transmission occurs between the 'encode' and 'decode' steps.

B Choice of media

Incorrect. This question is asking about the components of a basic communication model, whereas the choice of media is a technique for effective communication that involves making decisions about appropriate communications applications.

C Interactive communication

Incorrect. Interactive communication models move beyond basic communication to incorporate a means of providing acknowledgment and feedback/response. The question is asking about the 'basic' communication model which focuses on encoding, transmitting, and decoding the message without ensuring it was properly received and understood. For those of you who are familiar with the IT world, think of the basic communication as UDP and interactive communication as TCP.

D Writing style

Incorrect. A writing style is the use of active versus passive voice, sentence structure, and word choice. The writing style is not a component of a basic communication model.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 371

PMP Exam 1

Question 85

A_project to develop a new e-commerce website server has been completed. However, when the server was deployed on the customer network, it was unable to meet reliability and performance requirements and frequently crashed resulting in lost sales and customer dissatisfaction.

What type of requirements was most likely overlooked during testing?

A Business

B Project

C Solution

D Stakeholder

Answer: C

Hint:

Those requirements are further grouped into functional and nonfunctional requirements.

Explanation:

Having sufficient capacity for transactions is an example of a nonfunctional requirement. Nonfunctional requirements supplement the functional requirements to represent the solution requirements. Solution requirements describe the features, functions, and characteristics of the product, service, or result that will meet the business and stakeholder requirements. In the scenario, the server was unable to meet reliability and performance requirements. Reliability and performance requirements are examples of nonfunctional requirements, which, in turn, are a

subset of the solution requirements. Therefore, overlooking the testing of solution requirements to verify the performance and reliability of the website server was the most likely the cause of the problem described by the question.

Details for Each Option:

A Business

Incorrect. The business requirements describe the higher-level needs of the organization as a whole. Finer details such as website server capacity are not likely to be captured in the business requirements.

B Project

Incorrect. Project requirements describe the actions, processes, or other conditions that a project needs to meet. Examples include milestone dates, contractual obligations, constraints, etc. None of those examples cover technical requirements such as the website server capacity.

C Solution

Correct. Having sufficient capacity for the transaction volume is an example of a nonfunctional requirement which is part of the wider classification, called solution requirements.

D Stakeholder

Incorrect. Stakeholder requirements describe needs of a stakeholder or stakeholder group. While any requirement can be categorized as a stakeholder requirement, another answer choice more accurately addresses the question asked.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 148

PMP Exam 1

Question 86

You are reviewing the resource allocation for a project that you are managing. You discover that one of the raw materials you received is of lower quality than what was originally approved.

What should you do?

A Revise the issue log

B Update the lessons learned register

C Revise the resource register

D Update the quality management plan

Answer: A

Hint:

What project document is used to record and monitor problems as they are identified?

Explanation:

Reviewing resource allocation is part of the Control Resources process. The key benefit of this process is ensuring the assigned resources are available to the project when needed. Updates to project documents are among the outputs of the Control Resources process. New issues found during this process are recorded in the issue log. Therefore, when you discover that the raw materials received is of lower quality than what was originally approved, then the issue log should be revised.

Details for Each Option:

A Revise the issue log

Correct. The issue log is a project document used to identify and monitor issues that occur in the project. The issue log can be updated with any new issues found during the Control Resources process described in the scenario, making this choice the best answer to the question asked.

B Update the lessons learned register

Incorrect. The lessons learned register is a project document used to record lessons gained during a project, so they can be used as the project progresses. While issues and their resolution may eventually be added to the lessons learned register, in this scenario you have just found the issue and do not yet have the resolution.

C Revise the resource register

Incorrect. The 'resource register' is a made-up term.

D Update the quality management plan

Incorrect. The quality management plan describes how applicable policies, procedures, and guidelines will be implemented to achieve quality objectives. The fact the issue with the quality has been found indicates that the quality activities are likely adequate implying there is no need to update the quality management plan.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 352-354

Question 87

A_project manager is leading a project for a client. After the project was baselined, the client requests to change the process that specifies how formal acceptance of the completed project deliverables will be obtained. Instead of accepting the final product at the end of the project as originally planned, the client wants to review and accept each of the major project deliverables individually.

With the request approved by the CCB, what should the project manager do next?

A Document the status of the change request in the change management plan

B Modify the development approach of the project from traditional to agile

C Submit a change request to update the project management plan

D Update the scope management plan to reflect the requested changes

Answer: D

What component of the project management plan includes a description of how formal acceptance of the completed project deliverables will be obtained?

Explanation:

Scope management plan is a component of the project management plan that describes how the scope will be defined, developed, monitored, controlled, and validated. The scope management plan includes a description of the process that specifies how formal acceptance of the completed project deliverables will be obtained. The question is describing a requested change to that process. With the change request approved by the change control board (CCB), the next logical step is to update the scope management plan to reflect the requested changes.

Details for Each Option:

A Document the status of the change request in the change management plan

Incorrect. The change management plan specifies how the change requests will be managed on a project. The plan does not document the status of the change requests. This information is captured in the change log.

B Modify the development approach of the project from traditional to agile

Incorrect. The development approach is a component of the project management plan that describes the approach that will be taken by the project to deliver the product, service, or result. It is unlikely that the development approach will need to be changed as a result of the change in the process that specifies how formal acceptance of the completed project deliverables will be obtained.

C Submit a change request to update the project management plan

Incorrect. The change control board (CCB) is a formally chartered group responsible for reviewing, evaluating, approving, delaying, or rejecting changes to the project. The question indicates that the change request has already been reviewed and approved by the CCB. Therefore, there is no reason to submit another change request.

D Update the scope management plan to reflect the requested changes

Correct. The question implies that a change request to update the scope management plan with the new process of how the project deliverables are accepted has been approved by the change control board (CCB). With the change request approved, the next logical step is to update the scope management plan as requested.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 137, 171

Question 88

Four vendors have responded to a bid request on your project.

Which of the following vendors should you select based on the expected monetary value (EMV)?

A Vendor 1 with an 80% probability of success and profit of $20,000

B Vendor 2 with a 90% probability of success and profit of $19,000

C Vendor 3 with a 75% probability of success and profit of $18,000

D Vendor 4 with an 85% probability of success and profit of $20,000

Answer: B

Hint:

Which vendor provides the highest EMV?

Explanation:

The expected monetary value (EMV) technique is one that calculates the combined probability and impact values of a decision or a solution. This question requires a simple multiplication of the profit anticipated from a vendor by the probability of the vendor's success. Selecting Vendor 2 is the correct answer because they provide a solution with the highest EMV.

Details for Each Option:

A Vendor 1 with an 80% probability of success and profit of $20,000

Incorrect. Vendor 1's solution is calculated as 0.80 x $20,000 = $16,000, which is not the highest EMV possible of the answer choices given.

B Vendor 2 with a 90% probability of success and profit of $19,000

Correct. Vendor 2's solution is calculated as 0.90 x $19,000 = $17,100, which represents the highest profit to the project from the answer choices given.

C Vendor 3 with a 75% probability of success and profit of $18,000

Incorrect. Vendor 3's solution is calculated as 0.75 x $18,000 = $13,500, which is not the highest EMV possible of the answer choices given.

D Vendor 4 with an 85% probability of success and profit of $20,000

Incorrect. Vendor 4's solution is calculated as 0.85 x $20,000 = $17,000, which is not the highest EMV possible of the answer choices given.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 435

PMP Exam 1

Question 89

During your search for an external contractor, you are evaluating proposals received in response to the bid package. Your evaluation includes ensuring the complete response to the bid documents, procurement statement of work, source selection criteria, and any additional documents that went out in the bid package.

What tool or technique are you using?

A Selected sellers

B Advertising

C Joint engagements

D Data analysis

Answer: D

This tool or technique is intended to ensure the completeness of documents when obtaining seller responses during the process of selecting a seller and awarding a contract.

Explanation:

The scenario implies the Conduct Procurements process is being carried out. Proposal evaluation is an example of the data analysis techniques that can be used as part of this process. Proposals are evaluated to ensure they are complete and respond in full to the bid documents, procurement statement of work, and any additional documents that went out in the bid package. Proposal evaluation is one of several tools and techniques grouped based on its intent or purpose. In this case, the proposal evaluation's purpose is analysis. It is one of 27 tools and techniques that belong to the data analysis group.

Details for Each Option:

A Selected sellers

Incorrect. Selected sellers are not a tool or technique of the Conduct Procurement process but instead are outputs of the process and are the result of a proposal or bid evaluation.

B Advertising

Incorrect. The question information does not fit the definition of advertising, which is communicating with existing or potential users of a product, service or result.

C Joint engagements

Incorrect. This is a fictitious answer created for this question.

D Data analysis

Correct. This scenario depicts the use of proposal evaluation which is a component of the data analysis group. Proposal evaluation is a technique used in the Conduct Procurements process to ensure the completeness of seller responses to bid packages. It is one of the 27 techniques included in the data analysis group which are used in various processes.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 487, 685-694

PMP Exam 1

Question 90

After completing your project's planning, you have selected the team members and determined their roles and responsibilities.

What should you do next?

A Create the stakeholder register

B Document the information in the project team directory

C Conduct individual and team assessments

D Capture the information in the project charter as pre-assigned resources

Answer: B

Where should the team members along with their roles and responsibilities be documented as a result of the Acquire Resources process?

Explanation:

The question implies that the Acquire Resources process is being carried out. Project team assignments are one of the outputs of this process. Documentation of team assignments records the team members and their roles and responsibilities for the project in the project team directory. The incorrect answer choices represent actions that should be performed during processes other than the Acquire Resources process. Therefore, of the available choices, the next logical step is to document the information in the project team directory.

Details for Each Option:

A Create the stakeholder register

Incorrect. The question implies that the Acquire Resources process is being carried out. The stakeholder register is created as the result of the Identify Stakeholders process and not the Acquire Resources process. The stakeholder register may be updated during the Acquire Resources process, but it would not be created as it should already exist at this point in the project.

B Document the information in the project team directory

Correct. Project team assignments are one of the outputs of the Acquire Resources process. Documentation of team assignments records the team members and their roles and responsibilities for the project. Documentation can include a project team directory.

C Conduct individual and team assessments

Incorrect. Individual and team assessment tools give the project manager and the project team insight into areas of strengths and weaknesses. However, individual and team assessments are used as part of the Develop Team process rather than the Acquire Resources process described in the question.

D Capture the information in the project charter as pre-assigned resources

Incorrect. When physical or team resources for a project are determined in advance, they are considered pre-assigned. Pre-assignment may occur during the Develop Project Charter process or other processes before the initial resource management plan has been completed. However,

the question implies that the Acquire Resources process is being performed in this scenario. Therefore, these resource assignments would not be considered pre-assigned.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 334

PMP Exam 1

Question 91

As a vendor contract is being closed, a project manager discovers that the vendor never submitted a final invoice. The project manager contacts the vendor, who apologizes for the delay and agrees to submit the final invoice within the week. The project manager is under a lot of pressure from senior management and the accounting office to close the project on schedule and knows that it will take several weeks to receive and process the vendor's final payment.

What is the project manager's best course of action?

A Keep the contract open until the invoice arrives and then immediately close the project

B Keep the contract open until the invoice arrives, pay the invoice, and then proceed with closing the project, even though it will be several weeks late

C Close the contract on schedule; the project work is complete, and accounting can send payment to the vendor later

D Close the contract on schedule and notify the vendor that the outstanding invoice will not be paid

Answer: B

Hint:

Typically, what are the requirements for formal procurement closure?

Explanation:

Closed procurements is an output of the Control Procurements process. To close procurements, the buyer will typically provide the seller with formal written notice that the contract has been completed and that all deliverables have been approved. Though requirements for formal procurement closure vary by project and are defined in the terms and conditions of the contract as well as the procurement management plan, typically there should be no outstanding claims or invoices prior to closure. Should a problem arise with the invoice or the contract, the project manager will need the contract open and the project team available to address it. Therefore, the project manager should follow the process and keep the contract open until the invoice is paid and then proceed with closing the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Keep the contract open until the invoice arrives and then immediately close the project

Incorrect. Before contract closure, there should be no outstanding claims or invoices, and all final payments should have been made. Once the project manager receives the invoice and final payment has been made, the contract has officially been completed and can be closed.

B Keep the contract open until the invoice arrives, pay the invoice, and then proceed with closing the project, even though it will be several weeks late

Correct. The project manager and his team should receive and approve all deliverables, and make all final payments, prior to closure. This is essential in case of a problem with the final invoice or another contract situation. If a contract issue arises but the contract has already been closed and the project team released, the project manager could run into some serious problems.

C Close the contract on schedule; the project work is complete, and accounting can send payment to the vendor later

Incorrect. While this may seem harmless, it is risky to close the contract before resolving the outstanding invoice issue. Typically, there should be no outstanding claims or invoices, and all final payments should have been made, prior to contract closure.

D Close the contract on schedule and notify the vendor that the outstanding invoice will not be paid

Incorrect. Refusing to pay the final invoice because it is late and the project manager would like to close the contract on schedule could potentially violate the terms and conditions of the contract or lead to a contract dispute with the vendor. The buyer should pay the vendor for the project work that was completed and then formally close the contract.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 499

PMP Exam 1

Question 92

While identifying risks, you learn that one of the selected vendors may not be as stable as you had initially thought. Therefore, you create a list of backup suppliers and plan a risk response that involves hiring one of the alternate suppliers. During the project execution, you received notice that the selected vendor has just filed for bankruptcy and will not deliver as contracted.

What process will be used next to keep your project on track and all stakeholders satisfied?

A Manage Stakeholder Engagement

B Implement Risk Responses

C Plan Risk Responses

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Answer: B

Risk responses are developed during the planning phase, whereas implementing a risk response is performed during execution.

Explanation:

Risk management includes planning, identification, analysis, response planning, response implementation, and monitoring risk on a project. In this scenario, the risk of the instability of the current vendor had been identified, and a risk response plan to create a list of alternate suppliers was developed. When the current vendor declared bankruptcy, the risk occurred. The next step would be to use the Implement Risk Responses process for that particular risk which involved hiring an alternate supplier. All of this is supposed to keep the project on track and, as a result, the stakeholders satisfied.

Details for Each Option:

A Manage Stakeholder Engagement

Incorrect. Manage Stakeholder Engagement is the process of communicating and working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations. It allows the project manager to increase support and minimize resistance from stakeholders. This scenario describes planning for and realizing a risk, not managing stakeholders.

B Implement Risk Responses

Correct. Implement Risk Responses is the process of executing agreed-upon risk response plans. The original supplier in the scenario has declared bankruptcy. During the risk management planning, you had compiled a list of alternate suppliers with the understanding that you would hire one of the alternates should the need arise. All that remains to be done is implementing that risk response plan.

C Plan Risk Responses

Incorrect. Plan Risk Responses is the process of developing options and selecting strategies to address and treat risks should they occur. The plan to hire an alternate supplier from a predetermined list, as described in this scenario, is an example of the Plan Risk Response process. Therefore, this has already been completed.

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis is the process of determining which risks require action by assessing their probability of occurrence and impact. In this scenario, you have already identified a risk response by creating a list of alternate suppliers. Therefore, you have previously performed a qualitative analysis of this risk.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 449

PMP Exam 1

Question 93

You want to build an atmosphere of trust among the team and stakeholders and motivate them to share their knowledge.

Which of the following tool or technique would help your team the most to achieve your goal?

A Flowcharting

B Networking

C Brainstorming

D Document analysis

Answer: B

What tool or technique can be used as part of the Manage Project Knowledge process to share tacit knowledge?

Explanation:

Knowledge is split into two forms, explicit and tacit. Explicit knowledge is easily documented, such as lessons learned, while tacit knowledge is difficult to express, such as experience, beliefs, or insights. Sharing tacit knowledge is difficult because it resides in the minds of people who typically cannot be forced to share what they know. Allowing for informal interaction, or networking, among team members and stakeholders can build an atmosphere of trust thereby motivating people to share their tacit knowledge. Networking is one of the tools and techniques of the Manage Project Knowledge process implied by the scenario and, based on the scenario described, is the best tool for you to use to achieve your goal.

Details for Each Option:

A Flowcharting

Incorrect. A flowchart can display a series of steps that lead to an outcome. Flowcharts are an example of the data representation technique that is typically used as part of the Plan Quality Management process and the Manage Quality process, while the scenario suggests you are in the Manage Project Knowledge process.

B Networking

Correct. Knowledge is best shared using a combination of reviewing documentation and providing opportunities to interact with those who have previous experience. Networking allows natural connections among team members and stakeholders creating conditions for them to share and learn from each other.

C Brainstorming

Incorrect. Brainstorming is a facilitated session used to generate a lot of ideas in a short period. You are seeking for a way to share knowledge among the team and stakeholders. Brainstorming sessions may only partially address this need.

D Document analysis

Incorrect. Document analysis consists of reviewing documented information. This technique can be applied individually or in groups but is unlikely to make a significant contribution to knowledge sharing among the team and stakeholders.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 103

PMP Exam 1

Question 94

The CEO of your company has taken a strong personal interest in your project and has been very involved in status meetings, day-to-day project activities, and decision-making. Meanwhile, the sponsor seems unsupportive of the work, shows no interest in the project, and even threatens to cancel it to prioritize other contracts.

How should the CEO and project sponsor be classified in the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix?

A The CEO is leading; the sponsor is unaware.

B The CEO is supportive; the sponsor is resistant.

C The CEO is leading; the sponsor is resistant.

D The CEO is neutral; the sponsor is resistant.

Answer: C

In a stakeholder engagement assessment matrix, what is the highest possible engagement level of stakeholders?

Explanation:

Data representation is a technique of the Plan Stakeholder Engagement process. A stakeholder engagement assessment matrix is a data representation technique used to compare the current engagement levels of stakeholders and the desired engagement levels required for successful project delivery. One way of assessing engagement is the following:

- Unaware: The stakeholder is not aware of the project nor its outcomes.
- Resistant: The stakeholder is aware of the project but does not support it.
- Neutral: The stakeholder is ambivalent about the project and its outcomes.
- Supportive: The stakeholder feels favorable about the project and its outcomes.
- Leading: The stakeholder is actively engaged in promoting the project.

In this scenario, the CEO is actively engaged in the project by attending regular status meetings and being involved in day-to-day project decisions and activities. This stakeholder is, therefore, best classified as leading. Conversely, the sponsor is disengaged, shows no interest in the project, and even threatens to cancel it in order to address higher priority contracts, which suggests that the sponsor is unsupportive of the project. Therefore, the sponsor should be classified as resistant. While having an unsupportive sponsor may look counterintuitive, of the choices provided, "The CEO is leading; the sponsor is resistant", is the best answer.

Details for Each Option:

A The CEO is leading; the sponsor is unaware.

Incorrect. The CEO can be correctly classified as leading, but the sponsor is not unaware of the project. The sponsor is aware of the project but unsupportive of the work, which closely matches the definition of a resistant stakeholder.

B The CEO is supportive; the sponsor is resistant.

Incorrect. The CEO is not just aware of the project and supportive of the work. The CEO is actively engaged in decision-making and ensuring the project's success, and therefore best classified as leading. The sponsor would be correctly classified as resistant, but since the first part of the answer is incorrect, this cannot be the correct answer choice.

C The CEO is leading; the sponsor is resistant.

Correct. The best way to classify the CEO's engagement level is as leading. That is, the CEO is aware of the project and is actively engaged in promoting the project and ensuring its success. The sponsor's actions, however, suggest that they are unsupportive of the project, making this an example of a resistant stakeholder.

D The CEO is neutral; the sponsor is resistant.

Incorrect. Although it is never explicitly stated whether the CEO feels positively or negatively about the project, the CEO's personal interest in the project and active involvement in meetings and project decision-making suggests that this stakeholder is leading, not neutral. The sponsor would be correctly classified as resistant, but since the first part of the answer is incorrect, this cannot be the correct answer choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 512-522

PMP Exam 1

Question 95

You are currently in the process of making cost estimates for a software development project. You have determined that in the best-case scenario, the development would cost $140,000. In a worst-case scenario, it would cost $250,000. However, it would most likely cost $180,000. After performing some calculations, you establish a cost estimate of $185,000.

What estimating technique did you use?

A Three-point estimating: triangular distribution

B Cost variance (CV)

C Three-point estimating: beta distribution

D Cost performance index (CPI)

Answer: C

Hint:

What type of formula for estimating costs utilizes a weighted average?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the project team is conducting the Estimate Costs process. A beta distribution is an example of a three-point estimating technique that may be used in the Estimate Costs process. A beta distribution is calculated by applying a weighted average of optimistic, pessimistic, and most likely estimates. In this case, the cost estimate is calculated as ($140,000 + (4 * $180,000) + $250,000) / 6 which results in a cost estimate of $185,000.

Details for Each Option:

A Three-point estimating: triangular distribution

Incorrect. A triangular distribution can be calculated by taking the average of the optimistic, pessimistic, and most likely cost estimates. Based on the estimates provided in the question, a calculation with a triangular distribution results in a cost estimate of $190,000, not $185,000.

B Cost variance (CV)

Incorrect. A cost variance (CV) is the amount of budget deficit or surplus at a given point in time, expressed as the difference between the earned value and the actual cost. A cost variance is not an estimating technique.

C Three-point estimating: beta distribution

Correct. A beta distribution is a method to estimate cost by applying a weighted average of the optimistic, pessimistic, and most likely estimates. With the data supplied by the question, the cost estimate is calculated as ($140,000 + (4 * $180,000) + $250,000) / 6 which results in a cost estimate of $185,000.

D Cost performance index (CPI)

Incorrect. A cost performance index (CPI) is a measure of the cost efficiency of budgeted resources expressed as the ratio of earned value to actual cost. A cost performance index is not an estimating technique.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 244, 245

Question 96

The project requires ongoing stakeholder engagement and needs to respond to high levels of change. The project manager has chosen an adaptive life cycle for the project. The backlog contains an ordered list of requirements and work. At the beginning of each iteration, the team determines how many of the items on the backlog can be delivered within the next iteration.

Which process(es) will the project team need to repeat with each iteration?

A Define Scope

B Collect Requirements and Create WBS

C Collect Requirements and Define Scope

D Collect Requirements, Define Scope, and Create WBS

Answer: D

The project manager will need to begin each iteration with processes from the Project Scope Management Knowledge Area.

Explanation:

In the scenario described, the project is managed with an adaptive life cycle. Projects with adaptive life cycles are intended to respond to high levels of change and require close and consistent stakeholder engagement. Often the full scope of the project is not understood at the beginning of the project, or it evolves during the project. Therefore, the deliverables are developed over multiple iterations where a detailed scope is defined and approved at the beginning of each iteration. In an adaptive life cycle, a high-level vision for the project is decomposed into an ordered list of requirements and work which is contained in the backlog list. At the beginning of each iteration, the team determines how many of the items on the backlog list can be delivered with the iteration. This action corresponds to the Collect Requirements process. The chosen requirements from the backlog list are then used to define a detailed scope for that iteration. Lastly, the scope for the iteration is decomposed into the work required for that iteration's approved scope, meaning the Create WBS process is performed. Therefore, the processes of Collect Requirements, Define Scope, and Create WBS are performed for each iteration of the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Define Scope

Incorrect. Before beginning the iteration, the team determines which items on the backlog will be delivered or, in other words, which requirements will be addressed in the iteration. The requirements will be used to define a detailed scope for the iteration. Therefore, the iteration requires more than the Define Scope process.

B Collect Requirements and Create WBS

Incorrect. In an adaptive life cycle, the deliverables are developed over multiple iterations where a detailed scope is defined and approved for each iteration when it begins. While Collect Requirements and Create WBS are performed with each iteration, so is Define Scope. Therefore, this is not the best answer to the question asked.

C Collect Requirements and Define Scope

Incorrect. In an adaptive life cycle, the requirements constitute the backlog, and the team will determine how many of the requirements will be delivered in the next iteration. After the requirements are determined for the iteration, a detailed scope will be defined. However, the iteration also needs to be broken down into manageable parts for execution, which is accomplished through the Create WBS process. This answer is missing the Create WBS process.

D Collect Requirements, Define Scope, and Create WBS

Correct. In an adaptive lifecycle, the deliverables are developed over multiple iterations. At the beginning of each iteration, the team will determine how many of the requirements on the backlog can be delivered in the next iteration, and a detailed scope is defined and approved. The detailed scope is decomposed into manageable pieces of work through the Create WBS process. Therefore, three processes are repeated for each iteration; Collect Requirements, Define Scope, and Create WBS.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 131

PMP Exam 1

Question 97

A_project manager is planning a technology development project and is trying to determine if it is best to produce the software using internal resources or purchase the product from an outside source.

What tool or technique will be most useful for the project manager?

A Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis

B Product analysis

C Make-or-buy analysis

D Reserve analysis

Answer: C

What data analysis technique is used to determine whether it is better to produce a product internally or purchase it from an external source?

Explanation:

Based on the scenario described, the project manager is performing the Plan Procurement Management process. Make-or-buy analysis is a data analysis technique used during this process. Make-or-buy analysis is utilized to determine whether project deliverables can best be accomplished by the performing organization or should be purchased from outside sources. Factors to consider in the make-or-buy decision include the organization's current resource allocation and their skills and abilities, the need for specialized expertise, the desire not to expand permanent employment obligations, and the need for independent expertise. The project manager should use the data analysis technique of make-or-buy analysis in this case.

Details for Each Option:

A Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis is a process, not a tool or technique.

B Product analysis

Incorrect. Product analysis is used to ‘define’ products and services, not to determine whether to produce them internally or purchase from the outside sources.

C Make-or-buy analysis

Correct. Make-or-buy analysis is a technique to gather and organize data about product requirements and analyze them against available alternatives including the purchase or internal manufacture of the product.

D Reserve analysis

Incorrect. Reserve analysis is used to determine the amount of contingency and management reserve needed for the project. Reserve analysis is not used to determine whether the product or service should be produced by the performing organization or procured from the external sources.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 473

PMP Exam 1

Question 98

What is the key benefit of developing a charter for a project?

A Providing the project manager with the formal authority to manage the project

B Creating a contract between the project manager and the performing organization

C Linking the project to the strategic objectives of the performing organization

D Creating a comprehensive document that defines the basis of all project work

Answer: C

Do not confuse between the purpose of the project charter as a document and the key benefit of carrying out the Develop Project Charter process.

Explanation:

This question is an example of a few straightforward one-line knowledge-based questions that prospective PMP aspirants may encounter on their exam. The question is not asking to provide a definition of a project charter. Rather, the question is asking to select an answer choice that best describes the key benefit of developing a charter for a project. In other words, the question is

asking, "What is the key benefit of the Develop Project Charter process?" As stated in the reference provided, "The key benefits of this process are that it provides a direct link between the project and the strategic objectives of the organization, creates a formal record of the project, and shows the organizational commitment to the project."

Details for Each Option:

A Providing the project manager with the formal authority to manage the project

Incorrect. While it is true that the project charter provides the project manager with the authority to manage the project, the question is asking about the key benefit of the process of developing the project charter, rather than the purpose of the project charter as a document.

B Creating a contract between the project manager and the performing organization

Incorrect. A project charter is not considered a contract because there is no consideration or money promised or exchanged in its creation.

C Linking the project to the strategic objectives of the performing organization

Correct. One of the key benefits of developing the project charter is to provide a direct link between the project and the strategic objectives of the organization.

D Creating a comprehensive document that defines the basis of all project work

Incorrect. Creating a comprehensive document that defines the basis of all project work is the key benefit of the Develop Project Management Plan process, not the Develop Project Charter process. The project charter is a document that describes high-level information about the project, rather than provides a comprehensive plan.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 75

PMP Exam 1

Question 99

Due to confidentiality requirements, all of your project's communications are uploaded to a secure intranet website where the information can be accessed by stakeholders. However, during project execution, you had to spend a lot of time repeating project information to the stakeholders as many of them complained that they are not always up to date on the communications. You have discussed this issue with the project sponsor who says the communication method cannot be changed.

What is the most likely reason behind the project sponsor's comment?

A The communication breakdown structure is flawed

B The pull communication method is inadequate

C The enterprise environmental factors are imposing a constraint

D The contingent response strategies are lacking

Answer: C

What term describes conditions not under the control of the project team that influence, constrain, or direct the project?

Explanation:

Enterprise environmental factors (EEFs) refer to conditions, not under the control of the project team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project. In this scenario, established communication channels, tools, and systems influence the company's decision to use a secure website for project

communications. EEFs are typically not under the control of the project team which is likely the reason the sponsor said that the communication method could not be changed. Therefore, of the choices provided, enterprise environmental factors is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A The communication breakdown structure is flawed

Incorrect. 'Communication breakdown structure' is a made-up term.

B The pull communication method is inadequate

Incorrect. Pull communication is a communication method used for large audiences. This method requires the recipients to access content at their own discretion. While the website described in the scenario is an example of pull communication, the question does not ask about the communication method used, but rather about the situation or condition that forces the stakeholders to access the information.

C The enterprise environmental factors are imposing a constraint

Correct. Enterprise environmental factors (EEFs) are conditions established by the company that are not under the immediate control of the project team. The conditions created by enterprise environmental factors influence, constrain, or direct the project. The question suggests that the secure website is a requirement based on the company's EEFs.

D The contingent response strategies are lacking

Incorrect. Contingent response strategies are developed while planning risk responses. This scenario does not involve risk management; therefore, it is not the correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 388-391, 371, 38-39

PMP Exam 1

Question 100

A_project manager performed the Validate Scope process with the customer, and they have accepted the deliverables. The project manager is now in the process of finalizing all activities for the project.

Which of the following tools or techniques would be appropriate for identifying lessons learned for future projects and for improving the assets of the company?

A Document analysis

B Alternatives analysis

C Cost-benefit analysis

D Product analysis

Answer: A

Hint:

What must the project manager do when closing out a project?

Explanation:

When closing a project, the project manager needs to make sure that all documents are up-to-date, which can be done using the document analysis technique. While conducting the document analysis, the project manager can identify information to improve the company's organizational process assets by capturing lessons learned and knowledge gained from project implementation. All the other answer choices could be eliminated because they are not tools and techniques performed during the Close Project or Phase process, which is the process described by the scenario.

Details for Each Option:

A Document analysis

Correct. Document analysis is a data analysis technique that can be used during the Close Project or Phase process. Document analysis consists of reviewing and assessing any relevant documented information, which will allow you to identify lessons learned that project managers can use on future projects. By capturing the lessons learned and knowledge of the project, you are contributing to the company's organizational process assets.

B Alternatives analysis

Incorrect. The alternatives analysis technique is used to evaluate options in order to select the best options among alternatives to execute the work of the project. You can eliminate alternatives analysis as a correct choice because it is not a technique used during the Close Project or Phase process which is described by the scenario.

C Cost-benefit analysis

Incorrect. Cost-benefit analysis is a financial analysis tool used to determine the benefits of a project versus its costs. Cost-benefit analysis is unlikely to help in identifying lessons learned for future projects and for improving the assets of your company.

D Product analysis

Incorrect. Product analysis is a tool used in the Define Scope process where questions are asked about the product and answers are formed to describe the use, characteristics, and other relevant aspects of what is going to be manufactured. Product analysis has nothing to do with the process described in the question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 126

PMP Exam 1

Question 101

Throughout a project, the project team's overall performance should be evaluated to identify specific training, assistance, or changes needed to improve performance. Using the results from formal or informal evaluations, the project manager can take action to resolve issues, modify communication, address conflict and strengthen team interaction.

Which of the following would be used in this situation?

A Team performance assessments

B Work performance reports

C Enterprise environmental factors

D Project team assignments

Answer: A

During the Manage Team process, this is an important aspect of reviewing and tracking team performance to optimize overall project performance.

Explanation:

Team performance assessments are inputs to the Manage Team process and should be used throughout the project life cycle to evaluate a team's performance and effectiveness. By using project-specific indicators, the project management team can assess and identify specific training, coaching, mentoring, assistance, or changes required to improve performance. Regular formal and informal assessments allow the project management team to address issues and develop strategies to increase the likelihood of successfully meeting project goals.

Details for Each Option:

A Team performance assessments

Correct. This question aptly describes team performance assessments, which are used throughout the project life cycle to evaluate team performance. Assessment results provide project managers with information that may help identify specific training, coaching, mentoring, assistance, or changes needed to improve the team's overall performance and effectiveness.

B Work performance reports

Incorrect. Work performance reports are the physical or electronic representation of work performance information compiled from various controlling processes. This includes information such as status reports of deliverables, information notes, and electronic dashboards. Work performance reports would not be the appropriate option to complete the evaluations referenced.

C Enterprise environmental factors

Incorrect. This question references actions that can be taken to make improvements. Enterprise environmental factors are conditions that are beyond the control of the project team. These are internal and external conditions that influence, constrain, or direct the project positively or negatively.

D Project team assignments

Incorrect. Project team assignments are the documented records of the team members and their roles and responsibilities on the project and would not be used to perform the task described in the question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 347, 343

PMP Exam 1

Question 102

During a recent staff meeting, a corporate executive stated that the existing corporate structure would not meet the future needs of the organization.

In this context, what might a project manager say about driving change at the organizational level?

A The change control board (CCB) is a formally chartered group responsible for evaluating and approving organizational changes.

B An approved change request is required to restructure an organization.

C Operations drive change with the production of goods and services.

D Projects drive change by moving an organization from the current state to a desired future state.

Answer: D

Hint:

A project has yet to be initiated in this scenario.

Explanation:

Projects drive change in organizations. From a business perspective, a project is aimed at moving an organization from one state to another state to achieve a specific objective. Before the project begins, the organization is commonly referred to as being in the current state. The desired result of the change driven by the project is described as the future state.

In this scenario, the executive believes that the current corporate structure is inadequate and a reorganization is necessary to meet future organizational objectives. In this case, a project may be initiated to transform the organizational structure from the current state to a desired future state.

Details for Each Option:

A The change control board (CCB) is a formally chartered group responsible for evaluating and approving organizational changes.

Incorrect. A change control board (CCB) is a formally chartered group responsible for reviewing, evaluating, approving, delaying, or rejecting changes to a project, and for recording and communicating such decisions. The roles and responsibilities of the CCB are defined in the change management plan of a particular project and do not extend to the organizational level.

B An approved change request is required to restructure an organization.

Incorrect. A change request is a formal proposal to modify a document, deliverable, or baseline associated with a particular project. Therefore, change requests are only used within the context of a project and not at the organizational level.

C Operations drive change with the production of goods and services.

Incorrect. Operations management is concerned with the ongoing production of goods and/or services. Operations focus on efficient use of resources to meet customer demand, whereas projects are used to drive change.

D Projects drive change by moving an organization from the current state to a desired future state.

Correct. Projects drive change in organizations. From a business perspective, a project is aimed at moving an organization from one state to another state in order to achieve a specific objective.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 6

PMP Exam 1

Question 102

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In this context, what might a project manager say about driving change at the organizational level?

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B An approved change request is required to restructure an organization.

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D Projects drive change by moving an organization from the current state to a desired future state.

Correct. Projects drive change in organizations. From a business perspective, a project is aimed at moving an organization from one state to another state in order to achieve a specific objective.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 6

PMP Exam 1

Question 104

A_project to launch a new product to market has just entered its execution, and the purchase orders for the new product are much greater than anticipated, which presents both a threat and an opportunity for the performing organization. The opportunity is the potential for increased sales, and the threat is the inability for production to meet demand causing customer dissatisfaction. The possibility of this situation happening was identified and accounted for during project planning.

What should the project manager do next?

A Implement the agreed-upon risk response

B Submit a change request

C Perform Integrated Change Control

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Answer: A

What action should be taken to address a risk that has already been analyzed during project planning?

Explanation:

The question indicates that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning. The implementation of a risk response may or may not result in a change request. Typically, a change request is not required for a risk that has already been identified and accounted for during risk response planning. Therefore, of the choices given, the best answer to the question is for the project manager to implement the agreed-upon response plan.

Details for Each Option:

A Implement the agreed-upon risk response

Correct. Since the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning, the project manager should implement the agreed-upon risk response.

B Submit a change request

Incorrect. Submitting a change request is a premature action. If the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning, the next thing the project manager should do is to implement the agreed-upon risk response. A risk response may or may not result in the submission of a change request. There is no information in the question that the planned risk response will necessitate a change to a baseline or other components of the project management plan.

C Perform Integrated Change Control

Incorrect. The question states that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning. The project manager should follow the project management plan by implementing the agreed-upon risk response. If the risk response results in a change, then the Perform Integrated Change Control process should be performed to handle the change request.

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. The question indicates that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during the planning stage. Therefore, the risk analysis has already been completed before the risk being realized.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 449, 450

PMP Exam 1

Question 104

A_project to launch a new product to market has just entered its execution, and the purchase orders for the new product are much greater than anticipated, which presents both a threat and an opportunity for the performing organization. The opportunity is the potential for increased sales, and the threat is the inability for production to meet demand causing customer dissatisfaction. The possibility of this situation happening was identified and accounted for during project planning.

What should the project manager do next?

A Implement the agreed-upon risk response

B Submit a change request

C Perform Integrated Change Control

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Answer: A

What action should be taken to address a risk that has already been analyzed during project planning?

Explanation:

The question indicates that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning. The implementation of a risk response may or may not result in a change request. Typically, a change request is not required for a risk that has already been identified and accounted for during risk response planning. Therefore, of the choices given, the

best answer to the question is for the project manager to implement the agreed-upon response plan.

Details for Each Option:

A Implement the agreed-upon risk response

Correct. Since the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning, the project manager should implement the agreed-upon risk response.

B Submit a change request

Incorrect. Submitting a change request is a premature action. If the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning, the next thing the project manager should do is to implement the agreed-upon risk response. A risk response may or may not result in the submission of a change request. There is no information in the question that the planned risk response will necessitate a change to a baseline or other components of the project management plan.

C Perform Integrated Change Control

Incorrect. The question states that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during project planning. The project manager should follow the project management plan by implementing the agreed-upon risk response. If the risk response results in a change, then the Perform Integrated Change Control process should be performed to handle the change request.

D Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis

Incorrect. The question indicates that the risk described in the question had been identified and accounted for during the planning stage. Therefore, the risk analysis has already been completed before the risk being realized.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 449, 450

PMP Exam 1

Question 106

A_project manager is leading a project to update computer systems. Unfortunately, inadequate training of users on the new system has caused an increase in transaction times. After implementing the risk response, the project manager has collected data on average transaction times, which will be required to assess the effectiveness of the risk response.

What should the project manager do next?

A Implement the fallback plan

B Update the risk report with the new information

C Report the findings to the stakeholders in accordance with the communications management plan

D Use technical performance analysis to evaluate the transaction time data

Answer: D

Hint:

How should the project manager compare actual results against targets?

Explanation:

Technical performance analysis is used as a tool in the Monitor Risks process, and it may expose the degree of technical risk faced by the project. Technical performance analysis examines the technical accomplishments of the project and determines if they are progressing according to the plan. In this scenario, this analysis would be used to compare actual results, such as transaction

times, against performance targets. Since the project manager has collected technical performance measurements in the form of transaction data, the next step is to conduct technical performance analysis.

Details for Each Option:

A Implement the fallback plan

Incorrect. Implementing a fallback plan is a premature action until the data for transaction times can be evaluated to determine the effectiveness of the risk response.

B Update the risk report with the new information

Incorrect. The risk report may or may not be updated with information regarding the effectiveness of a particular risk response. However, the transaction time data needs to be analyzed before any conclusions can be drawn to include in a risk report.

C Report the findings to the stakeholders in accordance with the communications management plan

Incorrect. The raw data of transaction times is not likely to be communicated to stakeholders. The data needs to be analyzed first to provide some context for the data.

D Use technical performance analysis to evaluate the transaction time data

Correct. Technical performance analysis can be used to compare actual results, such as transaction times, against targets. The results of the technical performance analysis can provide context for the raw data that has been collected.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 456

PMP Exam 1

Question 107

On a project, the change control board (CCB) is conducting a meeting to evaluate a change request to increase the scope of the project. After reviewing the change request, the CCB must now decide whether to approve the request. They utilize a decision matrix to evaluate the requested change according to a set of predefined criteria.

What decision-making technique is the CCB using?

A Voting

B Autocratic decision making

C Multicriteria decision analysis

D Nominal group technique

Answer: C

Hint:

Of the available choices, which is the only technique which uses a decision matrix?

Explanation:

The PMBOK® Guide identifies three decision-making techniques including voting, autocratic decision making, and multicriteria decision analysis. Of the three decision-making techniques, only multicriteria decision analysis utilizes a decision matrix to evaluate change requests according to a set of predefined criteria.

Details for Each Option:

A Voting

Incorrect. Voting is a decision-making technique that can take the form of unanimity, majority, or plurality. It does not utilize a decision matrix.

B Autocratic decision making

Incorrect. With autocratic decision making, one individual takes responsibility for making the decision rather than using a decision matrix.

C Multicriteria decision analysis

Correct. Multicriteria decision analysis utilizes a decision matrix to provide a systematic analytical approach to evaluate requested changes according to a set of predefined criteria.

D Nominal group technique

Incorrect. The nominal group technique utilizes a voting process to rank ideas during a brainstorming session. It is not a decision-making technique.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 119

PMP Exam 1

Question 108

To ensure that lessons learned are captured and documented throughout the project life cycle, the project manager creates the lessons learned register.

What project management process is being performed?

A Direct and Manage Project Work

B Monitor and Control Project Work

C Manage Project Knowledge

D Create Lessons Learned

Answer: C

Hint:

During which project management process is the lessons learned register created?

Explanation:

Manage Project Knowledge is the process of using existing knowledge and creating new knowledge to achieve the project's objectives and contribute to organizational learning. The lessons learned register is an output of the Manage Project Knowledge process, making this process the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Direct and Manage Project Work

Incorrect. Direct and Manage Project Work is the process of leading and performing the work defined in the project management plan. The lessons learned register can be updated as a result of this process. However, the lessons learned register is not created during this process.

B Monitor and Control Project Work

Incorrect. Monitor and Control Project Work is the process of tracking, reviewing, and reporting overall project progress. The lessons learned register can be updated as a result of this process. However, for the first time, the lessons learned register is created as part of Manage Project Knowledge and not the Monitor and Control Project Work process.

C Manage Project Knowledge

Correct. Manage Project Knowledge is the process of using existing knowledge and creating new knowledge to achieve the project's objectives and contribute to organizational learning. The lessons learned register is created during the Manage Project Knowledge process.

D Create Lessons Learned

Incorrect. 'Create Lessons Learned' is not a process specified in the PMBOK® Guide.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 98, 104

PMP Exam 1

Question 109

You are managing a project that involves vendors. Midway into project execution, the sponsor hands you a formal letter from the customer informing you that your project has been terminated effective immediately. You are shocked since the project was going well and was forecasted to finish ahead of schedule and under budget.

What should you do first?

A Have your attorney call the customer's attorney

B Call a meeting with the customer

C Continue doing project work until the customer notifies you directly

D Close the contracts with the vendors

Answer: D

If a project is terminated, what is the formal step that needs to be done as part of the procurement process?

Explanation:

According to the scenario, the project manager has to begin the Close Project or Phase process. However, before doing this, contracts, if they exist on the project, should be closed as part of the Control Procurements process. Based on the scenario described, the project involves vendors. Therefore, when a project is terminated, contracts with the vendors should be closed. The procedures for formal procurement closure are defined in the contract and included in the procurement management plan. Closed procurements are an output of the Control Procurements process.

Details for Each Option:

A Have your attorney call the customer's attorney

Incorrect. Without having more information, it is unnecessary to turn this situation into a legal issue by involving attorneys.

B Call a meeting with the customer

Incorrect. Meeting with the customer may be appropriate at some point, but the question asks for your first action. You have been formally informed by the sponsor that the customer has canceled the project. Therefore, calling a meeting with the customer is not what you should do first. Making sure that the vendors do not spend their resources and do not bill the project that has been canceled is more important.

C Continue doing project work until the customer notifies you directly

Incorrect. The customer has already provided a formal letter and, therefore, is not necessarily obligated to notify the project manager specifically, so this would not be the best answer choice.

D Close the contracts with the vendors

Correct. If the project has been terminated, the project manager should first obtain financial, legal, and administrative closure. Closing contracts with vendors is part of this process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 499

PMP Exam 1

Question 110

A_project has been plagued by quality issues in deliverables that risk the achievement of project objectives. The project manager wants to meet with the team to discuss what could be improved going forward.

What type of meeting will help the project manager the most in achieving her goal?

A Lessons learned

B Kick-off

C Team building

D Risk review

Answer: A

Hint:

These meetings are often called retrospectives.

Explanation:

It can be reasonably assumed that the project manager is involved in the Control Quality process. Meetings are one of the tools and techniques that can be used as part of this process. Typically, there are two types of meetings associated with this process: approved change requests review meetings and retrospectives/lessons learned meetings. The lessons learned meetings are held to discuss topics such as the successful elements in project/phase, what could be improved, what to incorporate in the ongoing project and what in future projects, and what to add to the organizational process assets. According to the scenario, the project manager wants to meet with the team to discuss what could be improved going forward. Of the choices provided, based on its definition and objectives, the lessons learned meeting would help the project manager the most in achieving her goals, thus making lessons learned the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Lessons learned

Correct. Lessons learned meetings can be held by the project team to discuss what worked well during the project/phase and what could be improved. Those meetings are conducted during the Control Quality process implied by the scenario.

B Kick-off

Incorrect. The purpose of a kick-off meeting is to communicate the objectives of the project, gain commitment of the team, and explain the roles and responsibilities of stakeholders. The meeting is held early in the project life cycle before project work begins, making no sense to discuss quality improvements of deliverables that have not even been produced.

C Team building

Incorrect. Team building is an example of the interpersonal and team skills that can be used as one of the tools and techniques of the Develop Team process. Team building is aimed to enhance

the team's social relations and build a collaborative and cooperative working environment. According to the scenario, the project manager wants to discuss issues related to the quality of the project deliverables rather than enhance the team's social relations.

D Risk review

Incorrect. Risk review meetings are carried out as part of the Monitor Risks process to examine the effectiveness of risk response plans. Although the scenario mentions the word "risk" as it relates to achieving project objectives, the essence of the question lies with the quality issues of project deliverables rather than the effectiveness of risk responses.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 305, 457, 341, 528; see also https://www.projectmanagement.com/blog-post/28764/Lessons-Learned-Management-Techniques-for-the-PMP--Exam

PMP Exam 1

Question 111

After several iterations spent developing a product, the client states that the product shown at a demonstration does not reflect the product vision and requirements initially discussed. The client says that the product needs significant changes before it would be acceptable.

What might have prevented this situation?

A Allowing higher transparency of the work in front of the stakeholders

B Following a more rigorous organization's change control process

C Isolating the development team from stakeholders to avoid distraction

D Managing conflicts more efficiently between the client and the team

Answer: A

How might the client and development team better coordinate their activities to surface any misalignment with the project?

Explanation:

The scenario implies the project is lead using an agile approach. To accelerate the sharing of information among stakeholders, agile methods promote aggressive transparency. The intent of inviting any stakeholders (which would include the client) to project meetings and reviews is to surface as quickly as possible any misalignment, dependency, or other issue related to the changing project. On agile projects, often the client, user, and the development team exchange information in a dynamic co-creative process that leads to more stakeholder involvement and higher satisfaction. A product increment developed during the course of an iteration is demonstrated at the end of the iteration rather than after several iterations have been completed. Therefore, of the available options, allowing more transparency of the project work in front of the stakeholders by, for example, having all relevant stakeholders, including the client, periodically participate in project meetings, reviews, and demonstrations most likely would have avoided the problem described in the scenario.

Details for Each Option:

A Allowing higher transparency of the work in front of the stakeholders

Correct. To accelerate the sharing of information among stakeholders, agile methods promote aggressive transparency. For example, agile encourages inviting any stakeholders (which would include the client) to project meetings and reviews to surface as quickly as possible any misalignment, dependency, or other issue related to the changing project. Also, many agile teams post information radiators (project status and progress artifacts) in public spaces for everybody to view.

B Following a more rigorous organization's change control process

Incorrect. The question states that the project is being performed within an agile framework. Agile projects do not use a rigorous change control system. Rather, change is welcomed and harnessed for the benefit of the performing organization.

C Isolating the development team from stakeholders to avoid distraction

Incorrect. Having the development team isolated from stakeholders (and likely from the client) is apparently what caused the misalignment between what the client originally envisioned and what the team has eventually produced. Better cooperation between the client and the development team would have surfaced the misalignment early in the development process where it could have been more easily and quickly addressed.

D Managing conflicts more efficiently between the client and the team

Incorrect. The question describes a misalignment between the expectations of the client and the development team's understanding of the requirements rather than conflict. Regardless, conflict management skills are only beneficial in dealing with conflict after it occurs and would not prevent the problem from occurring in the first place.

Reference:

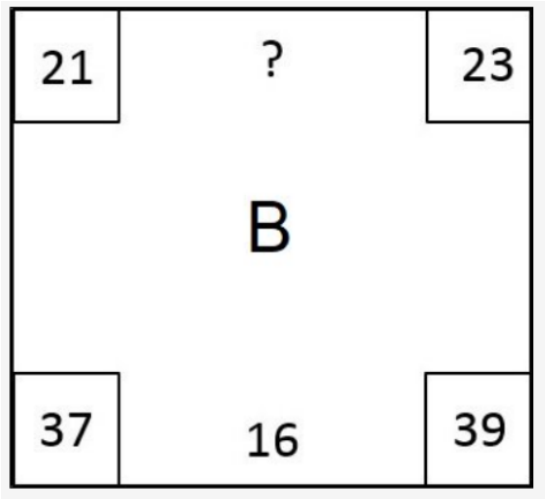
A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 506

PMP Exam 1

Question 112

Following is an illustration of a project network activity node that includes some information about activity B.

What is the duration of activity B, assuming that work starts on day one?



A 1

B 2

C 3

D 16

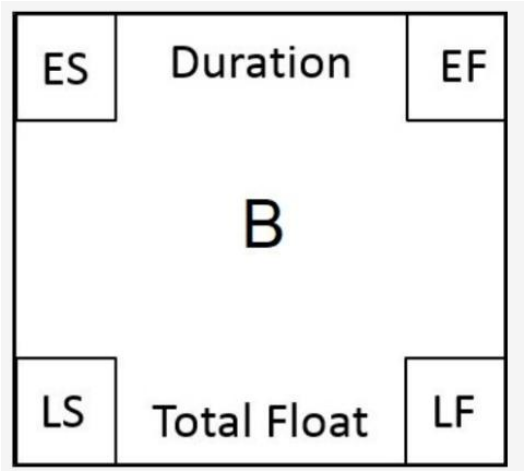
Answer: C

Use the relevant formula from the critical path method, assuming that work starts on day one (not day zero).

Explanation:

To answer this question, the first step is to understand the meaning of the values displayed on the network activity node. The accepted convention is shown below, where:

- ES = early start
- EF = early finish
- LS = late start
- LF = late finish



Unless the question explicitly states otherwise, it is recommended to assume that work starts on day 1. Since all values are provided, either one of the formulas can be used to calculate the duration of the activity:

EF = ES + D - 1

LF = LS + D - 1

With the values provided in the question, the calculation of the duration using early start and early finish is shown below:

23 = 21 + D - 1

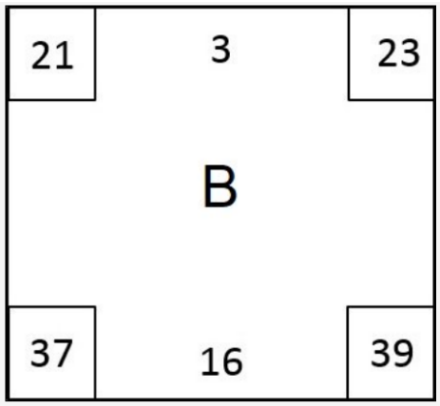
D = 23 - 21 + 1 = 3

With the values provided in the question, the calculation of the duration using late start and late finish is shown below:

39 = 37 + D - 1

D = 39 - 37 + 1 = 3

Now that we have identified the duration of activity B, we can fill in 3 for the duration value in the project schedule network activity node, as illustrated below.



We are frequently asked why would a simple subtraction not work in this case? Well, obviously, 23 - 21 = 2. However, as far as activity duration is concerned, the calculation is a bit different and may even sound counter-intuitive. However, when approaching this question with simple logic, no formulas are needed to find the correct answer. Think of this as if the work starts on March 21st at 9am and finishes on March 23rd at 5pm (we assume 8-hour working day, from 9am to 5pm). So the team is working during three working days: 21, 22, 23. Therefore, the duration is 3 days. When a formula is used, the result is 2 days, which contradicts the logic. This is why you would need to add 1. Same goes for 37 and 39. Of course, there are no such calendar dates, but the idea is the same: you work the whole day of 37th, then 38th, and finally 39th. A total of 3 days.

Details for Each Option:

A 1

Incorrect. You may have chosen this answer if you have used an incorrect formula EF = ES + D + 1.

B 2

Incorrect. You may have chosen this answer if you failed to use the 'start on day one' convention, and just subtracted 23 - 21.

C 3

Correct. Assuming work starts on day 1, duration of an activity can be calculated using the following formula: EF = ES + D - 1. According to the values provided in the scenario, 23 = 21 + D - 1. Therefore, D = 3.

D 16

Incorrect. You might have chosen this answer if you thought that the duration is the value shown in the bottom center of the figure. However, that is the conventional location for the float, making this choice an incorrect answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 210-211; see also PMI® Practice Standard for Scheduling– Second Edition; see also https://www.project-management-prepcast.com/network-diagram

PMP Exam 1

Question 113

A_project has been experiencing a significant and uncontrolled scope expansion, which has resulted in the project to run over budget and behind schedule. At the end of the project, an analysis is performed to determine the root cause of the issue.

What might the analysis reveal as the most significant issue in this scenario?

A A missing or incomplete configuration management plan

B The lack of an issue log

C An inadequate change management plan

D An incomplete risk register

Answer: C

Hint:

What document describes how the change control system will be implemented in a project?

Explanation:

The scenario suggests there was an uncontrolled expansion of the project scope. A change management plan is a component of the project management plan that establishes the change control board, documents the extent of its authority, and describes how the change control system will be implemented. The change management plan is a critical input in the Control Scope process which defines the process for managing change on the project. Without an effective change management plan, the Control Scope process would be ineffective which may lead to the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope. Therefore, of the available choices, the most likely cause of the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope is an inadequate change management plan.

Details for Each Option:

A A missing or incomplete configuration management plan

Incorrect. The configuration management plan is a component of the project management plan that describes how to identify and account for project artifacts under configuration control, and how to record and report changes to them. However, the configuration management plan does not describe the process of managing changes. The process of how the changes are managed on a project is described in the change management plan. Therefore, if the change management plan is flawed, even a perfect configuration management plan would not have prevented the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope.

B The lack of an issue log

Incorrect. An issue log is a project document where information about issues is recorded and monitored. If the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope were captured in the issue log, then perhaps the problem would have been addressed sooner. However, an issue must first occur on the project before it can be documented in the issue log and addressed. Therefore, documenting an issue in the issue log is a reactive, rather than proactive, approach and, therefore, would not have prevented the situation described in the scenario.

C An inadequate change management plan

Correct. A change management plan is a component of the project management plan that establishes the change control board, documents the extent of its authority, and describes how the change control system will be implemented. Even with a perfect change management plan, the project manager cannot control every single team member and stakeholder on a project from submitting and implementing changes. However, having an adequate change management plan would have likely helped prevent the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope. Therefore, of

the choices provided, an inadequate change management plan was the most likely reason for the issue presented by the question.

D An incomplete risk register

Incorrect. A risk register is a repository in which the outputs of risk management processes are recorded. The issue described by the question is the uncontrolled expansion of the project scope. If this risk had been identified during project planning and followed by the implementation of a risk response, perhaps the issue would have been addressed earlier in project execution. However, this action is a reactive measure to address a risk which has already occurred.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 88, 169

PMP Exam 1

Question 114

A_project is underway when a change request is submitted proposing the use of a substitute material to reduce the cost of the product. The request has been reviewed and denied due to a concern with the environmental impact of the proposed substitute.

What should the project manager do next?

A Update the change log and communicate the decision to the party who requested the change

B Communicate the decision to all project stakeholders

C Update the issue log and communicate the decision to the party who requested the change

D Since the request was denied, no further action is necessary

Answer: A

Hint:

Which project document is updated with the status of change requests?

Explanation:

The disposition of all change requests is recorded in the change log as a project document update. Since the question states that the request was denied, the decision only needs to be communicated to the requesting party. Therefore, updating the change log and communicating the decision to the person or group that made the request is what the project manager should do next.

Details for Each Option:

A Update the change log and communicate the decision to the party who requested the change

Correct. The disposition of all change requests is recorded in the change log as a project document update. The decision should also be communicated to the party that requested the change.

B Communicate the decision to all project stakeholders

Incorrect. The question states that the change request has been denied. It is not necessary to communicate the decision to 'all' project stakeholders unless the communications management plan prescribes this (which is not clear from the scenario provided).

C Update the issue log and communicate the decision to the party who requested the change

Incorrect. The question indicates that the request was made to save costs, rather than as a response to a specific issue. Therefore, it is unlikely that the information would be captured in the issue log warranting its update.

D Since the request was denied, no further action is necessary

Incorrect. Even though the request was denied in this case, the change log still needs to be updated, and the decision should be communicated to the requesting party.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 525, 120

PMP Exam 1

Question 115

The project you are managing requires the rental of equipment. If your primary supplier cannot provide the necessary equipment on time, you may need to rent the equipment at higher rates from a different supplier. To address this risk, you have added contingency reserves. Fortunately, the primary contractor provides all the equipment on time with no delays.

What should you do next?

A Update the risk register and release the contingency reserves associated with the risk

B Update the risk register and keep the contingency reserve as an added buffer for overall project risk

C Inform the project sponsor and stakeholders that all the equipment has been provided

D Update the lessons learned register to reflect that the contingency reserve was not necessary

Answer: A

Hint:

What project document is updated with the status of individual project risks?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the Monitor Risks process is underway, and project documents including the risk register may be updated during this process. The risk register should be updated to reflect the status of the unrealized risk. Also, since the identified risk did not occur, the unused contingency reserve may be removed from the project budget to free up resources for other projects or operations. Updating the risk register and releasing the funds is what you should do next. While the choice: “Update the lessons learned register to reflect that the contingency reserve was not necessary” is a plausible answer, it is not what the project manager would do 'next', it is something the project manager could do to ensure the information is available to other projects. This would be done after the risk register was updated and the contingency funds released.

Note, since the contingency reserves are part of the cost baseline, an approved change request would be required to release the finds. However, this option is not provided. Therefore, of the choices given, updating the risk register and releasing the associated contingency reserves is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Update the risk register and release the contingency reserves associated with the risk

Correct. The risk register should be updated to reflect the status of the outdated risk. Also, since the identified risk did not occur, the unused contingency reserve may be removed from the project budget to free up resources for other projects or operations.

B Update the risk register and keep the contingency reserve as an added buffer for overall project risk

Incorrect. The contingency reserve assigned to an individual project risk can only be used for that identified risk. If the risk does not occur, the associated contingency reserve should be released from the project budget.

C Inform the project sponsor and stakeholders that all the equipment has been provided

Incorrect. The communication management plan should be consulted to determine what communications should be shared and with whom. Since this information is not provided in the scenario, it is reasonable to assume that the action represented by this answer choice is unlikely to be your next step.

D Update the lessons learned register to reflect that the contingency reserve was not necessary

Incorrect. The fact that the risk did not occur does not mean the risk did not exist when the contingency reserve was assigned, so this should be captured somewhere or perhaps in more than one document. Although the risk did not occur on this project, it could occur on a future project, which supports documenting the risk and its status or impact. The first action to take with the unneeded contingency reserve set aside for the risk that didn't occur is to update the risk register to reflect the change in project risk and release the funds.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 458, 265

PMP Exam 1

Question 116

You have been newly hired to replace a project manager that is retiring. You would like to understand how to best work with the stakeholders involved in the project.

Which of the following would be best for you to review?

A Project charter

B Stakeholder register

C Stakeholder engagement plan

D Requirements management plan

Answer: C

Where would you find the best information about how to promote productive involvement of stakeholders in decision making and execution?

Explanation:

Effectively engaging stakeholders and managing their expectations is an essential part of achieving project success. The stakeholder engagement plan includes specific strategies or approaches for engaging stakeholders. This makes the stakeholder engagement plan the best artifact for you to review to understand who will be affected by the project and how to best interact with them.

Details for Each Option:

A Project charter

Incorrect. The project charter can provide information on internal and external parties affected by the project. It will not include any guidance on how to handle their engagement.

B Stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register contains information about stakeholders such as; name, contact information, their classification, and expectations. It will not include any strategies for interacting with them.

C Stakeholder engagement plan

Correct. The stakeholder engagement plan provides guidance on how the various stakeholders can be best involved in the project.

D Requirements management plan

Incorrect. The requirements management plan is a component of the project management plan that describes how requirements will be analyzed, documented, and managed. This plan is about the scope of the project, not the stakeholders.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 525

PMP Exam 1

Question 117

You are leading a hybrid project with an agile team developing the web application and a traditional engineering team to design the servers that will host the application. You want to determine what does your company say about the use of social media tools to communicate and work with the stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations.

What is your best course of action?

A Review the stakeholder register

B Check the organizational process assets

C Consult with the project sponsor

D Check the lessons learned repository

Answer: B

Hint:

Where is the best place to find corporate policies for the use of social media?

Explanation:

Communicating and working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations, address issues, and foster appropriate stakeholder involvement is essentially the definition of the Stakeholder Engagement process. According to the scenario, you want to determine what your company says about the use of social media tools to communicate and work with the stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations. This implies you are looking for inputs to the Manage Stakeholder Engagement process. Organizational process assets (OPAs) are one of the inputs to this process. Corporate policies and procedures for social media are an example of OPAs. It is typical for organizations to prohibit or provide guidelines on the use of social media when done on behalf of the business. You should first check the corporate policies and procedures before encouraging employees to use social media as a business tool.

Note, the scenario describes a hybrid project which involves an agile team developing the software and a traditional engineering team designing the hardware. This information, however, does not change the correct answer. Regardless of whether the project is predictive, agile, or hybrid, organizational process assets are the best place to find the corporate policies and procedures for the use of social media on projects performed by the organization.

Details for Each Option:

A Review the stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is a project document that captures the identification, assessment, and classification of project stakeholders. While the stakeholder register may mention communication preferences of some of the stakeholders, this document does not include information about the company's guideline about the use of social media tools to communicate and work with the stakeholders.

B Check the organizational process assets

Correct. Organizational process assets include corporate policies and procedures for social media. You should review the company's social media policy before using social media as a business tool.

C Consult with the project sponsor

Incorrect. The project sponsor may or may not be aware of policies for social media. The sponsor is neither the first point of contact nor is the best source for this information.

D Check the lessons learned repository

Incorrect. Checking the lessons learned repository is a good idea but is not the first thing you should do. Any information that can be gleaned from past projects regarding social media is irrelevant if corporate policies prohibit the use of social media or if allowed its use in the past but have been changed since then.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 526

PMP Exam 1

Question 118

At a project weekly status meeting, the project manager requests an update from a stakeholder who was supposed to implement an approved change request. The stakeholder is surprised saying they were not aware of the change.

What should the project manager do immediately?

A Rebuke the stakeholder for the failure to implement the change

B Review the communications management plan

C Update the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix

D See if the change is still needed for the project

Answer: B

Which component of the project management plan specifies what and how the information on a project should be shared?

Explanation:

The scenario implies there is a problem with project communications. While project communications should be monitored continuously throughout the project, the issue described in the question should specifically trigger the Monitor Communications process in which the project manager and team determine why there was a communications breakdown. In doing so, they may begin to improve project communication effectiveness by submitting a change request to revise the communication management plan and activities. Issues or conflicts, such as those described in the question, frequently act as a trigger for a change request to update the communication management plan and/or communication activities.

Details for Each Option:

A Rebuke the stakeholder for the failure to implement the change

Incorrect. Rebuking the stakeholder is an emotional response and would not resolve the issue presented by the question.

B Review the communications management plan

Correct. The project manager has to perform the Monitor Communications process to attempt to discover where the breakdown in project communications is occurring. Any issue or risk found

by performing this process may trigger a possible revision to the communications management plan.

C Update the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix

Incorrect. The stakeholder engagement assessment matrix shows the comparison between the current engagement levels of stakeholders and the desired engagement levels required for successful project delivery. Not only it is unclear what exactly should be updated in the matrix, but a mere update to the matrix would unlikely resolve the issue described in the scenario.

D See if the change is still needed for the project

Incorrect. According to the scenario, the change request has been approved, implying it has passed through the appropriate change control process established for the project. Instead of questioning if the change is still needed, the project manager has to understand why the decision about the change was not properly communicated.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 388-389, 377

PMP Exam 1

Question 119

A_project manager is explaining to the stakeholders how the new project will mainly focus on the intangible benefits. To provide a better explanation, the project manager wants to give an example of an intangible benefit.

Which of the following is best for the project manager to use as an example?

A Monetary assets

B Stockholder equity

C Market share

D Brand recognition

Answer: D

Hint:

Which of these benefits cannot be easily quantified?

Explanation:

The question divides potential benefits of a project into two groups, tangible and intangible. Tangible benefits are those that can be relatively easily expressed in monetary value, for example, anything that results in the production of a material, software, or service adds value to the organization's assets, increases stockholder equity, and so on. Intangible benefits are those that cannot be directly and easily expressed in monetary value, however, in the long-term can bring value to the organization. Examples of intangible benefits could be brand recognition, public benefit, or trademarks.

Details for Each Option:

A Monetary assets

Incorrect. Monetary assets are an example of a tangible benefit.

B Stockholder equity

Incorrect. Stockholder equity is an example of a tangible benefit.

C Market share

Incorrect. Market share is an example of a tangible benefit.

D Brand recognition

Correct. Brand recognition is an example of an intangible benefit that can be realized by investing in a project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 7

PMP Exam 1

Question 120

A_project manager is in the process of monitoring the overall progress of project work. The project has been plagued by numerous issues, which have led to cost and schedule overruns. These issues have caused frustration for the project team and sponsor. The project manager will be relieved when the project is over, but there are still several deliverables to be produced.

What is the best course of action for the project manager?

A Close the project as quickly as possible and move on to the next project

B Capture lessons learned in the lessons learned repository

C Downplay the issue to minimize the impact on performance appraisals

D Document lessons learned in the lessons learned register

Answer: D

Where should lessons learned during a project be captured to improve performance on the current project and future similar projects?

Explanation:

The question indicates that a project which has been plagued by problems and will likely fail to meet project objectives is nearing completion. Sometimes the best thing that can be achieved from a problem-plagued project is the knowledge gained of how to avoid the same problems from occurring on future projects. A poor performing project will very likely have lessons learned which should be captured in the lessons learned register to improve performance on the current project. During project closing, the lessons learned register is transferred to the lessons learned repository which is a store of historical information and available for future projects. Of the available options, the only appropriate action is to document the lessons learned from the project in the lessons learned register.

Details for Each Option:

A Close the project as quickly as possible and move on to the next project

Incorrect. Whenever a project does not go well, there is a temptation to move on as quickly as possible. However, if the lessons learned from the failures are not captured and analyzed, there is a risk the same problems that plagued the project will be experienced in future projects. Sometimes the best thing that can be gained from a project is the knowledge of how to avoid problems in the future.

B Capture lessons learned in the lessons learned repository

Incorrect. The lessons learned register, not the lessons learned repository, should be updated during the project to improve performance on the current project. The information captured in the lessons learned register is then transferred to the lessons learned repository at the end of the project where the information will be available to future projects.

C Downplay the issue to minimize the impact on performance appraisals

Incorrect. It is important to avoid masking poor performance. Only an honest assessment of project performance will allow the opportunity to improve the performance of future projects. Skewing reporting to appear more favorable to influence performance appraisals may violate the

value of honesty outlined in the PMI Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct, which reads, “Honesty is our duty to understand the truth and act in a truthful manner both in our communications and in our conduct.”

D Document lessons learned in the lessons learned register

Correct. A poor performing project will very likely have important lessons learned which should be captured in the lessons learned register to improve performance on the current project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 113, 104; see also PMI Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct, Honesty

PMP Exam 1

Question 121

The project you are leading will use wood pallets supplied by a vendor. During the testing of the first shipment from the vendor, an engineer discovers 10 of the 100 pallets of wood are subpar and do not meet project specifications.

What should you do immediately?

A Write an email to the stakeholders explaining the situation

B Schedule a meeting with the team to see if the pallets still can be used

C Record and document the problem in the project issue log

D Call the vendor and express your dissatisfaction with the delivery

Answer: C

Hint:

What should be your first course of action when issues or problems arise?

Explanation:

It is your duty as a project manager to record and document issues or problems that arise during the course of the project. The project document that captures the issues is called the issue log. Recording the issue immediately ensures that you have accounted for the problem. Be aware that the issue log is initially created in the Direct and Manage Project Work process, but is a project document that is updated throughout the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Write an email to the stakeholders explaining the situation

Incorrect. Stakeholders should be informed of the subpar wood delivery, but you should first record and document the problem. Also, the issue seems manageable and could be discussed at the next stakeholder meeting or noted in status reports rather than being emailed immediately to the stakeholders.

B Schedule a meeting with the team to see if the pallets still can be used

Incorrect. You could hold this meeting, but a change request would likely be required to change the specifications to allow the wood of a lower quality to be used.

C Record and document the problem in the project issue log

Correct. Anytime an issue arises, you should first record and document the problem as supporting evidence. Logging the issue first ensures the problem is not overlooked and that steps need to be taken to resolve the issue.

D Call the vendor and express your dissatisfaction with the delivery

Incorrect. Calling the vendor could be one way to approach the problem, but the question asks what you should do 'immediately' after learning of the issue. The correct action is to record and document the issue first before making the call to the vendor.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 96

PMP Exam 1

Question 122

During the production of a company's first ever jet engine, a defect in one of the turbine blades is discovered. The defect is repaired according to an approved process, and then the turbine blade is installed in the engine. During testing, the jet engine is destroyed due to a structural failure of the previously repaired turbine blade.

What action may have prevented the engine failure?

A Reviewing the lessons learned repository

B Inspecting the turbine blade after the defect repair

C Submitting a change request

D Conducting product testing by running the engine

Answer: B

What should have happened after the defect was repaired and before it was installed back into the engine?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the Control Quality process is underway and inspections are one of the tools and techniques associated with this process. An inspection is the examination of a work product to determine if it conforms to documented standards. Inspections can also be used to verify defect repairs. The question indicates that the defect was repaired and then installed in the engine. There is no mention of the turbine blade being inspected after the repair was completed. Therefore, an inspection of the repaired turbine blade is what was missed that may have prevented the engine failure.

Details for Each Option:

A Reviewing the lessons learned repository

Incorrect. The lessons learned repository contains lessons learned from past projects. The question indicates that this project will produce the company's first jet engine, and therefore it is not likely that lessons learned from past projects are applicable in this situation.

B Inspecting the turbine blade after the defect repair

Correct. An inspection is the examination of a work product to determine if it conforms to documented standards. Inspections can also be used to verify defect repairs. The question does not indicate that the repaired turbine blade was inspected after the completion of the repair.

C Submitting a change request

Incorrect. The question does not state whether or not a change request was submitted or if it was required. Even if the change request was required and missed, the question states that the defect was repaired with an approved process, making the supposedly missing change request an unlikely contributor to the engine failure.

D Conducting product testing by running the engine

Incorrect. The question states that the jet engine was destroyed during testing. Therefore, product testing was not missed, and this choice can be eliminated as a correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 303

PMP Exam 1

Question 123

The project manager and a stakeholder get into a heated debate about the stakeholder's idea requiring a scope change to the project. The project manager says the change will not be implemented and that the stakeholder must drop the idea. The project manager emphasizes that she is the project manager and the decision is final.

Should the project manager have responded differently to resolve the conflict?

A No; The project manager has the formal authority to make the final decision.

B Yes; The project manager should have discussed the idea with other stakeholders.

C No; The project manager was demonstrating the culture in which the company works.

D Yes; The project manager should have compromised with the stakeholder.

Answer: B

Hint:

What conflict resolution technique usually results in a win-win situation for the involved parties?

Explanation:

The project manager is using the force/direct conflict resolution technique, which involves pushing one's viewpoint at the expense of others and offering only a win-lose solution. While force/direct is a legitimate conflict resolution technique, it should be used only when other conflict resolution techniques fail or when the situation warrants this approach. The scenario described in the question does not suggest that other conflict resolution techniques have been used or that the situation is so acute that the project manager was left with no option except to use the force/direct technique. Since it appears the project manager did have other options, she should have pursued a win-win outcome, which the collaborative/problem-solving technique often creates. Discussing the stakeholder's idea with other stakeholders is the only conflict resolution technique offering the possibility of a win-win situation, and therefore is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A No; The project manager has the formal authority to make the final decision.

Incorrect. Unless the situation is an emergency (which is not the case in the scenario described), the project manager should not push her viewpoint onto others from a stance of power, known as a force/direct conflict resolution technique. This approach usually ends with a win-lose situation and therefore is not the best course of action in this situation. The project manager should have responded differently.

B Yes; The project manager should have discussed the idea with other stakeholders.

Correct. The project manager should have used a collaborative/problem-solving approach to address the conflict, such as discussing the idea with other project stakeholders and/or the team. Such a discussion would have allowed both sides to incorporate multiple viewpoints and insights from differing perspectives and hopefully lead to a win-win outcome with consensus and commitment.

C No; The project manager was demonstrating the culture in which the company works.

Incorrect. The project manager may well have been demonstrating the culture of the company (raising another issue, which is outside the scope of this question) but using a force/direct technique is still not the best way to resolve a conflict.

D Yes; The project manager should have compromised with the stakeholder.

Incorrect. Compromising often leads to a lose-lose outcome because this technique searches for a resolution to the conflict in order to appease both parties, but the decision may not be the best for the project. While compromising could have been a better approach than forcing, a

collaborative/problem-solving approach is preferred. Therefore, this answer is not the best choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 348-349

PMP Exam 1

Question 124

A_project manager has been experiencing unnecessary delays during project execution in obtaining signatures from senior management due to an inadequate notification process when a signature is required. Addressing the issue only requires a minor update to the communications management plan.

What should the project manager do next?

A Update the cost baseline

B Update the communications management plan

C Submit a change request

D Implement the proposed solution

Answer: C

The communications management plan is a component of the project management plan. What is required to update the project management plan?

Explanation:

Even though the proposed solution is not anticipated to affect any project constraints, a change request is still required. The proposed solution requires an update to the communications management plan. The communications management plan as a component of the project management plan which can be modified only if a requested change is approved. Regardless of how small the requested change is, it should go through the organization's change control process. Therefore, of the choices provided, the next thing for the project manager to do is to submit a change request.

Details for Each Option:

A Update the cost baseline

Incorrect. The question states that the proposed solution will require only a minor update to the communications management plan implying none of the other project constraints will be affected. Therefore, the cost baseline does not need to be updated.

B Update the communications management plan

Incorrect. The communications management plan will need to be updated before the proposed solution can be implemented, but a change request needs to be submitted and approved before a configuration element can be updated.

C Submit a change request

Correct. The proposed solution will require a change to the communications management plan, which is a component of the project management plan. A change to any configuration element requires an approved change request.

D Implement the proposed solution

Incorrect. Being a component of the project management plan, which is under the configuration control, the communications management plan needs to be updated by submitting a change request before the proposed solution can be implemented.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 393, 115, 83

PMP Exam 1

Question 125

A_project is about halfway complete. As the project manager, you receive formal notification from the customer that they no longer have funds available to continue the project. After further research, you learn that your customer is liquidating the company and selling off all assets to a competitor for pennies on the dollar.

What should you do next?

A Start the Close Project or Phase process

B Stop all work on the project and redeploy the resources to other projects

C Release the project team

D Put the project on hold until the acquiring company decides on how to proceed with the project

Answer: A

Hint:

What needs to be done when a project is terminated?

Explanation:

Even though the project has been terminated by the customer, the Close Project or Phase process must be performed. The Close Project or Phase process establishes procedures to investigate and document the reasons for actions taken if a project is terminated before completion. Additionally, the project information will need to be archived, and established procedures followed to transfer finished and unfinished deliverables. The project team will then be released as part of the Close Project or Phase process.

Details for Each Option:

A Start the Close Project or Phase process

Correct. When the project is terminated, either by the performing organization or by the customer, the next thing to be done is to perform the Close Project or Phase process.

B Stop all work on the project and redeploy the resources to other projects

Incorrect. Not all project work is stopped when a project is terminated. The activities associated with the Close Project or Phase process must be completed first, and the resources needed to perform those activities should be available.

C Release the project team

Incorrect. The release of the project team is part of the Close Project or Phase process. However, all of the activities associated with the Close Project or Phase process should to be completed, and you may need some of the project team members to complete this process before releasing them.

D Put the project on hold until the acquiring company decides on how to proceed with the project

Incorrect. The question indicates that the project is being terminated by the customer. If the acquiring company wishes to continue with the project, it will require a new contract and should be handled as a new project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 123, 128

PMP Exam 1

Question 126

First, a project manager assisted with the development of the project charter which has been approved. Second, he completed the development of the stakeholder register.

What should the project manager do next?

A Submit a change request to update any project documents with information gathered during the Identify Stakeholders process

B Update the communications management plan to include the communication requirements of stakeholders identified in the newly developed stakeholder register

C Update the stakeholder engagement plan with any pertinent information uncovered during the Identify Stakeholders process

D Establish the scope of the project, refine the objectives, and define the course of action required to attain the objectives that the project was undertaken to achieve

Answer: D

Hint:

The Develop Project Charter and Identify Stakeholders processes are complete in this scenario.

Explanation:

The question states that the development of the stakeholder register has just been completed. The stakeholder register is created during the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process. Change requests and project management plan updates can be outputs of the Identify Stakeholders process, but not during the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process. The project management plan does not exist when the Initiating Process Group is first completed. Change requests are not required until the project management plan has been completed and approved. Once the project charter and the stakeholder register have been completed at the start of the project, the Initiating Process Group is complete. The next logical step is to begin project planning with the Planning Process Group. The Planning Process Group is represented by the answer choice that defines this group as specified in the reference: "establish the scope of the project, refine the objectives, and define the course of action required to attain the objectives that the project was undertaken to achieve".

Details for Each Option:

A Submit a change request to update any project documents with information gathered during the Identify Stakeholders process

Incorrect. A change request is not required at this point in the project. The question states that the project charter and the stakeholder register have just been completed, which means the Initiating Process Group has just been completed and the Planning Process Group has yet to begin. Change requests are not required until the project management plan has been completed and approved.

B Update the communications management plan to include the communication requirements of stakeholders identified in the newly developed stakeholder register

Incorrect. The question indicates that the stakeholder register, which is developed during the Identify Stakeholders process, has just been completed. The communications management plan, a subsidiary of the project management plan, has yet to be created with the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholder process. Thus, the communications management plan cannot be updated.

C Update the stakeholder engagement plan with any pertinent information uncovered during the Identify Stakeholders process

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is created during the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process. The stakeholder engagement plan, a component of the project management plan, does not yet exist after the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process. Therefore, there is nothing to update.

D Establish the scope of the project, refine the objectives, and define the course of action required to attain the objectives that the project was undertaken to achieve

Correct. The stakeholder register is created during the first iteration of the Identify Stakeholders process. Once the project charter and the stakeholder register have been completed at the start of the project, the Initiating Process Group is complete. The next logical step is to begin project planning with the Planning Process Group. This answer choice is the definition of the Planning Process Group, making this the best answer to the question asked.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 23, 514-515

PMP Exam 1

Question 127

A_technician has just tested a piece of equipment and found a defect. The technician has informed the project manager and submitted a change request to repair the defect, indicating that the repair will require significant rework.

What should the project manager do first?

A Approve the change request

B Consult the change management plan

C Instruct the team to repair the defect

D Reject the change request due to significant rework

Answer: B

How should the project manager determine who has the authority to make a decision regarding a change request?

Explanation:

During the Perform Integrated Change Control process, change requests may be submitted for review and have a decision made based on the merits of the request. A defect repair may or may not require a change request, and the project manager may or may not have the authority to approve the change request. The change management plan provides direction for managing the change control process and documents the roles and responsibilities. The project manager should check the change management plan first to know which individual or group is responsible for reviewing and making decisions on change requests.

Details for Each Option:

A Approve the change request

Incorrect. The question does not state whether the project manager has the authority to approve change requests. The project manager must understand the approval requirements and procedures in the change management plan before a change request can be approved.

B Consult the change management plan

Correct. The change management plan provides direction for managing the change control process and documents roles and responsibilities. The project manager should check the change management plan first to know what individual or group is responsible for reviewing and making decisions on change requests.

C Instruct the team to repair the defect

Incorrect. A decision should first be made on the change request before the change could be implemented.

D Reject the change request due to significant rework

Incorrect. While the defect repair may eventually be rejected due to significant rework involved or any other considerations, this decision cannot be made at will by the project manager without reviewing the impact of repairing this defect on all project constraints. Additionally, the project manager should check the change management plan to determine who is responsible for reviewing and making decisions on change requests.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 116

PMP Exam 1

Question 128

During project initiation, the project stakeholders attend a meeting where they discuss how project success should be determined. The majority of the stakeholders are in favor of measuring project success by meeting the metrics of scope, cost, schedule, and quality only.

As the project manager, should you agree with this approach?

A Yes, meeting the metrics of scope, cost, schedule, and quality are the most important criteria for measuring project success.

B No, the measures of project success should be determined after considering all the project objectives.

C Yes, if most of the stakeholders are in favor of a set of success metrics, the project manager should accept the opinion of the majority.

D No, the stated metrics are less important than the level of customer satisfaction, which should be the primary measure of project success.

Answer: B

Hint:

Is project success measured by meeting only the metrics of scope, cost, schedule, and quality?

Explanation:

Traditionally, the project management metrics of project constraints such as scope, schedule, cost, and quality have been the most important factors in defining the success of a project. More recently, practitioners and scholars have determined that the measures of project success should be determined and defined by considering all the project objectives. In addition to the traditional metrics used to determine project success, today's measures of project success should be based on careful consideration of the project benefits management plan, meeting the financial measures such as NPV, ROI, IRR, meeting business case nonfinancial objectives, achieving stakeholder satisfaction, meeting organizational strategy goals and objectives, customer adoption of solutions provided, etc.

Details for Each Option:

A Yes, meeting the metrics of scope, cost, schedule, and quality are the most important criteria for measuring project success.

Incorrect. Meeting the metrics of scope, cost, schedule, and quality are only some of the measures or criteria used to determine project success. Others include, but are not limited to customer satisfaction, achievement of business goals, meeting organizational strategy, meeting financial and non-financial measures, and customer adoption of the solution.

B No, the measures of project success should be determined after considering all the project objectives.

Correct. Along with the traditional metrics listed above, project success should also be measured with consideration toward achieving all the agreed upon project objectives, for example, completing the project benefits management plan, customer satisfaction, achievement of business

goals, meeting organizational strategy, meeting financial and non-financial measures, and customer adoption of the solution.

C Yes, if most of the stakeholders are in favor of a set of success metrics, the project manager should accept the opinion of the majority.

Incorrect. The measures of project success are not determined by a majority vote. The key stakeholders and the project manager should discuss and agree upon the measures of success that meet all the project objectives, many of which extend beyond the customers or end users of project deliverables.

D No, the stated metrics are less important than the level of customer satisfaction, which should be the primary measure of project success.

Incorrect. Absolute statements typically represent incorrect answers. Saying that project success should be primarily measured by the level of customer satisfaction fails to consider all the objectives of the project. While customer satisfaction is an important factor in measuring project success, there are many other factors that should be considered when determining and documenting project success measures.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 34

Question 129

Project facilities, resources, and stakeholders are geographically distributed. The project manager understands that under these circumstances, communicating and working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations, address issues, and foster their involvement will be challenging.

What does this challenge represent?

A Organizational process assets

B Enterprise environmental factors

C Resource breakdown structure

D Logistical factors

Answer: B

Which input to the Manage Stakeholder Engagement process is affected by the geographic distribution of facilities and resources?

Explanation:

Communicating and working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations, address issues, and foster their involvement is the definition of the Manage Stakeholder Engagement process. One of the inputs to this process is enterprise environmental factors (EEFs). EEFs are conditions that are not under the immediate control of the team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project. The geographic distribution of the facilities, resources, and stakeholders is an example of enterprise environmental factors. These factors represent a challenge to the project manager while managing stakeholder engagement and, therefore, should be taken into consideration.

Details for Each Option:

A Organizational process assets

Incorrect. Organization process assets are plans, processes, policies, and knowledge bases that are specific to and used by the performing organization. This is unrelated to the geographic distribution of the project facilities, resources, and stakeholders.

B Enterprise environmental factors

Correct. The geographic distribution of facilities and resources is an example of enterprise environmental factors.

C Resource breakdown structure

Incorrect. A resource breakdown structure is a hierarchical representation of resources by category and type. The geographic distribution of the facilities, resources, and stakeholders is not reflected in the resource breakdown structure.

D Logistical factors

Incorrect. 'Logistical factors' is a fake term made up for this question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 526

PMP Exam 1

Question 130

You are leading a three-phase project to build a prototype. The first phase entails design. In the second phase, the manufacturing team would produce the parts from the design specifications. In the third phase, the production team would assemble the parts to construct the prototype. You are at the end of the first phase.

What should you do?

A Transfer the design to the production team to be used during assembly

B Transfer the design to the testing team for final verification

C Transfer the design to the project management office (PMO)

D Transfer ownership of the design to the manufacturing team

Answer: D

Hint:

Which of the choices describes an output from the Close Project or Phase process?

Explanation:

The question states you are at the end of the first phase, implying you are in the Close Project or Phase process. An output of the Close Project or Phase is the transition of the final product, service, or result to a different group or organization that will operate, maintain, or support it throughout its life cycle. Officially transferring the ownership of deliverables to the assigned stakeholders facilitates project (or phase) closure. In this case, you would transfer ownership of the design to the manufacturing team since they are responsible for the second phase of the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Transfer the design to the production team to be used during assembly

Incorrect. The scenario states you are at the end of the first phase. To assemble the prototype, the production team is supposed to get the parts manufactured in the second phase, not the design developed in the first phase. There is not enough information in the question to determine if the production team needs the design. Therefore, you have to transfer the design to the manufacturing, not the production team, who will produce the parts and transfer them to production.

B Transfer the design to the testing team for final verification

Incorrect. The question asks what you should do at the end of the first phase, implying project/phase closure. Verification of the design would have been done while the work of phase one was carried out which, based on the scenario, has already been completed.

C Transfer the design to the project management office (PMO)

Incorrect. The PMO is an organizational structure that standardizes the project-related governance processes and facilitates the sharing of resources, methodologies, tools, and techniques. The responsibilities of the PMO can range from providing project management support functions to the direct management of one or more projects. There is no indication in the scenario that the PMO is directly managing the project or any of its phases. Therefore, transferring the design to the PMO is not the best answer.

D Transfer ownership of the design to the manufacturing team

Correct. An output of the Close Project or Phase process is the final product, service, or result transition. In the scenario, you would transfer ownership for the result of the first phase (i.e., the design specifications) to a different group (i.e., the manufacturing team) that will initiate the next phase. Note, the output from a single phase of a multi-phase project is known as the intermediate product, service, or result.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 123, 127

PMP Exam 1

Question 131

You are a project manager at an organization with a project management office (PMO), which maintains complete control of all projects. The PMO has just created a project charter for a project to evaluate and streamline their product offerings and has named you as the project manager.

You are employed by which type of PMO organization?

A Supportive

B Controlling

C Directive

D Initiative

Answer: C

Hint:

Which type of project management office (PMO) has a high level of control over projects?

Explanation:

The question describes a project management office (PMO) that maintains complete control over projects. Directive PMOs take control of the projects by directly managing the projects. Additionally, a directive PMO assigns project managers, and they report directly to the PMO, as is described by the question. Based on the description provided by the question, the directive PMO is the best answer choice.

Details for Each Option:

A Supportive

Incorrect. Supportive PMOs provide a consultative role for projects, and the degree of control provided is low. A PMO with complete control of projects as described by the question is not considered a supportive PMO.

B Controlling

Incorrect. Controlling PMOs provide support and require compliance through various means. The degree of control is moderate with a controlling PMO. However, the question describes a PMO which maintains complete control over all projects. Therefore, this answer choice can be eliminated as a correct response.

C Directive

Correct. Directive PMOs take control of the projects by directly managing the projects, and project managers are assigned by and report to the PMO. The degree of control provided by a directive PMO is high. The question states that the PMO maintains complete control over projects which best describes a directive PMO.

D Initiative

Incorrect. 'Initiative' is a fake PMO type made up for this question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 48

PMP Exam 1

Question 132

You are developing a work breakdown structure (WBS). Based on the required project deliverables, you have currently decomposed the work in the WBS as deep as eight levels down. A team member points out that the WBS must not exceed six levels.

What is your best course of action?

A Continue decomposing the work, but no more than eight levels as specified in the PMBOK® Guide

B Continue decomposing the work as needed with no regard to the number of WBS decomposition levels

C Stop decomposing the work and reference the project management plan for the depth of the WBS

D Modify the WBS to have a maximum of six decomposition levels as requested by the team member

Answer: B

Hint:

What is the WBS used for?

Explanation:

One purpose of the Create WBS process is to organize the project work into smaller, manageable components so that work packages can be used to estimate time and cost. While excessive decomposition can lead to nonproductive management effort, inefficient use of resources, etc., the PMBOK® Guide does not limit the number of WBS decomposition levels. The level of decomposition is determined by the scope of the deliverable. It is the job of the project manager to be mindful of complexity when decomposing the work.

Details for Each Option:

A Continue decomposing the work, but no more than eight levels as specified in the PMBOK® Guide

Incorrect. The PMBOK® Guide provides no limit to the number of WBS decomposition levels.

B Continue decomposing the work as needed with no regard to the number of WBS decomposition levels

Correct. The depth needed to decompose the project work is not pre-defined. The level of decomposition is often guided by the degree of control needed to effectively manage the project. The PMBOK® Guide provides no limit to the number of WBS decomposition levels.

C Stop decomposing the work and reference the project management plan for the depth of the WBS

Incorrect. Although the project management plan may describe the project's complexity, it would not state the maximum number of levels needed for the WBS.

D Modify the WBS to have a maximum of six decomposition levels as requested by the team member

Incorrect. The PMBOK Guide provides no limit to the number of WBS decomposition levels.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 158

PMP Exam 1

Question 133

You are working with your team to create the work breakdown structure (WBS). A team member provides you with the breakdown of work to be performed, which is the last piece needed to finalize the scope baseline. You discover that a critical element is missing.

How should you proceed?

A Submit a change request to add the missing element

B Have the team start production while you assess the impact and determine if a formal change request is needed

C Instruct the team member to add the critical element and then resubmit

D Determine the impact of the additional element; submit a change request with the impact results

Answer: C

Hint:

How are changes handled when the project management plan has not been finalized?

Explanation:

Project baselines, including scope, schedule, and cost, are necessary to compare and measure against work performance and project execution. This requires an established baseline in each area. In this question, the scenario implies you are carrying out the Create WBS process, and the scope baseline has not yet been finalized. During project planning, as long as the project management plan has not yet been approved, the components of the plan can be updated as many times as necessary without a formal change control process. Once the scope baseline has been defined, any issues discovered would have to go through the Perform Integrated Change Control process. Changes that may have an impact on the cost, scope or schedule should be evaluated, and those results should accompany the change request.

Details for Each Option:

A Submit a change request to add the missing element

Incorrect. Since the scope baseline has not been finalized, a change request is not required. Before the baselines are defined, documents within the project management plan, such as the work breakdown structure (WBS) can be updated as many times as necessary. Once the baseline is defined, changes must go through the Perform Integrated Change Control process.

B Have the team start production while you assess the impact and determine if a formal change request is needed

Incorrect. The missing element is critical so starting production before adding the element would likely result in increased project costs due to the required rework or corrections. Since the scope baseline has not been finalized, a change request is not required.

C Instruct the team member to add the critical element and then resubmit

Correct. Since the scope baseline has not been finalized, documents within the project management plan such as the work breakdown structure can be updated as many times as necessary. Therefore, the additions can be made without submitting a change request. Once the baseline has been finalized, any changes would have to go through the Perform Integrated Change Control process.

D Determine the impact of the additional element; submit a change request with the impact results

Incorrect. Since the scope baseline has not been finalized, a change request is not required. Once the baseline is defined, changes must go through the Perform Integrated Change Control process. Needed changes may require a determination of the impact on baselines to be included with the change request.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 83, 117, 161

PMP Exam 1

Question 134

You are planning a kick-off meeting for your new project. The meeting will communicate the start of the project, key milestones, and other relevant information.

Which of the following best describes the objective of this meeting?

A Inform and engage stakeholders and gain commitment

B Manage uncertainty and opportunity throughout the project life cycle

C Ensure that the required project resources will be available

D Manage timely completion of the project

Answer: A

The Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline will be helpful in correctly answering this question.

Explanation:

The Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline contains a list of tasks for each domain, with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Task #12 of the planning domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline states, "Conduct kick-off meeting, communicating the start of the project, key milestones, and other relevant information in order to inform and engage stakeholders and gain commitment." Therefore, inform and engage stakeholders and gain commitment is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Inform and engage stakeholders and gain commitment

Correct. Task #12 of the planning domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline states, "Conduct kick-off meeting, communicating the start of the project, key milestones, and other relevant information in order to inform and engage stakeholders and gain commitment." Therefore, this is the correct answer.

B Manage uncertainty and opportunity throughout the project life cycle

Incorrect. This answer choice is associated with a different task from the planning domain of the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline.

C Ensure that the required project resources will be available

Incorrect. This response describes the task of developing the procurement management plan rather than conducting the kick-off meeting.

D Manage timely completion of the project

Incorrect. This answer represents the task of developing the project schedule, not conducting the kick-off meeting.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 86; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain 2, Task 12

PMP Exam 1

Question 135

To share their concerns about the slow progress of the project, a stakeholder is looking for the escalation process to the senior management team.

Where would the stakeholder find this information?

A Escalation management plan

B Communications management plan

C Project management plan

D Stakeholder engagement plan

Answer: B

Hint:

Where would you find escalation processes?

Explanation:

The Manage Communications process involves providing information as well as allowing stakeholders to request additional information and clarification as needed. In this case, the stakeholder is not pleased with the progress of the project and would like to escalate their concerns. The escalation process is detailed in the communications management plan. While the communications management plan is a subsidiary of the project management plan, the escalation process is specific to the communications management plan making this the 'best' answer.

Details for Each Option:

A Escalation management plan

Incorrect. The 'escalation management plan' is a made up term for this question. The escalation process is outlined in the communications management plan.

B Communications management plan

Correct. The communications management plan contains the escalation processes.

C Project management plan

Incorrect. The communications management plan is a subsidiary of the project management plan. Whenever two answer choices seem to be correct, the choice that most accurately addresses the question asked is typically the correct answer.

D Stakeholder engagement plan

Incorrect. The stakeholder engagement plan is a subsidiary of the project management plan that identifies the strategies and actions required to effectively engage stakeholders in project decisions and execution. It does not contain any information regarding escalations.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 377, 381

PMP Exam 1

Question 136

A_project manager wants to track team member performance, provide feedback, resolve issues, and manage changes to optimize project performance.

In what process will the project manager carry out these activities?

A Develop Team

B Manage Team

C Control Team

D Acquire Resources

Answer: B

Develop Team is the process of improving competencies, team interaction, and the overall team environment to eventually enhance team performance.

Explanation:

This question is an example of short, straightforward knowledge-based questions that prospective PMP aspirants may encounter on their exam. Tracking team member performance, providing feedback, resolving issues, and managing team changes to optimize project

performance are activities that typically carried out as part of the Manage Team process, making Manage Team the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Develop Team

Incorrect. Develop Team is the process of improving competencies, team member interaction, and the overall team environment to enhance project performance. Activities described in the scenario are not part of the Develop Team process.

B Manage Team

Correct. Manage Team is the process of tracking team member performance, providing feedback, resolving issues, and managing team changes to optimize project performance.

C Control Team

Incorrect. 'Control Team' is a made-up term.

D Acquire Resources

Incorrect. Acquire Resources is the process of obtaining team members, facilities, equipment, materials, and other resources necessary to complete the project work. The question describes activities undertaken in the Manage Team process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 345, 336

PMP Exam 1

Question 137

Several stakeholders expressed concern over the lack of notification when project updates were uploaded to the company's intranet. The situation was addressed with an update to the communications management plan that provided for a follow-up email to be sent to the appropriate stakeholders whenever a new report was available for download.

Which project document should be updated with the description of the situation along with its progress and resolution?

A Stakeholder management plan

B Stakeholder register

C Communications management plan

D Issue log

Answer: D

Hint:

What project document tracks problems as they arise along with their progress and resolution?

Explanation:

The question implies that the Monitor Communications process is being performed, and all the answer choices may be updated because of this process. However, only the issue log is updated with information on issues raised, their progress, and resolution. Among the available options, the issue log provides the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Stakeholder management plan

Incorrect. The stakeholder management plan is updated to reflect the actual situation of stakeholders, their communications needs, and their importance. However, the stakeholder management plan does not track the progress of issues encountered during a project.

B Stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register may be updated with revised stakeholder communication requirements, but it does not capture a description of the situation that prompted the need for the update.

C Communications management plan

Incorrect. The question states that the communications management plan was updated in response to the issue raised by the stakeholders, but the communications management plan does not contain a description of the situation that prompted the change nor the progress towards its resolution.

D Issue log

Correct. The issue log is a project document where information about issues is recorded and monitored. The issue log is updated with new information on issues raised, their progress, and resolution.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 393

Question 138

A_project manager asks a consultant to help implement an approved change request, which involves rolling out a service that is new to the company.

What tool is the project manager using?

A Specialized knowledge

B Technical knowledge

C Database management

D Expert judgment

Answer: D

Hint:

What tools are used to direct and manage project work?

Explanation:

Expert judgment is a tool used in the Direct and Manage Project Work process. The term refers to using the knowledge and experience of someone who has expertise in completing the types of activities required for the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Specialized knowledge

Incorrect. The combination of words 'specialized knowledge' is used in the PMBOK® Guide to explain the expert judgment tool or technique. However, on its own, specialized knowledge is not a tool or technique. Therefore, this answer is incorrect.

B Technical knowledge

Incorrect. The combination of words 'technical knowledge' is used in the PMBOK® Guide to explain the expert judgment tool or technique. However, on its own, technical knowledge is not a tool or technique. Therefore, this answer is incorrect.

C Database management

Incorrect. Database management is not a term associated with the PMBOK® Guide. Therefore, this answer is incorrect.

D Expert judgment

Correct. Expert judgment is one of the tools or techniques used during the Direct and Manage Project Work process. Expert judgment is used to complete project activities when expertise in a relevant application area is required.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 94

PMP Exam 1

Question 139

You are approached by a senior manager with upward project influence, who expresses concern about a long-term project you have recently taken over. She asks about your plan to avoid the complications experienced earlier in the project. You are unfamiliar with the previous complications.

Which of the following would best help you obtain details about the past complications and help avoid them?

A Risk management plan

B Change log

C Lessons learned register

D Stakeholder register

Answer: C

This document includes details on previous issues and challenges and can provide advice on how to avoid them.

Explanation:

The lessons learned register is created as an output early in the project in the Manage Project Knowledge process and thereafter used as an input and updated as an output in many processes throughout the project. This register can be a valuable component of a project's success. According to the PMBOK Guide, lessons learned earlier in the project can be applied to later phases to improve efficiency and effectiveness when managing stakeholder engagement.

Details for Each Option:

A Risk management plan

Incorrect. The risk management plan is not the best document to learn the details of the complications referenced in the question. The risk management plan describes how risk management activities will be structured and performed.

B Change log

Incorrect. The question does not reference changes made that would lead you to use the change log. The change log would typically track information regarding time, cost and risk and would not include the situational detail that would be preferable in this situation.

C Lessons learned register

Correct. The PMBOK Guide states that the lessons learned register may include situation descriptions, impact, challenges, recommendations and proposed actions associated with listed situations. The register includes information on how challenges can be avoided; as well as approaches that aided in successful stakeholder engagement and those that were not successful.

D Stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is used to identify stakeholders, their requirements, expectations, category, and other information; it would not provide, however, the situational information needed in this case.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 525, 104

PMP Exam 1

Question 140

In planning a project, a project manager wants to prepare a detailed list of individual project risks and identify potential risk responses along with likely risk owners.

What should the project manager do?

A Create the risk register

B Develop the risk assignments report

C Conduct the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process

D Conduct the Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis process

Answer: A

Hint:

Where are details of individual project risks captured?

Explanation:

The question describes the work required to create the risk register, which is an output of the Identify Risks process. The risk register contains details of identified individual project risks as well as potential risk owners and potential risk responses. Therefore, to collect the information desired by the project manager the next logical step is to create the risk register.

Details for Each Option:

A Create the risk register

Correct. The risk register contains details of identified individual project risks as well as potential risk owners and potential risk responses and is an output of the Identify Risks process. Therefore, by creating the risk register, the project manager will have the desired information.

B Develop the risk assignments report

Incorrect. 'Risk assignments report' is a fake term made up for this question.

C Conduct the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process

Incorrect. The risk register, which contains the information described in the scenario, is needed to conduct the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process. Therefore, the risk register is necessary before the Perform Quantitative Risk Analysis process is started.

D Conduct the Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis process

Incorrect. The Identify Risks process which yields the information described in the scenario, and the risk register, must be completed before starting the process of Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 417

PMP Exam 1

Question 141

During the planning of the construction project you are leading, a team member notices that a steel column in one of the buildings obstructs the path where a water pipe is planned to be installed. You realize that to account for the column, significant changes need to be made to the project management plan.

What should you do?

A Update the project management plan as necessary

B Keep the plan unchanged since the project is in planning

C Consult with the organization's project management office

D Submit a change request to update the project management plan

Answer: A

Hint:

Change control deals with change requests after project baselines are established.

Explanation:

The scenario describes a project in planning. Since project planning is still underway, it can be assumed that the project has yet to be baselined. In such situations, changes are not required to be formally handled by the Perform Integrated Change Control process. As long as the project baselines are not set, you can revisit and update the project management plan as many times as needed without going through the organization's change control process established for the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Update the project management plan as necessary

Correct. The project is in planning, implying the baselines have yet to be established. Therefore, to account for the steel column, you can (and should) directly update the project management plan without going through the formal change control procedure.

B Keep the plan unchanged since the project is in planning

Incorrect. Regardless of the stage of the project (planning, executing, etc.), changes should be addressed. According to the scenario, you have already realized that the project management plan should be updated. Keeping the plan unchanged may negatively impact further planning, endanger staff, and derail the project.

C Consult with the organization's project management office

Incorrect. There is nothing wrong with consulting with the organization's project management office (PMO). However, the scenario describes a relatively simple situation where a change has been identified during project planning. The project manager can just go ahead and update the project management plan as necessary without the need of consulting with the PMO.

D Submit a change request to update the project management plan

Incorrect. According to the scenario, the project is in planning. No change request is needed to update the project management plan during project planning.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 115

PMP Exam 1

Question 142

A_project manager has just notified his supervisor that he has accepted a position with a competitor. The supervisor is angry and accuses the project manager of sabotage by leaving in the middle of a high-profile project. The project manager tries to explain his position, but his supervisor continues yelling accusations. Finally, the project manager turns around and exits the office.

What type of conflict management technique has the project manager used?

A Smoothing/accommodating

B Compromising

C Withdrawing/avoiding

D Collaborating

Answer: C

Hint:

This type of conflict management may not result in a resolution.

Explanation:

Conflict is inevitable in a project environment. Learning how to manage conflict is a valuable interpersonal skill for a project manager. Each technique has its place and use. Retreating from an actual or potential conflict situation and postponing the issue to be better prepared or to be resolved by others is the technique of withdrawing/avoiding. The project manager left the supervisor's office in the midst of the conflict clearly withdrawing from the conflict.

Details for Each Option:

A Smoothing/accommodating

Incorrect. Using a smoothing/accommodating resolution technique involves conceding one's position to the needs of others to maintain harmony and relationships. In the scenario described, neither the project manager nor the supervisor has conceded their positions, and clearly, a harmonious resolution has not been obtained.

B Compromising

Incorrect. Compromising is searching for solutions that bring some degree of satisfaction to all parties to temporarily or partially resolve the conflict. The interaction between the two parties did not lead to any type of resolution, temporary or not.

C Withdrawing/avoiding

Correct. The project manager left the supervisor's office and the conflict behind thereby withdrawing and avoiding the situation.

D Collaborating

Incorrect. Incorporating multiple viewpoints and insights from differing perspectives typically leading to a resolution by consensus is the definition of collaborating. There was no resolution in this scenario making this an incorrect answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 349

Question 143

Due to the length of the project and the volume of concrete involved, inflation is a concern for potential suppliers. You specify that bids be a set price per cubic yard of concrete plus a quarterly adjustment based on the Producer Price Index (PPI).

What is the appropriate type of contract for this situation?

A Firm fixed price (FFP)

B Cost plus fixed fee (CPFF)

C Fixed price with economic price adjustments (FPEPA)

D Fixed price plus inflation adjustment (FPPIA)

Answer: C

Hint:

What type of fixed price contract might include an adjustment for inflation?

Explanation:

The question indicates that the sponsor wants a fixed price contract with an economic adjustment to account for inflation over the course of the project. A fixed price with economic price adjustments contract (FPEPA) is a fixed-price contract, but with a special provision allowing for predefined final adjustments to the contract price due to changed conditions, such as inflation changes, or cost increases (or decreases) for specific commodities. A fixed price with economic price adjustments contract (FPEPA) is the appropriate contract type to use in this situation.

Details for Each Option:

A Firm fixed price (FFP)

Incorrect. A firm fixed price contract (FFP) is a type of fixed price contract where the buyer pays the seller a set amount (as defined by the contract), regardless of the seller's costs. The question states that the contract type will include an adjustment to account for inflation. The FFP contract does not have a provision for an economic price adjustment.

B Cost plus fixed fee (CPFF)

Incorrect. A cost plus fixed fee contract (CPFF) is a type of cost-reimbursable contract where the buyer reimburses the seller for the seller's allowable costs defined by the contract plus a fixed amount of profit (fee). The question states that the contract type will include a fixed price plus an adjustment to account for inflation. The CPFF contract is not a fixed price contract nor does it have a provision for an economic price adjustment.

C Fixed price with economic price adjustments (FPEPA)

Correct. A fixed price with economic price adjustments contract (FPEPA) is a fixed-price contract, but with a special provision allowing for predefined final adjustments to the contract price due to changed conditions, such as inflation changes, or cost increases (or decreases) for specific commodities.

D Fixed price plus inflation adjustment (FPPIA)

Incorrect. 'Fixed price plus inflation adjustment (FPPIA)' is a fake contract type made up for this question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 471

Question 144

Your project has reached a point where there are several executing activities in progress. Many of the project team members are new to the project, and while they are working well as a team, you are concerned as to whether they are following the procedures correctly.

What tool or technique is likely to help you determine if there is a problem?

A Ishikawa diagrams

B Quality audit

C Quality metrics

D Monte Carlo analysis

Answer: B

Hint:

A tool used to identify non-compliance or shortcomings in procedures or processes.

Explanation:

A quality audit is a tool used in the Manage Quality process to determine if the project activities are following organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures. Since the team members are new to the project, a quality audit could identify compliance with the procedures as well as proactively offer assistance to improve implementation of the procedures.

Details for Each Option:

A Ishikawa diagrams

Incorrect. Ishikawa diagrams, also known as fishbone diagrams, are used for finding a root cause of a problem. In the scenario described, you are not sure if there is a problem, so looking for a root cause would be premature.

B Quality audit

Correct. Quality audits help determine if project policies, processes, and procedures are being followed correctly. Conducting an audit could identify whether your team is properly following procedures as well as proactively offer assistance to improve implementation of processes which could, in turn, raise the team's productivity.

C Quality metrics

Incorrect. Quality metrics define product attributes and how the Control Quality process will determine their compliance. This scenario is not related to product attributes, but to processes, therefore, quality metrics would be of no use.

D Monte Carlo analysis

Incorrect. Monte Carlo analysis is a simulation technique typically used in schedule planning and risk analysis. You are concerned about the team's reporting processes. Therefore, this answer is incorrect.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017 Page(s) 294-295

PMP Exam 1

Question 145

You have just been named the project manager of an existing project, which is currently in its execution stage. You have discovered that the project is lacking support from the stakeholders, and a few stakeholders have become resistant. These unresolved issues have caused the project to fall behind schedule. You want to increase the probability of project success by working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations.

Which project management process should your efforts be focused on first?

A Schedule compression

B Manage Schedule

C Manage Stakeholder Engagement

D Interpersonal skills

Answer: C

Which project management process could increase support and minimize resistance from stakeholders?

Explanation:

First of all, the question is asking to select a project management process so you can eliminate any choice that is not a project management process. The key benefit of the Manage Stakeholder Engagement process is that it allows the project manager to increase support and minimize the resistance of stakeholders. Additionally, this process increases the probability of project success by working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations, address issues, and foster appropriate stakeholder involvement.

Details for Each Option:

A Schedule compression

Incorrect. Schedule compression is a technique that could be used to address the schedule issue. However, schedule compression is not a project management process.

B Manage Schedule

Incorrect. ‘Manage Schedule’ is a fake project management process made up for this question.

C Manage Stakeholder Engagement

Correct. Manage Stakeholder Engagement is the process which allows the project manager to increase the probability of success by working with stakeholders to meet their needs and expectations. This is the project management process where you should focus your efforts first.

D Interpersonal skills

Incorrect. Interpersonal skills are behavioral competencies that help project managers analyze situations and interact appropriately. However, these skills are not a project management process.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 507

PMP Exam 1

Question 146

To develop a charter for the project that you have been assigned to lead, you have reviewed the business documents and studied the agreements. You lack the information about the key project deliverables which should be included in the charter.

What is the best way to obtain this information?

A Facilitate a meeting with key stakeholders

B Ask the project sponsor for their advice

C Review the project scope statement

D Talk to the end users of the project

Answer: A

Which option represents one of the tools and techniques associated with the Develop Project Charter process?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the Develop Project Charter process is underway, and meetings are one of the tools and techniques associated with this process. For the Develop Project Charter process, meetings are held with key stakeholders to identify project objectives, success criteria, key deliverables, high-level requirements, summary milestones, and other summary information. Therefore, the best way to obtain information on key deliverables is to facilitate a meeting with key stakeholders.

One may argue that as long as the project charter is not yet approved, the project manager does not have the authority to engage stakeholders in any meetings or even know who the key project stakeholders are. While there is merit to this argument, a project manager is identified and assigned as early in the project as is feasible, preferably while the project charter is being developed. It is reasonable to assume that the sponsor would inform the project manager of the key stakeholders. Waiting for the project charter to be approved and only then collect inputs from stakeholders would introduce an unnecessary delay to the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Facilitate a meeting with key stakeholders

Correct. Meetings are one of the tools and techniques associated with the Develop Project Charter process. For this process, meetings are held with key stakeholders to identify key deliverables and other summary information.

B Ask the project sponsor for their advice

Incorrect. While the project sponsor is undoubtedly a source for information regarding the key deliverables of the project, input should be sought from other key stakeholders and not limited to the project sponsor.

C Review the project scope statement

Incorrect. The project scope statement contains the description of the project scope, major deliverables, assumptions, and constraints. However, the question suggests that the project is still

in the initiation stage. The project scope statement is created during the Define Scope process, which occurs later in project planning.

D Talk to the end users of the project

Incorrect. It is unlikely that the end users of the project will be able to provide you with the information on key project deliverables. It is the key project stakeholders, not the end users, who can help you with your inquiry.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 80-81, 77

PMP Exam 1

Question 147

The city has obtained funding to renovate an existing park, which will require closing the park for one year. The project has entered the execution stage, the heavy equipment has been moved into the park, and the construction has begun. The mayor of the city has called the project manager to discuss the displacement of the homeless people who illegally slept in the park. The project manager reviews the stakeholder register and finds the homeless population was not identified as stakeholders.

What should the project manager do next?

A Remove the homeless people from the park

B Disregard the homeless people and proceed with the project as planned

C Perform a stakeholder analysis on the homeless population

D Update the project charter to include the homeless population

Answer: C

Hint:

What tools and techniques are used after stakeholders have been identified?

Explanation:

Identifying the people or groups of people that could impact or be impacted by the project is an important process in managing a project. Identify Stakeholders is an iterative process that should be performed each time new stakeholders are identified. The project manager must also determine the appropriate focus for each person or group by using the tools and techniques of the Identify Stakeholders process such as stakeholder analysis.

Details for Each Option:

A Remove the homeless people from the park

Incorrect. While the removal of the homeless people from the park is what likely will have to be done, there is not enough information in the question to determine if the project manager has the authority to do so.

B Disregard the homeless people and proceed with the project as planned

Incorrect. The homeless population is being affected by the project and is, therefore, should be treated as project stakeholders. Proceeding with the project as planned disregarding the homeless people would be socially irresponsible and may negatively impact the project and the performing organization.

C Perform a stakeholder analysis on the homeless population

Correct. Stakeholder analysis is a technique that identifies the interests, expectations, and influence of identified stakeholders as well as ways to manage the impact on them or the project. The homeless population was not initially identified as stakeholders, but now that they have been

identified, measures need to be taken to manage this group of stakeholders and the impact of the project on them.

D Update the project charter to include the homeless population

Incorrect. While the project charter contains a list of stakeholders, it is a high-level list only. The scenario suggests that a whole group of stakeholders was missed during project initiation. Although these stakeholders could be added to the project charter, it is not a typical approach. Newly identified stakeholders should be analyzed and added to the stakeholder register, and not the project charter.

Reference:

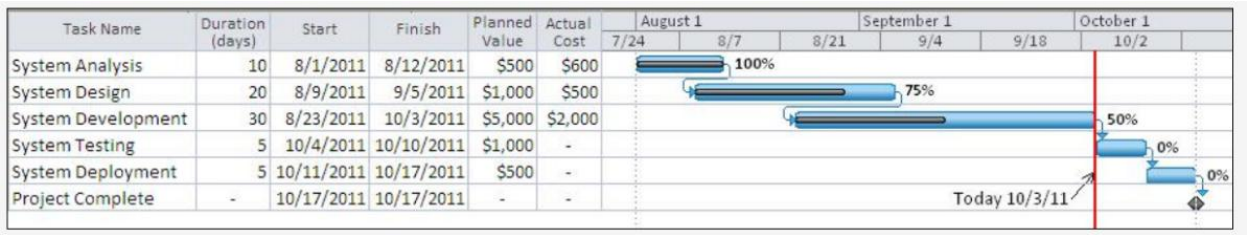
A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 512

PMP Exam 1

Question 148

On October 3rd (represented by the red line in the Gantt chart below), the project sponsor calls you to check on the project's progress and stresses that the project cannot go over the originally planned budget. You want to determine the cost performance that must be maintained for the remainder of the project to achieve the original project budget. The method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete.

What is the project's current TCPI based on the original budget, and what does this mean for the project?



Task Name	Duration (days)	Start	Finish	Planned Value	Actual Cost
System Analysis	10	8/1/2011	8/12/2011	$500	$600
System Design	20	8/9/2011	9/5/2011	$1,000	$500
System Development	30	8/23/2011	10/3/2011	$5,000	$2,000
System Testing	5	10/4/2011	10/10/2011	$1,000	-
System Deployment	5	10/11/2011	10/17/2011	$500	-
Project Complete	-	10/17/2011	10/17/2011	-	-

A The current TCPI is 1.15, and corrective action is required to meet the original budget.

B The current TCPI is 1.15, and no corrective action is required.

C The current TCPI is 0.87, and corrective action is required to meet the original budget.

D The current TCPI is 0.87, and no corrective action is required.

Answer: D

Hint:

TCPI = (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC)

Explanation:

The question is asking to calculate the to-complete performance index (TCPI) based on the original budget. In other words, what is the efficiency that must be maintained to complete the project on plan. The TCPI can be calculated as (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC), where BAC is budget at completion, EV is earned value, and AC is actual costs. The BAC for this project can be determined by the summation of the planned values for each of the individual activities listed in the chart, which is:

$500 + $1,000 + $5,000 + $1,000 + $500 = $8,000

The EV is the sum of the planned work completed for each activity multiplied by the percentage of completion of the corresponding activity. Note, since the scenario mentions that the method used to determine the earned value is based on percent complete, the earned value of a partially completed work package is calculated by multiplying the planned value of the work package by its the percent complete:

- 100% for System Analysis
- 75% for System Design

- 50% for System Development

EV = (100% * $500) + (75% * $1,000) + (50% * $5,000) = $500 + $750 + $2,500 = $3,750

The AC is the sum of the costs for the first three activities:

- $600 for System Analysis
- $500 for System Design
- $2,000 for System Development

AC = $600 + $500 + $2,000 = $3,100

TCPI = (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC) = ($8,000 - $3,750) / ($8,000 - $3,100) = 0.87

The TCPI value of less than 1 indicates that the project is currently on track to complete under budget, and there is some room for the current cost performance to slip without running over budget. With the project running under budget, the cost performance should continue to be monitored, but there is no reason for corrective action at this time.

Note that TCPI can be also be calculated using an estimate at completion (EAC). Since the question indicates that the original budget is still valid and must be met, the EAC was not used in the calculation nor was it provided in the scenario.

Also note, the sponsor is concerned only with the budget. Nothing in the scenario refers to the schedule which may or may not be met.

Details for Each Option:

A The current TCPI is 1.15, and corrective action is required to meet the original budget.

Incorrect. The question is asking for the to-complete performance index (TCPI) based on the original budget, which can be calculated as (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC). TCPI = ($8,000 - $3,750) / ($8,000 - $3,100) = 0.867. The value of 1.15 provided in this answer choice is a result of incorrect usage of the formula by switching the numerator and the denominator. Additionally, since the TCPI is less than 1, corrective action is not required.

B The current TCPI is 1.15, and no corrective action is required.

Incorrect. The question is asking for the to-complete performance index (TCPI) based on the original budget, which can be calculated as (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC). TCPI = ($8,000 - $3,750) / ($8,000 - $3,100) = 0.87. The value of 1.15 provided in this answer choice is a result of

incorrect usage of the formula by switching the numerator and the denominator. The second part of the answer choice (no corrective action is required) represents a true statement. However, since the first part is wrong, this choice is an incorrect answer.

C The current TCPI is 0.87, and corrective action is required to meet the original budget.

Incorrect. The TCPI is 0.87 in this case. However, since the TCPI is less than 1, the project is currently trending under budget, and no corrective action is needed at this point.

D The current TCPI is 0.87, and no corrective action is required.

Correct. The question is asking for the to-complete performance index (TCPI) based on the original budget, which can be calculated as (BAC - EV) / (BAC - AC). TCPI = ($8,000 - $3,750) / ($8,000 - $3,100) = 0.87. Since the TCPI is less than 1, the project is currently trending under budget, and no corrective action is needed at this point.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 266-268

Practice Standard for Earned Value Management - Second Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2011, Page(s) 38-39

https://www.project-management-prepcast.com/pmp-formulas

Question 149

You are scheduling a series of meetings with the team to forecast the effort it will take to complete the work for each milestone. As a point on your agenda, you ask the team to review organizational process assets (OPAs) that may influence their estimates.

Which of the following should the team review?

A The project scope baseline and the schedule management plan

B The assumption log, risk register, and resource calendars

C Estimating policies, lessons learned repository, and project calendars

D Duration estimate databases, team locations, and productivity metrics

Answer: C

Hint:

Remember, the question is looking for organizational process assets.

Explanation:

The scenario implies you are carrying out the Estimate Activity Durations process. Keeping in mind that the question is looking for organizational process assets (OPAs) that can serve as inputs to this process, it should be easy to eliminate the choices that list project management plan components and project documents. For the other two choices, there is a way to distinguish between enterprise environmental factors (EEFs) and OPAs. EEFs are conditions, not under the immediate control of the team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project, program, or portfolio. EEFs can be either internal or external to the organization. OPAs can also be divided into two groups including policies established by the project management office (PMO) of the performing organization and repositories used by the performing organization to store and retrieve organizational information. Only one choice mentions policies and repositories. The other item, project calendar, is an example of a repository that the performing organization can use to store and retrieve information. Therefore, the choice that lists estimation policies, lessons learned repository, and project calendars is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A The project scope baseline and the schedule management plan

Incorrect. The project scope baseline and the schedule management plan are components of the project management plan. Since they are not OPAs, this choice can be eliminated.

B The assumption log, risk register, and resource calendars

Incorrect. The assumption log, risk register, and resource calendars are some of the ten project documents that can be considered as inputs to the Estimate Activity Durations process described in the scenario. None of them considered an OPA, making this choice an incorrect answer.

C Estimating policies, lessons learned repository, and project calendars

Correct. Estimating policies, lessons learned repository, and project calendars are explicitly listed as examples of OPAs that may influence the Estimate Activity Duration process described by the question.

D Duration estimate databases, team locations, and productivity metrics

Incorrect. Duration estimate databases, team locations, and productivity metrics are explicitly listed as examples of EEFs that influence the Estimate Activity Duration process implied by the scenario. However, the question is asking for OPAs, not EEFs.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 199, 38-41

Question 150

Your project sponsor has asked for an overview of the performance and outcome of the project you recently closed. He is requesting a description of the overall project, information on quality and cost evaluations, and information on the completion of scope objectives and criteria for meeting them.

What document will you provide him?

A The cost and scope baseline report

B Final report

C Quality report

D Project charter

Answer: B

Hint:

This report's purpose is to summarize project performance at the close of the project or phase.

Explanation:

The final report provides a summary of the project performance from several different areas within the project. In addition to the items requested by the sponsor in the question, the final report may include the following: information on quality objectives, the criteria used to evaluate quality, verification and delivery dates, validation information on the final product, service, or result, risks or issues encountered during the project and how they were addressed.

Details for Each Option:

A The cost and scope baseline report

Incorrect. Though the cost baseline is the approved version of the established budget and the scope baseline is the approved record of the scope statement, WBS and WBS dictionary, there is not a combined cost and scope baseline report. This report is fictitious and is not a term used in the guide.

B Final report

Correct. The final report provides a summary of the project performance and would include the information requested by your project sponsor as well as a summary of other project performance information. Creating and archiving the final report is one of several activities to be performed at the close of the project.

C Quality report

Incorrect. This report would not provide the information requested by the sponsor in this scenario as it is a report on quality management issues and recommendations for corrective actions and summarizes any findings from quality control activities.

D Project charter

Incorrect. The project charter is a document that formally authorizes the project and would not include results of the final outcome of the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 127-128

PMP Exam 1

Question 151

During a meeting, two attendees begin debating the facts of a major topic of the last meeting. More participants join in and begin arguing. The debate escalates, and conversations veer farther

and farther from the prepared agenda. To avoid further discord, you announce the remaining agenda items will be discussed at the next meeting and abruptly end the meeting.

What should you have done differently to have a better outcome in this situation?

A Used better meeting management skills

B Networked more before project execution has begun

C Used body language to express your frustration

D Recorded any actions to be taken and the action owner

Answer: A

What interpersonal and team skill is needed to ensure that you attain the intended objectives of a meeting?

Explanation:

Project meetings allow project managers and team members the opportunity to utilize several of the 17 tools and techniques within the interpersonal and team skills group. This question requires the knowledge of the proper application of meeting management skills, such as taking necessary steps to ensure meetings are effective and efficient and that they meet the intended objectives.

Details for Each Option:

A Used better meeting management skills

Correct. Meeting management is an interpersonal and team skill that is critical when facing issues or conflicts that arise during meetings. In this case, ensuring there was follow-up on the minutes from the previous meeting, keeping discussions on topic, and managing conflict promptly would likely have produced a better outcome in this meeting.

B Networked more before project execution has begun

Incorrect. Networking is a useful tool in the Manage Communications process; however, it would be an ineffective tool in diffusing the conflicts present during this meeting.

C Used body language to express your frustration

Incorrect. Attempting to convey your disapproval or frustration by use of appropriate body language, such as facial expressions or gestures, is unlikely to be the most effective tool or technique to use in this situation.

D Recorded any actions to be taken and the action owner

Incorrect. Though recording all actions along with the allocated person responsible for each action is a necessary step in all project meetings, this step would not have affected the outcome of the meeting in this scenario.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 381, 386

PMP Exam 1

Question 152

You are managing a project to reformulate a reagent using a new supplier's raw materials. An essential requirement of the new reagent is that when it is used for testing, the same sample should return the same results consistently. You are looking for a way to determine if the reagent measurements are stable and have predictable performance.

Which of the following tools and techniques can help you the most?

A Failure mode and effects analysis (FMEA)

B Decision trees

C Root cause analysis

D Control charts

Answer: D

Which of these compares a process against the upper and lower specification limits based on the requirements?

Explanation:

Control charts are used to determine whether or not a process is stable or has predictable performance. Upper and lower specification limits are based on the requirements and reflect the maximum, and minimum values allowed. Control charts are used most frequently to track repetitive activities such as the results of the testing in the scenario.

Details for Each Option:

A Failure mode and effects analysis (FMEA)

Incorrect. FMEA is not referenced in the PMBOK® Guide, but it is a systematic technique for failure analysis. The scenario did not indicate any type of failure; it asked for a technique to determine if the reagent measurements are stable and predictable, making FMEA an incorrect answer.

B Decision trees

Incorrect. A decision tree is a tool that uses a tree-like graph or model of decisions and their possible consequences. It is a data analysis tool used in quantitative risk analysis to support the selection of the best course of action in the event of a risk. A decision tree does not provide a means to determine the stability or predictability of a process and is, therefore, an incorrect answer.

C Root cause analysis

Incorrect. Root cause analysis is an analytical technique used to determine the primary underlying reason that causes a variance, defect, or risk. The question is asking what tool can be used to assess reagent measurement's stability and predictability. There is no indication that a

problem has been encountered in the scenario. Therefore, the root cause analysis is not necessary.

D Control charts

Correct. Control charts are used to determine whether or not a process is stable or has predictable performance. In this scenario, results obtained from the testing of the reformulated reagents could be plotted on control charts with specification limits to assess if the results are stable over time.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 304

PMP Exam 1

Question 153

You have just completed the creation of the stakeholder register and scheduled a meeting with the key project stakeholders. You want to ensure that they are aware of their roles and responsibilities as well as understand the key project deliverables and milestones.

What should you do?

A Let the stakeholders review the stakeholder register

B Let the stakeholders review the WBS and the RACI chart

C Provide the stakeholders with the approved project charter

D Inform the stakeholders of the approved project management plan

Answer: C

Which document contains the information about the key project deliverables and milestones, and lists the key project stakeholders?

Explanation:

Task 8 of Domain I of the (PMP)® Examination Content Outline reads, "Inform stakeholders of the approved project charter to ensure common understanding of the key deliverables, milestones, and their roles and responsibilities." To answer this question correctly, one should determine what process the project manager has just completed. The question states that you have just completed the creation of the stakeholder register, meaning you have completed the Identify Stakeholders process. This implies that the project charter has already been created and approved because the Develop Project Charter process is performed earlier in the Initiating Process Group. The project charter is a document that authorizes the existence of a project and provides the project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources to project activities. The project charter contains information about the key project deliverables and milestones as well as lists the key project stakeholders. While the PMBOK® Guide does not elaborate on the stakeholders' list in the project charter, it is reasonable to assume that the stakeholders are listed in the project charter along with their roles and responsibilities. Therefore, providing the stakeholders with the approved project charter is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Let the stakeholders review the stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is a project document that contains details about the identified stakeholders. While the stakeholder register may have information about the stakeholders' roles and responsibilities on the project, this document does not contain information about the key project deliverables and milestones.

B Let the stakeholders review the WBS and the RACI chart

Incorrect. You have just completed the creation of the stakeholder register. This means you have just completed the Identify Stakeholders process. It's unlikely that you have also completed the preparation of the WBS which would have required from you to complete the Create WBS process. That process comes later as part of the Planning Process Group. Even if you had the WBS, and the WBS contained the information about the key project deliverables, you could eliminate this answer choice from being a correct answer by noting that neither the WBS nor the RACI chart contains information about the project milestones. Also, a RACI chart may not contain the information about the stakeholders' roles and responsibilities. The RACI chart only shows what activity is performed by what resource and what their responsibility is with regard to the activity.

C Provide the stakeholders with the approved project charter

Correct. The project charter is a document that authorizes the existence of a project and provides the project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources to project activities. The project charter contains information about the key project deliverables and milestones as well as lists the key project stakeholders along with their roles and responsibilities.

D Inform the stakeholders of the approved project management plan

Incorrect. You have just completed the creation of the stakeholder register. This means you have just completed the Identify Stakeholders process. It's unlikely that you have also completed the preparation of the project management plan which would have required you to complete the Develop Project Management Plan process. That process comes later as part of the Planning Process Group. Even if you had completed that process, the project management plan does not contain information about the stakeholders' roles and responsibilities on the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 81; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain I, Task 8

PMP Exam 1

Question 154

Based on your experience as a project manager, you know that there is a confusion about the difference between the Validate Scope process and the Control Quality process.

Which of the following statements would help clarify this confusion?

A The Validate Scope process is concerned with the correctness of the deliverables while the Control Quality process is concerned with acceptance of the deliverables.

B The Validate Scope process is concerned with acceptance of the deliverables while the Control Quality process is concerned with the correctness of the deliverables.

C Both the Validate Scope process and the Control Quality process are interchangeable and concerned with the correctness and acceptance of the project deliverables.

D The Validate Scope process belongs to the Executing Process Group while the Control Quality process belongs to the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group.

Answer: B

Control Quality is generally performed before Validate Scope. Both are concerned with the deliverables.

Explanation:

Both processes indicated in the scenario, Validate Scope and Control Quality, are interrelated. The Control Quality process inspects the deliverables for correctness, resulting in verified deliverables as outputs. Verified deliverables are inputs to the Validate Scope process. In the Validate Scope process, the verified deliverables are reviewed with the customer resulting in accepted deliverables. Accepted deliverables are an output from the Validate Scope process. Both processes are necessary to gain formal acceptance of the deliverable from the customer. Eventually, accepted deliverables serve as in input to the Close Project or Phase process.

Details for Each Option:

A The Validate Scope process is concerned with the correctness of the deliverables while the Control Quality process is concerned with acceptance of the deliverables.

Incorrect. The Validate Scope process is concerned with 'acceptance' of the deliverable by the customer. The Control Quality process is concerned with the 'correctness' of the deliverable and meeting the quality requirements specified for the deliverables. This answer is the exact opposite of the correct answer and therefore incorrect.

B The Validate Scope process is concerned with acceptance of the deliverables while the Control Quality process is concerned with the correctness of the deliverables.

Correct. The Control Quality process inspects the deliverables for correctness, resulting in a verified deliverable. In the Validate Scope process, the verified deliverable is reviewed with the customer resulting in an accepted deliverable. Therefore, Validate Scope is concerned with the acceptance of deliverables and Control Quality is concerned with correctness, or quality, of deliverables.

C Both the Validate Scope process and the Control Quality process are interchangeable and concerned with the correctness and acceptance of the project deliverables.

Incorrect. The processes are not interchangeable. The Validate Scope process is concerned with acceptance of the deliverables while the Control Quality process is concerned with the correctness of the deliverables.

D The Validate Scope process belongs to the Executing Process Group while the Control Quality process belongs to the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group.

Incorrect. Both the Validate Scope and the Control Quality processes belong to the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 164

PMP Exam 1

Question 155

A_project manager uses a bottom-up approach in creating estimates for the number of programmers with the appropriate skill set that will be required for the project.

Once the team resources have been estimated, what should the project manager do next?

A Develop the resource management plan

B Update the requirements traceability matrix

C Assign the identified resources as risk owners

D Create the resource breakdown structure

Answer: D

Hint:

Of the available choices, which is created as a result of the Estimate Activity Resources process?

Explanation:

It can be inferred from the question that the project manager is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process. The resource breakdown structure is created as an output of this process. The resource breakdown structure is a hierarchical representation of resources by category and type. Of the available choices, creating the resource breakdown structure is the next thing the project manager should do.

Details for Each Option:

A Develop the resource management plan

Incorrect. The question suggests that the project manager is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process. The resource management plan is created prior to and used during the Estimate Activity Resources process.

B Update the requirements traceability matrix

Incorrect. The requirements traceability matrix is a grid that links product requirements from their origin to the deliverables that satisfy them. According to the scenario, the project manager is carrying out the Estimate Activity Resources process. Updates to the requirements traceability matrix is not an output of this process.

C Assign the identified resources as risk owners

Incorrect. Risk owners are nominated as part of the planning processes of the Project Risk Management Knowledge Area, while the question describes resource planning.

D Create the resource breakdown structure

Correct. It can be inferred from the scenario that the project manager is performing the Estimate Activity Resources process. The resource breakdown structure is created as a result of the Estimate Activity Resources process. Of the available options, creating the resource breakdown structure is the next thing the project manager should do.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 326-327

Question 156

A_project manager has taken over a project, which is now in closure. The customer has accepted the deliverables, and the project manager is trying to determine who should sign off on the project.

What should the project manager do?

A Sign the project by herself

B Follow the project charter

C Ask the customer to sign

D Consult with the sponsor

Answer: B

Hint:

This was defined very early in the project.

Explanation:

The scenario suggests the project manager is carrying out the activities associated with the Close Project or Phase process. The project charter is one of the inputs to this process and is used to provide the project manager and the team with the information on the project success criteria, the approval requirements, and who will sign off on the project. Regardless of whether the project manager was with the project since its beginning or has taken the project over during its closure, to find out who should sign off on the project, the project manager should follow the guidelines specified in the project charter.

Details for Each Option:

A Sign the project by herself

Incorrect. It is possible that the project manager is the individual responsible for signing off on the project. However, this determination cannot be done based on the information available in the question. The project manager should check the project charter to make this determination.

B Follow the project charter

Correct. As it pertains to the Close Project or Phase process described in the scenario, the project charter specifies the project success criteria, the approval requirements, and who will sign off on the project, making this choice the best answer to the question asked.

C Ask the customer to sign

Incorrect. According to the scenario, the customer has accepted the project deliverables, However, this does not necessarily mean the customer (or their representatives) are the one to sign off on the project. This information should be provided in the project charter.

D Consult with the sponsor

Incorrect. While it is reasonable to assume the project sponsor may know who should sign off on the project, there is a better course of action for the project manager to answer her question without bothering the project sponsor.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 124

PMP Exam 1

Question 157

A_project involving teams and vendors in multiple countries is halfway complete when you replace the project manager. You have not managed a global project before, and you are interested in learning how the project communications are being distributed and what technology is being used to share them.

Where will you find this information?

A The distribution management plan

B The stakeholder engagement plan

C The requirements management plan

D The communications management plan

Answer: D

Hint:

What is a subsidiary of the project management plan that describes project communications?

Explanation:

The communications management plan is a component of the project management plan that describes how project communications will be planned, structured, implemented, and monitored for effectiveness. Included in the communications management plan is information such as stakeholder communication requirements, the frequency of distributions, technologies used to distribute the information, and individuals or groups who will receive the information. This document will provide all the information you need for understanding the project's communications plan. Therefore, it is the correct answer.

Details for Each Option:

A The distribution management plan

Incorrect. The distribution management plan is a made-up term for this question.

B The stakeholder engagement plan

Incorrect. The stakeholder engagement identifies strategies to promote the productive involvement of stakeholders in a project. Therefore, this is an incorrect answer.

C The requirements management plan

Incorrect. The requirements management plan describes how project product requirements will be analyzed, documented, and managed. Therefore, this is not a correct answer.

D The communications management plan

Correct. The communications management plan describes the information needs of the stakeholders and how they will be addressed. In the communications management plan, you will find information such as frequency of communications, technology to be used, content, format, and language to be used. Therefore, this is a correct answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 366, 377

PMP Exam 1

Question 158

A_project is nearing its end when the project manager receives an approved change request to replace a defective unit.

What should the project manager do next?

A Capture the problem in the issue log

B Meet with the change control board

C Have the defective unit repaired

D Have the defective unit replaced

Answer: D

Hint:

What should be done with an approved change request?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the Direct and Manage Project Work process is being carried out. Approved change requests are one of the inputs to that process. The project manager has received an approved change request. It is now her responsibility to ensure the approved change request is implemented as specified. Since the change request calls for the replacement of the defective unit, the next step for the project manager is to have the defective unit replaced.

Details for Each Option:

A Capture the problem in the issue log

Incorrect. An issue log is a project document where information about project issues is recorded and monitored. The issue log is updated with the status and final solution, but a description of the problem would have been captured at the time the issue occurred rather than when the remedy is implemented.

B Meet with the change control board

Incorrect. The change control board (CCB) is responsible for reviewing and rendering a decision on change requests. The question indicates that the project manager received an approved change request, so a decision has already been made. Therefore, meeting with the CCB is not required. Additionally, it is not clear what is the purpose of meeting with the CCB.

C Have the defective unit repaired

Incorrect. Alternatives for resolving the issue would have been analyzed during the Perform Integrated Change Control process when the change request was originally submitted. The decision was made to approve the change request to replace rather than repair the defective unit.

D Have the defective unit replaced

Correct. The project manager has received an approved change request. It is now her responsibility to ensure that the approved change request is implemented as specified by replacing the defective unit.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 93

PMP Exam 1

Question 159

A_project manager is organizing a meeting to gain approval for the project management plan. Before the meeting is scheduled, the organization announces a restructuring, which is effective immediately and impacts several key stakeholders for the project. To ensure the appropriate stakeholders are invited to the meeting, the project manager needs to update the relevant project documentation to reflect the new organizational structure.

What is the best course of action?

A Cancel the meeting and wait for the instructions from the project sponsor

B Update the stakeholder register to reflect the new organizational structure

C Schedule the meeting with the original list of project stakeholders

D Submit a change request to update the stakeholder register

Answer: B

Hint:

It is important to ensure that the relevant stakeholders are invited to the meeting.

Explanation:

Based on the scenario provided, the new organizational structure resulted in changes among project stakeholders. Stakeholder identification is an ongoing process that can be done at any point throughout the project life cycle. Once new information about stakeholders becomes available, the stakeholder register should be updated. Since the stakeholder register is a project document, a change request is not typically required to update the stakeholder register. Regardless, no change requests are required until the project management plan has been approved. Therefore, of the available choices, updating the stakeholder register to reflect the new organizational structure is the best course of action for the project manager to take in this situation.

Details for Each Option:

A Cancel the meeting and wait for the instructions from the project sponsor

Incorrect. Canceling the meeting and waiting for the instructions from the project sponsor is a reactive approach. The project manager should be proactive. Updating the stakeholder register to reflect the new organizational structure and inviting the relevant stakeholders is a better course of action.

B Update the stakeholder register to reflect the new organizational structure

Correct. The stakeholder register should be updated to reflect the new organizational structure to ensure the relevant stakeholders are invited to the meeting.

C Schedule the meeting with the original list of project stakeholders

Incorrect. Scheduling the meeting as planned with the original list of project stakeholders may result in a situation where the wrong stakeholders are invited to the meeting while others are missing from it.

D Submit a change request to update the stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register is a project document, and as such, does not typically require an approved change request to modify. The configuration management plan will specify which,

if any, project documents are placed under configuration control. Regardless, the question indicates that the project management plan has yet to be approved, and change requests are not necessary until the project management has been approved.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 83; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain 2, Task 11

PMP Exam 1

Question 160

You are managing a project, which has been plagued with quality issues, and you decide to schedule a lessons learned meeting to determine how to address the quality issues. The meeting is rather contentious with lengthy discussions about everything that has gone wrong on the project but adjourned without any concrete actions to prevent the problems from recurring.

What might have made the meeting more productive?

A Development of a more detailed agenda for the meeting

B The use of a skilled facilitator to guide the meeting

C Inviting more appropriate meeting participants

D An update to the lessons learned register after the meeting

Answer: B

Hint:

What is required to turn negatives into positives to ensure meeting objectives are met?

Explanation:

This question is a good example of questions that might be encountered in the real exam, forcing the student to choose between two potentially correct answers. In this case, a detailed agenda and a skilled facilitator both may have been beneficial in making the meeting more productive. The PMP aspirant must choose the 'best' answer of the options presented whether or not the question asks for the 'best' response. Of course, in the real world, you would elect to have both a skilled facilitator and a detailed agenda, but the PMP exam will expect the PMP aspirant to decide which answer will provide a better outcome.

A facilitator can help keep you, and everyone else, on track. Lessons learned sessions don't deliver any value when the discussion only focuses on what went wrong. A facilitator can help guide the group to turn negatives into positives by eliciting what can be done differently in the future and develop concrete actions to make sure the problems do not recur on the project. Developing a detailed agenda might have been a helpful tool to keep the meeting on track and make sure that more was discussed other than just what went wrong. However, as anyone with experience in running meetings knows, an agenda by itself will not keep a meeting on track. A skilled facilitator can ensure that meeting objectives are met with or without a detailed agenda. Therefore, of the available choices, using a skilled facilitator provides the best strategy to ensure meeting objectives are met.

Details for Each Option:

A Development of a more detailed agenda for the meeting

Incorrect. Developing a detailed agenda might have been a helpful tool to keep the meeting on track and make sure that more was discussed other than just what went wrong. However, as anyone with experience in running meetings knows, an agenda by itself will not keep a meeting on track. A skilled facilitator is essential to ensure that the meeting's objectives are achieved with or without a detailed agenda.

B The use of a skilled facilitator to guide the meeting

Correct. A facilitator can help keep you, and everyone else, on track. Lessons learned sessions don't deliver any value when the discussion only focuses on what went wrong. A facilitator can help guide the group to turn negatives into positives by eliciting what can be done differently in the future and developing concrete actions to make sure the problems do not recur on the project.

C Inviting more appropriate meeting participants

Incorrect. There is no indication from the description provided by the question to indicate that the wrong participants were in attendance. On the contrary, the fact that there was a lengthy discussion about what has gone wrong on the project suggests that the meeting participants are familiar with the issues raised at the meeting.

D An update to the lessons learned register after the meeting

Incorrect. The lessons learned register should be updated with any knowledge gained that might be beneficial in addressing the quality issues. However, the question states that the meeting adjourned without any concrete actions to prevent the problems from occurring in the future, leaving little or nothing to add to the lessons learned register.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 305, 80; see also https://www.projectmanagement.com/blog-post/28764/Lessons-Learned-Management-Techniques-for-the-PMP--Exam

Question 161

Your project is a few days into execution. You are concerned because you notice that your project team members hardly speak to one another, aside from polite small-talk, and do not seem to be collaborating very much. As the leader of the team, you are playing a dominant role during meetings and begin to wonder if there is something wrong with your project team.

According to Tuckman, what stage is being described?

A Storming

B Performing

C Forming

D Norming

Answer: C

One of these options refers to the earliest phase in Tuckman's stages of team development, where team members meet and learn more about the project and behave more independently.

Explanation:

In this scenario, the project is early in execution, with the team members that have apparently just been acquired, which makes it most likely to be the forming phase - the first phase in Tuckman's Ladder. The team is still getting to know one another and adjusting to their roles while working more independently. This closely matches the definition of forming.

Details for Each Option:

A Storming

Incorrect. The question states that the project is a few days into execution, and though the team has yet to begin working more collaboratively, there is no mention of tension, disagreement, or conflict amongst the team members, which is common during the storming phase.

B Performing

Incorrect. In the performing stage, teams tend to function as a well-organized unit. They are interdependent and work through issues smoothly and effectively, which is not the scenario described here.

C Forming

Correct. This scenario describes forming. At this stage, team members tend to be polite and behave more independently until they know how they fit into the overall project and what roles they will play. In the forming stage, the project manager tends to take on more of a dominant role as team members are learning more about the project.

D Norming

Incorrect. In the norming phase, team members begin to work together and adjust their work habits and behaviors to support the team. The team members learn to trust each other.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 338

PMP Exam 1

Question 162

You are managing a project and have encountered a situation that was not identified during the risk planning process. To resolve the situation, additional work is required to be added to the project. This work will increase the project cost.

To whom should you escalate the need for additional funds to complete that work?

A Program manager

B Project team

C Project sponsor

D Portfolio manager

Answer: C

Issues beyond the control of a project manager should be escalated to the person who provides financial resources to the project.

Explanation:

Typically, funds to cover unforeseen work come from management reserves. An approved change request is required to move funds from the management reserves into the cost baseline. Ideally, submitting a change request would be the correct answer. However, this option is not provided as an answer choice. Therefore, the goal is to select the best option among the choices given. The project sponsor provides resources and support for the project, program, or portfolio and has a high interest in enabling their success. Of the choices offered, the project sponsor would be the best person to secure additional funding for the project, either from management reserves or any other applicable source, thus making the project sponsor the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Program manager

Incorrect. A program is a group of related projects managed in a coordinated manner to obtain benefits not available from managing them individually. A program manager does not have direct responsibility for individual projects but instead coordinates the activities of the program to ensure the program benefits are delivered as expected. Funding for a project is secured

through a project sponsor; therefore, additional funding would also be the responsibility of the sponsor.

B Project team

Incorrect. Project team members are responsible for completing the work required for the project. It is the team's role to do the planning, executing, monitoring and controlling of the project to which they are assigned. The project team members are not at a corporate level to secure funding or add additional funding. Therefore, this is not a correct answer.

C Project sponsor

Correct. A project sponsor provides resources and support for the project, program, or portfolio and is accountable for enabling its success. In this scenario, the project manager has determined the additional work required as a result of the previously unidentified risk necessitates an increase in the budget. The sponsor obtained the initial funding for the project; therefore, the sponsor would be the person to whom the project manager would request additional funding.

D Portfolio manager

Incorrect. A portfolio is a group of projects, programs, and operations managed as a group to achieve strategic objectives. A portfolio manager focuses on doing the 'right' programs and projects to meet the company's business goals and therefore, does not focus on managing individual projects. Securing additional funding for a project is a direct responsibility of the project sponsor and not a portfolio manager making this an incorrect answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 11-15, 723

Question 163

The project you are leading has a current CPI of 1.0 and SPI of 0.8. You have been notified by the project management office that your project has been selected for a quality audit that is scheduled to take place over the coming weeks.

What should be your primary concern with regards to the audit?

A That the project falls back in line with the project schedule

B Finding errors, defects, bugs, or other nonconformance problems in the product

C Assuring that the project products fall within the sponsor's acceptance limits

D That the work performed lines up with company policies, processes, and procedures

Answer: D

Hint:

Quality audits in Manage Quality do not focus on the product.

Explanation:

A quality audit is among the tools and techniques of the Manage Quality process, which is concerned with translating the quality management plan into executable quality activities that incorporate the organization's quality policies into the project. A quality audit is a structured, independent process used to determine if project activities comply with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures. Quality audits do not focus on the product or the project's schedule or cost performance. Therefore, of the choices available, ensuring that work complies with the company policies, processes, and procedures should be your primary concern.

One may argue that under the circumstances described in the scenario, with the project behind schedule, having an audit in the middle of project execution would be a hassle to the project manager, the team, the project stakeholders, and will likely put the project behind schedule even further. However, you, as the project manager, can do nothing about that. You have no choice but accept the fact the audit is coming and have to be prepared for it. So what will be your primary concern with regards to the audit? As mentioned above, quality audits do not focus on the product or the project's schedule or cost performance. Therefore, of the choices available,

ensuring that work complies with the company policies, processes, and procedures should be your primary concern.

Details for Each Option:

A That the project falls back in line with the project schedule

Incorrect. Not every piece of information provided is actually relevant to the question. In this case, the project being behind schedule (as indicated by the SPI number) is an irrelevant issue, since quality audits are not concerned with the schedule or cost performance of a project but rather how the work being performed lines up with the policies, processes, and procedures of the organization.

B Finding errors, defects, bugs, or other nonconformance problems in the product

Incorrect. Quality audits in Manage Quality do not focus on the product, but rather on the processes and their conformance to the quality management plan.

C Assuring that the project products fall within the sponsor's acceptance limits

Incorrect. This sounds more like the activities that take place in the Control Quality process, which focus on determining if the project outputs are complete, correct, and meet customer expectations.

D That the work performed lines up with company policies, processes, and procedures

Correct. A quality audit is a structured, independent process used to determine if project activities comply with organizational and project policies, processes, and procedures.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 294-295, 298

PMP Exam 1

Question 164

Midway into project execution, a supplier notifies the project manager that the roof over their manufacturing plant has collapsed due to a tornado. The supplier wants to terminate the contract citing the 'Act of God' clause in the contract.

What should the project manager do next?

A Close the procurement with the supplier

B Begin the process of claims administration

C Insist the supplier delivers on the contract

D Consult with the project sponsor

Answer: A

Hint:

When a contract is terminated for just cause, what should the project manager do next?

Explanation:

Vendor contracts typically contain a force majeure clause, sometimes referred to as an 'Act of God clause', which provides a defense mechanism against breach of contract for circumstances beyond human control such as natural disasters. The reason for terminating the contract provided by the vendor appears to meet the definition of a force majeure. Hence, the vendor is within their legal right to terminate the contract. The project manager should close the procurement and focus on finding another qualified vendor to supply the required parts.

Details for Each Option:

A Close the procurement with the supplier

Correct. Contracts typically contain a force majeure clause, sometimes referred to as an act of God clause, which provides a defense against breach of contract for circumstances beyond human control such as natural disasters. The reason for terminating the contract provided by the supplier appears to meet the definition of a force majeure.

B Begin the process of claims administration

Incorrect. Claims administration refers to contested changes where the buyer and seller cannot reach an agreement. There is not enough information in the question to determine if there is any disagreement on the project. The situation is relatively straightforward - an act of God has occurred resulting in the supplier being unable to deliver on the contract. Since the contract likely has the force majeure clause, the procurement with the supplier should be closed.

C Insist the supplier delivers on the contract

Incorrect. Based on the question text, the supplier most likely has the right to terminate the contract. If the supplier were able to deliver as planned, they would not be requesting to terminate the contract and forfeiting the associated profits.

D Consult with the project sponsor

Incorrect. It is clear from the circumstances described by the scenario that the supplier will not be able to deliver on the contract, and the project manager will need to find another source for the parts. Therefore, it is unlikely that the sponsor will be able to provide any helpful advice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 499, 125

Question 165

Due to funding related issues a few months ago, your company was forced to terminate some of its projects. Since then, one of the projects has been re-initiated, and you have been assigned to manage it. You want to find out the exact reasons for the termination of the project.

Which of the following should you review to obtain this information?

A Final product, service, or result

B Project documents

C Lesson learned repository

D Project or phase closure documents

Answer: D

Hint:

The reasons for termination can be found in a specific set of documents.

Explanation:

When a project is closed (either as planned or terminated prematurely) or, in other words, when the Close Project or Phase process is complete, project or phase closure documents, an output of this process, indicate the reason why the project was terminated and formalize the procedures for the transfer of the finished and unfinished deliverables of the canceled project to others. Project or phase closure documents are organizational process assets. Therefore, to find out the exact reasons for the termination of the project, of the available choices, reviewing the project or phase closure documents will provide you with the needed information and is, therefore, the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Final product, service, or result

Incorrect. The final product, service or result are the accepted deliverables from a project, which are handed over to the ongoing organization that will operate, maintain, and support them. Reviewing the final product, service, or result would not help you determine the reasons for the termination of the project. Those are not documents that contain this information.

B Project documents

Incorrect. Project documents are any project-related documents that are not part of the project management plan. They include documents such as assumption and issue logs, lessons learned register, project schedule, resource calendars, etc. None of the project documents will contain information on why the project was terminated.

C Lesson learned repository

Incorrect. The lesson learned repository contains lesson learned and knowledge gained throughout a project. However, the lessons learned repository does not indicate why the project was terminated, making this choice an incorrect answer.

D Project or phase closure documents

Correct. If the project was terminated prior to completion, the project or phase closure documents are the formal documentation that indicates why the project was terminated and formalizes the procedures for the transfer of the finished and unfinished deliverables of the terminated project to others. The project or phase closure documents are organizational process assets.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 128

Question 166

A_senior executive suggests initiating a project to replace a significant portion of the company's labor force with an automated production line. Other company executives are skeptical that this approach is the best way to increase profit margins and wonder if they are ready to sponsor such an effort.

What is the first thing that should be done in this scenario?

A Performing a needs assessment

B Consulting with the project management office

C Appointing a project sponsor to create a project charter

D Providing a project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources

Answer: A

Hint:

understanding the business goals and objectives, issues, and opportunities and recommending proposals to address them?

Explanation:

In this scenario, the skepticism of the other executives suggests that the proposed solution only partially, if at all, addresses the need to increase profit margins. The executive team thinks other alternatives and additional solutions should be considered to increase margins. In other words, the needs assessment should be performed first. The needs assessment involves understanding business goals and objectives, issues, and opportunities and recommending proposals to address them. Therefore, the first thing for the company to do in this situation before taking any action is to perform a needs assessment to evaluate options to address the competitive issues faced by the company, and only then provide recommendations.

Details for Each Option:

A Performing a needs assessment

Correct. A needs assessment involves understanding business goals and objectives, issues, and opportunities and recommending proposals to address them. A needs assessment is typically the first step of the pre-project work for a new project.

B Consulting with the project management office

Incorrect. A project management office (PMO) is a management structure that standardizes the project-related governance processes and facilitates the sharing of resources, methodologies, tools and techniques. While the PMO may be able to make some suggestions, there is another choice that is more immediate and should be attempted first prior to consulting with the PMO.

C Appointing a project sponsor to create a project charter

Incorrect. Creating the project charter is the first step when starting a project, but based on the scenario, there is no agreement that automating the product line is the best way to increase profit margins. Pre-project work should be completed before a project sponsor can create the project charter.

D Providing a project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources

Incorrect. The project charter authorizes the project manager to apply organizational resources to the project. The pre-project work should be completed before the project charter is created and a project manager is provided the authority to apply organizational resources to the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 30, 77

PMP Exam 1

Question 167

You want to determine the progress that the team members have made so far on the project you are leading. You see that activity A was completed on July 30th and took 25 hours, activity B is not yet complete, but has taken 12 hours so far, there have been 15 change requests, and the actual costs are $1.1 million.

What is this information called?

A Work performance data

B Progress activity data

C Work performance reports

D Work performance information

Answer: A

This is raw data and measurements that are an output of the Direct and Manage Project Work process.

Explanation:

Work performance data is raw observations and measurements that are collected during project execution. Work performance data is an input to various controlling processes where it is analyzed and put into context and becomes an output called work performance information. Work performance reports are the organized presentation of the work performance information used to generate decisions, raise issues, or awareness. Since the information you have received is raw data and out of context, it is work performance data.

Details for Each Option:

A Work performance data

Correct. Work performance data is the raw results, measurements, and observations obtained during the Direct and Manage Project Work process.

B Progress activity data

Incorrect. 'Progress activity data' is a made-up term for this question.

C Work performance reports

Incorrect. Work performance reports are the organized presentation of the work performance information. These reports are provided to various stakeholders who need the information. The information you have received from your team is simply data which has not been put into any context.

D Work performance information

Incorrect. Work performance information is work performance data that is analyzed in context and compared against the project management plan during the controlling processes. Based on the scenario described, you are reviewing raw data that has not yet been analyzed.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 95, 26

Question 168

On a project that you are leading, you have developed all subsidiary management plans and had them approved.

What should you do next?

A Collect detailed requirements

B Develop the process improvement plan

C Create the work breakdown structure

D Develop the project scope statement

Answer: A

Hint:

What should you do before defining the scope of the project?

Explanation:

The project management plan consists of several components. They are grouped into three main categories: the subsidiary management plans (those that cover project management knowledge areas, such as the scope management plan, the cost management plan, etc.), the baselines, and additional components. The question states that the subsidiary management plans have been developed and approved. The subsidiary management plans are typically created at the beginning of project planning. Those plans mainly answer the question, "How would you manage Knowledge Area XYZ on your project?". For example, the scope management plan would describe how the project scope will be defined, developed, monitored, controlled, and validated. This plan, however, does not include the requirements themselves. Therefore, of the choices provided, you have to select the one that logically comes after these subsidiary plans have been approved. For example, developing baselines should likely be the next step. Collecting detailed project requirements is the first step in creating the scope baseline.

In other words, the goal of the Planning Process Group is to come away with a thoroughly planned project and well-defined scope statement. The beginning steps of planning are determining how you will plan for each knowledge area followed by collecting detailed requirements from stakeholders. The foundation for defining the product and project scope results from the proper collection of requirements from stakeholders so you will understand their needs and objectives. In this scenario, you have planned for all the knowledge areas so the next step in planning would be collecting requirements which will lead you to a well-defined scope statement that will become part of the scope baseline.

Details for Each Option:

A Collect detailed requirements

Correct. Collect Requirements is the process of determining, documenting, and managing stakeholder needs and requirements to meet project objectives. After the management plans for all the knowledge areas are created, but before developing a scope statement, you will need to collect detailed requirements from stakeholders.

B Develop the process improvement plan

Incorrect. The process improvement plan is not a plan specified in the PMBOK® Guide.

C Create the work breakdown structure

Incorrect. The work breakdown structure (WBS) is a hierarchical decomposition if the total scope of work to be carried out on a project. The WBS cannot be created before the detailed project and product requirements are collected.

D Develop the project scope statement

Incorrect. Before developing the scope statement, you need to know details of what the stakeholders expect from the project. Collecting requirements will provide a basis for defining the product scope and the project scope and will need to be completed before creating the project scope statement.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 87-88, 138

PMP Exam 1

Question 169

You are managing a multiphase project. Different teams will be working during different phases.

When would you typically schedule the kick-off meeting?

A At the beginning of each phase

B Once, at the beginning of the project

C Multiphase projects do not require a kick-off meeting

D At the beginning of every quarter

Answer: A

Hint:

Each phase in a multiphase project is typically treated as a project of its own.

Explanation:

The purpose of the kick-off meeting is to communicate the objectives of the project (or phase), gain the commitment of the project team, and explain the roles and responsibilities of the project stakeholders. A project phase is a collection of logically related activities that culminates in the completion of one or more deliverables. Typically, each project phase has its own objectives. Sometimes, each project phase is executed by a different team, which is the scenario described in the question. The phases may also have different stakeholders. Therefore, it makes sense to hold the kick-off meeting at the beginning of each phase to communicate the objectives of the phase, gain the commitment of the new team, and explain (or remind) roles and responsibilities of the project stakeholders.

Details for Each Option:

A At the beginning of each phase

Correct. Each phase of a multiphase project is typically treated as a project of its own. Therefore, of the choices provided, holding a kick-off meeting for a multiphase project at the beginning of each phase is the best answer to the question asked.

B Once, at the beginning of the project

Incorrect. Each phase of a multiphase project is typically treated as a project of its own. The purpose of the kick-off meeting is to communicate the objectives of the project (or phase), gain the commitment of the team, and explain the roles and responsibilities of the project stakeholders. Therefore, holding the kick-off meeting only once, at the beginning of the project, would unlikely be sufficient for each project phase as each phase has at a minimum its own objectives.

C Multiphase projects do not require a kick-off meeting

Incorrect. Any project, either single or multiphase, requires a kick-off meeting.

D At the beginning of every quarter

Incorrect. If the project phases were scheduled to start every quarter, then this answer choice could have been a plausible option. However, there is not enough information in the question to support this. Therefore, this choice is not the best answer to the question asked.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 86

Question 170

In a phone call between the client and the project manager, the client requests that a feature is to be added to the product. The project manager agrees to include the feature for an extra $5,000 and instructs the team to develop the feature. The product is delivered, the client is pleased and accepts the deliverables but refuses to pay the cost of the added feature.

How could this situation have been avoided?

A The project manager could have selected a more appropriate choice of communication media.

B The scope could have been cut to balance the cost of the feature.

C The project manager should have requested a lower price for the feature.

D Nothing could have been done differently.

Answer: A

Hint:

What form of communication is required to change the terms of a contract?

Explanation:

The question refers to the Manage Communications process. The choice of media is part of this process and includes decisions such as when to communicate in writing versus orally. The project manager should have followed up with formal written communication in the form of an updated contract to reflect the increased cost associated with the increase in the project's scope, instead of relying on informal oral communication. If the project manager had selected the appropriate choice of media, the issue likely could have been avoided.

Details for Each Option:

A The project manager could have selected a more appropriate choice of communication media.

Correct. For effective communications management, one should consider the choice of media, which includes deciding when to communicate in writing versus orally. The project manager should have followed up the conversation over the phone with formal written communication in

the form of an updated contract to reflect the cost associated with the increase in the project's scope, instead of relying on informal oral communication.

B The scope could have been cut to balance the cost of the feature.

Incorrect. Cutting the scope would violate the terms of the contract and would not have likely prevented the issue.

C The project manager should have requested a lower price for the feature.

Incorrect. There is not enough information in the question to determine the cost of the feature and the price to be quoted to the customer. Regardless, the essence of the question is not about the price but the process of submitting changes on a project, which, in this case, has not been properly carried out.

D Nothing could have been done differently.

Incorrect. The issue could have been avoided by following up with formal written communication in the form of an updated contract including the cost of the added scope.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 381

PMP Exam 1

Question 171

To better understand the manufacturing process flow, a project manager needs a visual representation of the sequence of steps for the process, which can then be used to identify where quality defects can occur and where to incorporate quality checks.

What diagramming technique would be most helpful in this situation?

A Flowchart

B Ishikawa diagram

C Matrix diagram

D Influence diagram

Answer: A

Hint:

Which diagramming technique is also known as a process map?

Explanation:

A flowchart is a depiction in a diagram format of the inputs, process actions, and outputs of one or more processes within a system. When flowcharts are used to represent the steps in a process, they are sometimes called a process flow diagram and can be used for identifying where quality defects can occur or where to incorporate quality checks. Among the available options, only a flowchart provides a visual representation of the sequence of steps in a process as is asked by the question.

Details for Each Option:

A Flowchart

Correct. When flowcharts are used to represent the steps in a process, they are sometimes called a process flow diagram and can be used for identifying where quality defects can occur or where to incorporate quality checks.

B Ishikawa diagram

Incorrect. An Ishikawa diagram, also known as a fishbone diagram, is a decomposition technique that helps trace an undesirable effect back to its root cause. The question describes the diagramming of a process flow rather than root cause analysis.

C Matrix diagram

Incorrect. A matrix diagram seeks to show the strength of relationships between factors, causes, and objectives that exist between the rows and columns that form the matrix. The question describes a diagram for a sequence of steps as opposed to a matrix.

D Influence diagram

Incorrect. An influence diagram is a graphical representation of situations showing causal influences, time ordering of events, and other relationships among variables and outcomes. An influence diagram does not provide the visualization of a process flow.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 284

PMP Exam 1

Question 172

You are looking for guidance on how to acquire a team for your project.

Where is the best place to look for this information?

A Project charter

B Stakeholder engagement plan

C Resource management plan

D Procurement management plan

Answer: C

Hint:

Where is the best place to find guidance on acquiring resources for the project?

Explanation:

The resource management plan is the component of the project management plan that provides guidance on how project resources should be categorized, allocated, managed, and released. This is the best place to find guidance on how to acquire on the project team.

Details for Each Option:

A Project charter

Incorrect. The project charter documents high-level information on the project including high-level requirements. It does not provide guidance on how to acquire the project team.

B Stakeholder engagement plan

Incorrect. The stakeholder engagement plan identifies the management strategies and actions required to promote the productive involvement of stakeholders in decision making and execution. It does not provide guidance on how to acquire the project team.

C Resource management plan

Correct. The resource management plan contains information on how to acquire human and physical resources. This is the best place to find guidance on how to acquire the project team.

D Procurement management plan

Incorrect. The procurement management plan contains information regarding resources that will be acquired from outside the organization. There is not enough information in the question to determine whether the resources are acquired internally or externally. Therefore, consulting the resource management plan is a better answer choice.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 330

PMP Exam 1

Question 173

Project managers spend most of their time doing what?

A Communicating with team members and other project stakeholders

B Writing manuals for the product developed by the project

C Interacting with the project sponsor to secure funds for the project

D Doing nothing because the project team does most of the work

Answer: A

Hint:

It is about an interaction with people.

Explanation:

According to the reference, "Communication has been identified as one of the single biggest reasons for project success or failure. Effective communication within the project team and between the project manager, team members, and all external stakeholders is essential." This is

the reason for why project managers spend most of their time communicating with team members and other project stakeholders.

Details for Each Option:

A Communicating with team members and other project stakeholders

Correct. According to the PMBOK® Guide, project managers spend most of their time communicating with team members and other project stakeholders.

B Writing manuals for the product developed by the project

Incorrect. Manuals for the product are typically written by the project team members. While a project manager can be part of the writing effort, the project manager does not spend most of their time writing the manuals, but rather communicating with the project team and stakeholders to effectively manage the project.

C Interacting with the project sponsor to secure funds for the project

Incorrect. Funds for the project are secured during the project initiation. The approved project charter is the document that formally authorizes the project and provides the project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources (such as funds) to project activities.

D Doing nothing because the project team does most of the work

Incorrect. While one can argue that there are project managers out there who do nothing for their projects, this answer choice does not represent a responsible project manager.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 61

PMP Exam 1

Question 174

A_stakeholder involved in the project wants to increase the scope of the project. The stakeholder knows that the project management plan authorizes a change control board (CCB) to evaluate all change requests but is unsure of the process for submitting a change request and wants to know who is authorized to make the request.

How should the project manager respond to the stakeholder?

A All change requests must be submitted by the CCB.

B Only the project sponsor can submit change requests.

C The project manager is responsible for submitting change requests to the CCB.

D Any stakeholder involved in the project can submit a change request.

Answer: D

Hint:

Is there a restriction on which interested party can make a request?

Explanation:

A change request should be submitted to change the scope of a project. The change request becomes an input to the Perform Integrated Change Control process. The CCB is responsible for evaluating the request and rendering a decision. However, any stakeholder involved in the project can submit the change request.

Details for Each Option:

A All change requests must be submitted by the CCB.

Incorrect. The CCB is authorized to review and evaluate change requests, but any stakeholder involved in the project can submit a change request.

B Only the project sponsor can submit change requests.

Incorrect. The project sponsor or any stakeholder involved in the project can submit a change request.

C The project manager is responsible for submitting change requests to the CCB.

Incorrect. The project manager or any stakeholder involved in the project can submit a change request.

D Any stakeholder involved in the project can submit a change request.

Correct. Changes may be requested by any stakeholder involved with the project and may occur at any time throughout the project life cycle.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 115

Question 175

You have been requested to provide information on your project's activities and processes to a unit within your company but external to the project. This group of individuals will compare the information to organizational and project policies, processes and procedures and identify good and best practices being used as well as nonconformity, gaps, and shortcomings within project activities and processes.

What tool or technique is being conducted by the external team?

A Audits

B Statistical sampling

C Data analysis

D Problem solving

Answer: A

Hint:

What quality review process involves teams that are independent of the project?

Explanation:

Audits which are defined as structured, independent processes assist project management in determining if project activity and processes comply with the policies and procedures prescribed. During the Manage Quality process, the data and results from the Control Quality process are used to determine the overall quality of the project work. The quality status is made available to the project stakeholders. Audits are one of many tools used to manage quality and increase the probability of meeting quality objectives and identify ineffective processes that cause poor quality.

Details for Each Option:

A Audits

Correct. The question references an external team requiring project activity information. Per the guide, audits are usually conducted by teams independent of the project whose purpose is to determine if project activities comply with set project and organizational standards.

B Statistical sampling

Incorrect. Statistical sampling is a tool or technique used in the Control Quality process and is not the process being conducted by the external team in this scenario.

C Data analysis

Incorrect. The information in the question describes a process to conduct a comparison of activities which is more of an assessment or audit than a type of analysis.

D Problem solving

Incorrect. The question does not indicate that there are issues or challenges that require resolution, which is the primary purpose of problem solving.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 294, 288

PMP Exam 1

Question 176

The project sponsor asks the project manager how they plan to meet customer expectations and ensure the achievement of project objectives.

The project manager replies that it would be best to:

A Identify key deliverables based on the business requirements

B Develop a perfect project management plan

C Maintain quality of the deliverables within six sigma standard deviation

D Make sure each project risk has a response and an owner

Answer: A

Hint:

Look for the answer choice that represents the customer's interest.

Explanation:

Business requirements describe the high-level needs of the organization and the reasons of why a project has been undertaken. According to task 2 of Domain I in the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, in order to manage customer expectations and direct the achievement of project goals, project managers have to identify key deliverables based on the business requirements.

Details for Each Option:

A Identify key deliverables based on the business requirements

Correct. Aligning the project deliverables with the business requirements provided by the customer will lead to customer expectations being met and the project goals being achieved.

B Develop a perfect project management plan

Incorrect. It is hard to assume there is such a thing as a 'perfect' project management plan. Perfect or not, a project management plan alone would not help meet customer expectations and direct the achievement of project goals.

C Maintain quality of the deliverables within six sigma standard deviation

Incorrect. If the key deliverables are not based on the business requirements, no matter how high the quality level is, the project goals would not be achieved.

D Make sure each project risk has a response and an owner

Incorrect. Proper risk management is important to any project but by itself does not ensure that customer expectations are met or that the project achieves the business derived objectives.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 77-79; see also Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, Project Management Institute Inc., June 2015, Domain I, Task 2

PMP Exam 1

Question 177

A_project manager is performing quality assurance for a complex software development project. The project has experienced a trend of increasing escaped defects. To improve the quality of the product, the project manager and the team have created the diagram below.

How is the team attempting to reduce defects and improve quality in this scenario?

People	Processes and Procedures
Uneven workload	Pair programming
Training	Collective code ownership
Hiring standards	Feature driven development
Servant leadership	Retrospectives
Ambiguous roles and responsibilities	Daily scrum
Generalizing specialists	Kanban board
Sustainable pace	Refactoring
Working agreements	WIP limits

Technology	Environment
Build tools	Caves and common
Continuous integration	Osmotic learning
System capacity	Collective team spaces
Virtual tools	Interruptions

A Utilizing an affinity diagram to show areas that should be focused on the most

B Using a matrix diagram to show relationships between the rows and columns

C Developing a scatter diagram to show the relationship between variables

D Creating a histogram to show the number of defects per deliverable

Answer: A

Hint:

Which of the answer choices is a data representation tool that organizes information into groups?

Explanation:

The question states that the project team is performing quality assurance, which indicates that the Manage Quality process is underway. Affinity diagrams are one of the data representation techniques that may be used during the Manage Quality process. The diagram presented by the question is an example of an affinity diagram. Affinity diagrams can organize potential causes of defects into groups showing areas that should be focused on the most. The incorrect answers describe other types of data representation techniques.

Details for Each Option:

A Utilizing an affinity diagram to show areas that should be focused on the most

Correct. The diagram presented by the question displays potential causes of defects organized into groups showing areas that should be focused on the most. Such diagrams are known as affinity diagrams and can be used as part of the quality assurance process described in the scenario.

B Using a matrix diagram to show relationships between the rows and columns

Incorrect. A matrix diagram seeks to show the strength of relationships among factors, causes, and objectives that exist between the rows and columns that form the matrix. However, the diagram presented by the question provides no information on the strength of relationships, making this an incorrect choice.

C Developing a scatter diagram to show the relationship between variables

Incorrect. A scatter diagram is a graph that shows the relationship between two variables. Scatter diagrams can demonstrate a relationship between an element of a process, environment, or activity on one axis and a quality defect on the other axis. The diagram included in the question does not show the relationship between variables; therefore, this answer is incorrect.

D Creating a histogram to show the number of defects per deliverable

Incorrect. Histograms show a graphical representation of numerical data. The diagram presented in the question does not contain any numerical data. Therefore, this answer choice can be eliminated.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 293

PMP Exam 1

Question 178

To define the product that will be produced by the project, the project team is using a product analysis technique that helps with breaking down the high-level requirements into the level of detail needed to design the product.

Which of the following is the product analysis technique used by the team?

A Work breakdown structure

B Product planning

C Progressive elaboration

D Product breakdown

Answer: D

Hint:

This technique is used in the Define Scope process.

Explanation:

Product analysis can be used as a tool to define the scope of a project. It involves methods for translating high-level product or service descriptions into meaningful deliverables. Requirements are captured at a high level and decomposed to the level of detail needed to design the final product and define the scope. Examples of product analysis techniques include product breakdown, requirements analysis, systems analysis, systems engineering, value analysis, and value engineering. In the scenario described, the team breaks down the high-level requirements into the level of detail needed to design the product, which corresponds to the product breakdown technique, making it the best answer among the choices given.

Details for Each Option:

A Work breakdown structure

Incorrect. The work breakdown structure is not an example of product analysis. Instead, it is a tool that shows all the scope of the project broken down into manageable deliverables.

B Product planning

Incorrect. Product planning is where market requirements that define a product's feature set are identified and articulated, but product planning is not specifically about breaking down high-level requirements into lower level details.

C Progressive elaboration

Incorrect. Progressive elaboration is the process of continuously improving and detailing a project plan as more accurate and specific information becomes available. It describes the iterative nature of project management. Progressive elaboration does not represent an example of a product analysis technique.

D Product breakdown

Correct. Product breakdown is an example of the product analysis technique that breaks down the high-level requirements into the level of detail needed to design the product.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 153

PMP Exam 1

Question 179

A_project manager is 11 months into a project that was planned to be completed in two years. From a schedule perspective, half of the work has already been completed.

What is the SPI and project status?

A 1.09 and the project is behind schedule

B 1.09 and the project is ahead of schedule

C 0.92 and the project is behind schedule

D 0.92 and the project is ahead of schedule

Answer: B

Hint:

The SPI can be calculated as ES / AT.

Explanation:

Earned schedule (ES) is an extension of the theory and practice of earned value management (EVM) which is one of the trends and emerging practices in project cost management. Earned schedule theory replaces the schedule performance index measures used in traditional EVM (where the schedule performance index (SPI) was calculated as earned value (EV) divided by planned value (PV)) with earned schedule (ES) and actual time (AT). The equation for calculating the schedule performance index (SPI) using earned schedule is:

SPI = ES / AT

In the scenario provided, the ES is stated as half of the total project schedule of 2 years (24 months) or 12 months. The AT is stated as 11 months. Therefore, the SPI calculation is as follows:

SPI = 12 / 11 = 1.09

Since the SPI is greater than one, the project is ahead of schedule.

Details for Each Option:

A 1.09 and the project is behind schedule

Incorrect. The SPI of 1.09 is correct. However, since the SPI is greater than 1, more work has been completed than was planned. Therefore, the project is ahead of schedule and not behind schedule.

B 1.09 and the project is ahead of schedule

Correct. Schedule performance index (SPI) is calculated as the earned schedule (ES) divided by the actual time (AT) or SPI = ES / AT. The ES is stated as half of the total project of 2 years (24 months) or 12 months. The AT is stated as 11 months. Therefore, the SPI calculation is 12 / 11 for an SPI of 1.09. Since the SPI is greater than 1, the project is ahead of schedule.

C 0.92 and the project is behind schedule

Incorrect. Schedule performance index (SPI) is calculated as the earned schedule (ES) divided by the actual time (AT) or SPI = ES / AT. Using the formula incorrectly by transposing ES and AT would have resulted in 0.92.

D 0.92 and the project is ahead of schedule

Incorrect. Schedule performance index (SPI) is calculated as the earned schedule (ES) divided by the actual time (AT) or SPI = ES / AT. Using the formula incorrectly by transposing ES and AT would have resulted in 0.92. Additionally, an SPI of less than 1 would indicate that the project is behind schedule rather than ahead of schedule.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 233; see also https://www.project-management-prepcast.com/pmp-formulas

PMP Exam 1

Question 180

You are leading a project for a weak matrix organization, which will use internal resources. As you acquire the team members, you realize that the staff being offered to you lack the necessary skills required to perform the project work. Training these individuals will take too long, and the training costs were not included in the project budget.

What is the first thing you should do in this situation?

A Issue a change request

B Use your authority as the project manager to obtain the required resources

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

D Negotiate with the functional managers

Answer: D

Hint:

What will be necessary to obtain the needed resources in a weak matrix organization?

Explanation:

This question is a good example of what you will see on your real exam – two answer choices which could be equally correct. Both submitting a change request and negotiating with the functional managers are plausible first steps you, as project manager, could take in this situation. We have selected negotiation just because we could not mark two choices being correct answers. The main lesson to take from this question is to be ready during the real exam to face ambiguous questions with answer choices extremely close to one another and always select the answer choice you think is the best of those provided. It will not always be the ideal answer or the answer you would like to see as the correct one, but it should be better than the others. Unfortunately, on the real exam, you will never know what the actual correct answer to a particular question was. You will only see your final result and will be unable to contact the PMI

and argue with them on the correctness of their answers. Therefore, the best advice we can provide you while you are preparing for and taking your exam is to make reasonable assumptions based on all available information in the scenario and, of the choices given, select the 'best' answer to the question asked or the answer you believe should be the correct one.

Here are some justifications of why negotiating first, before submitting a change request, could be a better answer choice. With the Acquire Resources process underway, it is crucial that the project manager obtain the necessary resources to meet project objectives. The question states that the performing organization is structured as a weak matrix. In a weak matrix organization, the project manager has limited authority and little control over resources, as the personnel needed for the project team report to a functional manager rather than the project manager. If the resources being offered are inadequate to complete the project successfully, the project manager should negotiate for the appropriate resources. Therefore, negotiating with the respective functional managers is what should be done next in this situation. Only if negotiations fail, you can go ahead and submit a change request to update the resource management plan to reflect the actual resources, and another change request to update the schedule and the cost baselines to account for the necessary training.

Here are some justifications of why submitting a change request, before conducting the negotiation, could be a better answer choice. When competency levels of the actual resources acquired during project execution differ from those planned and specified in the resource management plan, a change request should be submitted to reflect actual experience in acquiring resources for the project. Another change request may be submitted to update the schedule and cost baselines to allocate time and budget for training of resources lacking the needed expertise. During the time the change request(s) is(are) being handled as part of the Perform Integrated Change Control process, you can try negotiating the resources with the functional managers who have the authority over the individuals needed for your project. If the functional managers provide you with the necessary resources, you don't have to implement the change request even if it is approved. If the resources are not available, you will proceed with the implementation of the approved change request. And if both fail, no resources and the change request is rejected, escalating to the project sponsor would be your next logical step.

Details for Each Option:

A Issue a change request

Incorrect. When competency levels of the actual resources acquired during project execution differ from those planned and specified in the resource management plan, a change request should be submitted to reflect actual experience in acquiring resources for the project. Another

change request may be submitted to update the schedule and cost baselines to allocate time and budget for training of resources lacking the needed expertise. Whether or not submitting the change request is the first thing you should do in this situation is arguable. First, you may want to try to negotiate the resources with the functional managers who have the authority over the individuals needed for your project. If negations fail, you can submit change requests.

B Use your authority as the project manager to obtain the required resources

Incorrect. In a weak matrix organizational structure, the project manager has very limited authority. The individuals needed for the project team report to a functional manager rather than the project manager. Therefore, you, as the project manager, do not have direct control over the resources needed for the project, making this choice an incorrect response.

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

Incorrect. The project sponsor is responsible for the project funding and is supposed to support the project manager when issues cannot be handled within the authority of the project manager. In weak matrix organizations, the authority of the project manager over project resources is low. Therefore, escalating the issue to the project sponsor may seem like a plausible option. However, the question is asking, “What is the 'first' thing you should do in this scenario?” Escalating the issue directly to the project sponsor is a premature action. First, you should try negotiating the resources with the functional managers who have the authority over the individuals needed for your project. Only if negotiations fail, escalating the issue to the sponsor is one of the steps you can take. Another option is submitting a change request to update the resource management plan to reflect actual experience in acquiring resources for the project and to update the schedule and cost baselines to account for the necessary training.

D Negotiate with the functional managers

Correct. In a weak matrix organizational structure, the human resources needed for the project are controlled by their functional managers. If the resources being offered are inadequate to successfully complete the project, the project manager should consider negotiating for the appropriate resources with the functional managers. Whether or not negotiating is the first thing you should do over submitting a change request, is arguable.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 47, 329-330

PMP Exam 1

Question 181

According to the project management plan, your team will be virtual. To select the project team members, you are using an analytical approach by ranking and evaluating the candidates on various criteria such as experience, knowledge, cost, and even time zones.

What tool or technique are you using?

A Interpersonal and team skills

B Colocation

C Multicriteria decision analysis

D Pre-assignment

Answer: C

All answer choices represent tools and techniques that can be used during the Acquire Resources process. However, only one uses several criteria to make a decision.

Explanation:

According to the scenario, you are performing the Acquire Resources process. Multicriteria decision analysis is an example of the decision making technique that can be used as part of this process. Selection criteria are often used to select the project team members. Using a multicriteria decision analysis tool, criteria are developed to rate or score potential resources. In the scenario, you are ranking and evaluating the candidates on various criteria such as

experience, knowledge, cost, and even time zones. This description closely matches the definition of the multicriteria decision analysis, making it the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Interpersonal and team skills

Incorrect. Negotiation is an example of the interpersonal and team skills that can be used as part of the Acquire Resources process described in the scenario. Nothing in the question suggests that you are negotiating.

B Colocation

Incorrect. Colocation involves placing many or all of the most active project team members in the same physical location to enhance their ability to perform as a team. The scenario states that according to the project management plan, your team will be virtual.

C Multicriteria decision analysis

Correct. Multicriteria decision analysis is an example of the decision-making techniques that are associated with the Acquire Resources process implied by the question.

D Pre-assignment

Incorrect. The question suggests that you are performing the Acquire Resources process. Pre-assignment can be used as part of this process to determine project resources in advance, while according to the scenario, you are in the process of selecting the project team members from the pool of candidates that have not been pre-assigned.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 332

PMP Exam 1

Question 182

A_pharmaceutical company invested $5,000,000 in a project to develop a new drug to treat hypertension, which was terminated before completion. However, before the project was canceled, testing indicated that a side effect of the drug was the stimulation of hair growth. The pharmaceutical company is now in the initiation stage of a new project to develop the drug as a treatment for hair loss.

How should the $5,000,000 spent on the previous project be treated with respect to the benefits analysis of the new project?

A Investment costs that must be included as a cost to the new project

B Sunk costs that should not influence future decisions

C Opportunity costs that should be considered before approving the new project

D Included in the payback period for the new project

Answer: B

Hint:

What are costs that have already been incurred and cannot be recovered called?

Explanation:

When a project is terminated prematurely, there is a chance that some useful business value will already have been generated, such as in the scenario described where a side effect of the drug was the stimulation of hair growth. This situation allows the premature closure to be less of a failure due to sunk costs. However, sunk costs are the costs that have already been incurred and cannot be recovered. The $5,000,000 represents sunk costs which are not relevant to the new project and should not influence the decision of whether or not to proceed with the new project. For example, if a real estate investor buys a home and invests $300,000 in the home and renovations, but the market value of the renovated house is only $250,000. The fact that the real

estate investor spent $300,000 (sunk costs) does not influence the amount for which the renovated home can be sold.

While the topic of this question is not included in the PMBOK® Guide, the Project Management Professional (PMP)® Examination Content Outline, June 2015, covers knowledge and skills, such as project selection, with which PMP aspirants are expected to be familiar. Project finance principles are among these knowledge and skills.

Details for Each Option:

A Investment costs that must be included as a cost to the new project

Incorrect. The costs of the failed project are sunk costs which are not recoverable. Any revenues from the new project cannot be applied to the previous project, nor any costs from the previous project should be included as a cost to the new project. The new project must be evaluated independently of the previous project.

B Sunk costs that should not influence future decisions

Correct. Sunk costs are the costs that have already been incurred and cannot be recovered. The $5,000,000 represents sunk costs which are not relevant to the new project and should not influence the decision of whether or not to proceed with the project.

C Opportunity costs that should be considered before approving the new project

Incorrect. Opportunity cost is the value of the best alternative given up when a choice is made, in which the choices must be mutually exclusive owing to limited resources. The original project was terminated, and there is no information presented by the question to suggest that another project is being considered.

D Included in the payback period for the new project

Incorrect. The investment costs associated with the previous project are written off as a loss and remain with the terminated project. The losses are not transferable to the new project and should not be included in any benefits analysis including the payback period.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 34-35, 671; see also https://www.pmi.org/learning/library/business-project-sunk-cost-dilemma-2676

PMP Exam 1

Question 183

A_project to build a prototype brake assembly is underway. Two team members disagree on the testing and assembly sequence. One wants to test each part before final assembly, while the other wants to wait to test the final assembly as a whole. With facilitation, they agree to perform some quick tests on the parts before assembly into the prototype. They also agree not to repeat the same tests on the final assembled prototype.

What was the conflict management technique used in this scenario?

A Smooth/accommodate

B Force/direct

C Compromise/reconcile

D Withdraw/avoid

Answer: C

Hint:

Which approach occasionally results in a lose-lose situation?

Explanation:

The question best describes the compromise/reconcile conflict resolution technique. There was some give and take on both sides to resolve the conflict, with some tests performed before assembly and some tests performed post-assembly. Both parties gave up something and received partial satisfaction relative to their initial position. The compromise/reconcile approach is the best description of the scenario presented by the question.

Details for Each Option:

A Smooth/accommodate

Incorrect. The smooth/accommodate approach emphasizes areas of agreement rather than areas of difference, conceding one's position to the needs of the others to maintain harmony and relationships. However, the question indicates that both parties only partially conceded their positions.

B Force/direct

Incorrect. The force/direct approach involves pushing one's viewpoint at the expense of others, offering only a win-lose situation. Whereas, the question suggests that each of the parties gained a partial victory. Therefore, this is not the best answer choice.

C Compromise/reconcile

Correct. The compromise/reconcile approach is exemplified by searching for solutions that bring some degree of satisfaction to all parties in order to temporarily or partially resolve the conflict. Of the available choices, the compromise/reconcile approach is best described by the question.

D Withdraw/avoid

Incorrect. The withdraw/avoid approach involves retreating from an actual or potential conflict situation, but the premise of the question indicates that the project manager did intervene to resolve the conflict. Therefore, this answer choice can be eliminated.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 349

PMP Exam 1

Question 184

As part of project planning, a team member is using the resource breakdown structure and RACI chart.

What process would benefit the most from these techniques?

A Control Costs

B Plan Resource Management

C Identify Stakeholders

D Manage Project Knowledge

Answer: B

Hint:

RACI stands for responsible, accountable, consult, and inform. It is a type of assignment matrix.

Explanation:

Both the resource breakdown structure and RACI (responsible, accountable, consult, and inform) chart are used in the Plan Resource Management process as techniques to represent data. The resource breakdown structure is a hierarchical chart showing team and physical resources related by category and resource type. It breaks down required resources into small enough detail as to be used in conjunction with the work breakdown structure (WBS) for further planning. The

RACI chart is useful for ensuring team members' roles and responsibilities are clear, especially when the team consists of internal and external resources.

Details for Each Option:

A Control Costs

Incorrect. Control Costs is the process of monitoring the status of the project to update the project costs and managing changes to the cost baseline. This process belongs to the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group. Neither the resource breakdown structure nor the RACI chart is used in the Control Costs process.

B Plan Resource Management

Correct. Both the resource breakdown structure and the RACI chart are examples of the data representation group of tools and techniques that can be used as part of the Plan Resource Management process.

C Identify Stakeholders

Incorrect. Identify Stakeholders is the process of identifying project stakeholders and analyzing and documenting information regarding their interests, involvement, interdependencies, influence, and potential impact on project success. According to the scenario, you are in project planning. Although the Identify Stakeholders process can take place at any point during the project, this process is typically performed as part of project initiation. Additionally, neither the resource breakdown structure nor the RACI chart is used in the Identify Stakeholders process.

D Manage Project Knowledge

Incorrect. Manage Project Knowledge is the process of using existing knowledge and creating new knowledge to achieve the project's objectives and contribute to organizational learning. This process is part of the Executing Process Group while the techniques described in the scenario are typically used during project planning.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 316-317

PMP Exam 1

Question 185

While checking the resource calendars, you see that the company's 3D printer is reserved for another project manager during the same time that you need the printer to create a prototype for your project. You speak with the other project manager and offer to provide him with a member of your project team to complete his project sooner. This solution will free up the printer in time for you to keep your project on schedule. You both see this solution as a win-win.

What tool or technique are you using to gain timely access to the printer?

A Control Resources

B Prototype

C Soft skills

D Win-win technique

Answer: C

What tool or technique used during the Control Resources process would be helpful in gaining timely access to a resource?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the project management process of Control Resources is being performed. Interpersonal and team skills, also known as "soft skills", is one of the tools and

techniques associated with the Control Resources process. The interpersonal and team skill of negotiation is what is being used in this case to gain timely access to a critical resource.

Details for Each Option:

A Control Resources

Incorrect. The question does describe the process of Control Resources. However, Control Resources is a process and not a tool or technique.

B Prototype

Incorrect. A prototype is what being built by the project, but the prototype is not useful in gaining access to a resource.

C Soft skills

Correct. Interpersonal and team skills, sometimes known as “soft skills”, include negotiation and influencing, and can be used by project managers to control resources on their projects. In this scenario, you used negotiation to gain timely access to the 3D printer which was a critical resource for your project.

D Win-win technique

Incorrect. 'Win-win technique' is a fake term made up for this question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 357

PMP Exam 1

Question 186

You have been recruited by a well-respected vice president (VP) in your company to be the project manager of an important company initiative. The VP wrote the business case, worked with you on the project charter, and has attended every meeting to date. You are currently creating the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix.

What current engagement level would you assign the VP?

A Supportive - because the VP is aware of the project's potential impacts and supportive of the work and its outcomes.

B Leading - because the VP is aware of the project's potential impacts and actively engaged in project success.

C Authority - because the VP is an executive overseeing the project.

D Neutral - because the VP is a vice president and can be neither supportive nor unsupportive.

Answer: B

Hint:

What engagement level is the stakeholder most involved?

Explanation:

You can rule out 'neutral' because the VP is too involved with the project to be indifferent. You can also rule out 'authority' because it is not an engagement level specified in the PMBOK® Guide. 'Supportive' would be a good choice, but 'leading' is a better answer because the 'leading' engagement level means the stakeholder is not only aware of the project and its potential impact but is also actively engaged with the project ensuring that the project is a success.

Details for Each Option:

A Supportive - because the VP is aware of the project's potential impacts and supportive of the work and its outcomes.

Incorrect. Although the VP is technically 'supportive' as he is aware of the project and its potential impacts and supportive of the work and its outcomes, 'leading' would be a better answer choice because he is actively engaged in ensuring the project's success.

B Leading - because the VP is aware of the project's potential impacts and actively engaged in project success.

Correct. 'Leading' is defined as being aware of the project and potential impacts and actively engaged in ensuring that the project is a success, which the VP is. Therefore, of the choices provided, 'leading' is the best answer to the question asked.

C Authority - because the VP is an executive overseeing the project.

Incorrect. 'Authority' is not an engagement level specified in the PMBOK® Guide.

D Neutral - because the VP is a vice president and can be neither supportive nor unsupportive.

Incorrect. The VP is not indifferent and being vice president does not exclude him from being evaluated in the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix. He has a vested interest in the project making 'neutral' an incorrect answer.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 521

Question 187

You have been informed that one of the critical path's activities must finish no later than September 1st. As a result of this imposed date, the activity's float became negative, and the project schedule is no longer feasible.

Which of the following is the best solution?

A Leveling resources

B Crashing the schedule

C Consulting the issue log

D Terminating the project

Answer: B

Hint:

You need to compress the schedule.

Explanation:

During planning, the critical path is characterized by zero total float. During project execution, if duration and relationship logic violate a constraint on the late date on a schedule network diagram, it results in negative float, which means the schedule is not feasible. The scenario describes an imposed date. An imposed date is a fixed date imposed on a schedule activity or schedule milestone, usually in the form of a “start no earlier than” and “finish no later than” date. Such a schedule constraint may cause the activity float to become negative, which is what happened in the scenario. Therefore, you should look for an option that would realign the schedule with the baseline. Of the choices provided, only crashing would allow shortening the duration of the project schedule, thus providing the best chance to complete the project on time.

Details for Each Option:

A Leveling resources

Incorrect. Resource leveling is a resource optimization technique in which start and finish dates are adjusted based on resource constraints with the goal of balancing the demand for resources with the available supply. The available float is used for leveling resources properly. According to the scenario, the float is already negative. Therefore, leveling resources will only worsen the situation.

B Crashing the schedule

Correct. Crashing is a schedule compression technique that is used to shorten the schedule duration for the least incremental cost by adding resources. Therefore, by crashing, i.e., shortening the project's duration to comply with the imposed date, the project has a better chance to be completed on time.

C Consulting the issue log

Incorrect. The issue log is a project document where information about the issues encountered during the project is recorded and monitored. The issue with the imposed date has just been encountered. Therefore, the issue log would not have the issue captured. Even if the issue were documented, consulting the issue log would not help you resolve the situation described.

D Terminating the project

Incorrect. When a project schedule becomes no longer feasible, project termination may be considered. However, terminating the project without attempting to resolve the issue is unlikely to be the best course of action. Options to salvage the project, such as crashing the schedule, should be considered before the decision to terminate the project is made.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 215

PMP Exam 1

Question 188

You are managing a virtual project team across multiple time zones. As the project progresses, the team members learn to trust one another and adjust their work routines to accommodate the different time zones, work habits, and culture.

What stage of team development is being demonstrated in this situation?

A Forming

B Storming

C Performing

D Norming

Answer: D

Hint:

What stage of team development is characterized by team members learning to trust each other?

Explanation:

The question describes the Tuckman ladder of team development, which includes forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning as the stages of development. The norming stage of team development is characterized by team members adjusting their work habits and behaviors to support the team, and they learn to trust each other. The question states that the team is adjusting their work habits by making accommodations for team members in different time zones, and they are learning to trust each other. Of the available options, the norming stage is aligned the best with the description provided by the question.

Details for Each Option:

A Forming

Incorrect. The forming stage of team development is where team members meet and learn about the project and their formal roles and responsibilities. The question describes a team that is already working together and therefore has moved past the forming stage.

B Storming

Incorrect. During the storming phase of team development, the team begins to address the project work, technical decisions, and the project management approach. Of the available choices, this is not the best description of the development stage outlined in the question.

C Performing

Incorrect. Teams that reach the performing stage of team development function as a well-organized unit and work through issues smoothly and effectively. There is not enough information in the question to conclude that the team is already well-organized and works through issues smoothly and effectively. Another answer choice, norming, more accurately describes the current stage of the team.

D Norming

Correct. The norming stage of team development is characterized by team members adjusting their work habits and behaviors to support the team, and they learn to trust each other.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 338

Question 189

During the development of the project management plan and before establishing baselines, the project manager is asked by a key stakeholder to add a critical feature that will slightly extend the project schedule and cost.

What should the project manager do?

A Ask the stakeholder to submit a change request to change control board

B Submit a change request on behalf of the stakeholder and ask them to sign it

C Reject the stakeholder's request

D Update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder

Answer: D

Hint:

The project is in its planning and the baselines have not been established.

Explanation:

The project management plan is baselined and approved before the project enters its execution. Baselines (scope, cost, schedule) are part of the project management plan. As long as the baselines are not established, as in this situation, the project management plan can be modified as many times as necessary. No change request is needed in this situation. Therefore, among the choices provided, updating the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder is the best answer to the question asked.

Details for Each Option:

A Ask the stakeholder to submit a change request to change control board

Incorrect. The project management plan is being developed, and the baselines (scope, cost, schedule) have not been finalized nor has the project management plan been approved. Before baselining and the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan.

B Submit a change request on behalf of the stakeholder and ask them to sign it

Incorrect. The project management plan is being developed, and the baselines (scope, cost, schedule) have not been finalized nor has the project management plan been approved. Before baselining and the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan.

C Reject the stakeholder's request

Incorrect. While it is the project managers job to monitor and control changes in project scope, there is no indication where in the planning process the project is and more importantly before the baselining and the approval of the project management plan, requests of this type are typical and should be expected.

D Update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder

Correct. The scenario describes a project in planning where neither the project management plan nor the baselines (which are the components of the plan) have been approved. Before the approval of the project management plan, no change request is required to change the plan as many times as needed. Therefore, the project manager can update the project management plan as requested by the stakeholder.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 83

Question 190

A_project manager has compiled a list of key deliverables, which include the working software, employee training materials, user manuals, etc.

When is the first time that these key deliverables would have been identified?

A During the Define Scope process

B When processes of the Executing Process Group are performed

C During the Develop Project Charter process

D When processes of the Planning Process Group are performed

Answer: C

Hint:

Key deliverables are identified very early in the project life cycle.

Explanation:

The key deliverables are identified during the Develop Project Charter process as part of the pre-project work. The identified key deliverables are then included in the project charter as one of its elements. Of the available choices, the Develop Project Charter process occurs earliest in the project life cycle, and it is when key deliverables are first identified.

Details for Each Option:

A During the Define Scope process

Incorrect. The Define Scope process results in the project scope statement which lists major project deliverables. Major project deliverables are derived from the key deliverables. However, the key deliverables are identified earlier in the project life cycle, during project initiation, and are listed in the project charter which is an input to the Define Scope process.

B When processes of the Executing Process Group are performed

Incorrect. Deliverables are produced during the Executing Process Group. Deliverables must be identified before they can be produced. Therefore, this answer choice can be eliminated.

C During the Develop Project Charter process

Correct. The key deliverables are identified during the Develop Project Charter process and included as an element in the project charter. Of the available choices, the Develop Project Charter process is when key deliverables are first identified.

D When processes of the Planning Process Group are performed

Incorrect. The key deliverables are listed in the project charter. The Develop Project Charter process is part of the Initiating Process Group which is completed before the Planning Process Group begins.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 80-81, 154

PMP Exam 1

Question 191

You are a project manager who is currently performing the process of identifying quality requirements for the project. As you work with your project team to develop the quality management plan, the newest team member asks you to explain the benefit of performing this process.

How should you respond to the team member?

A Provides guidance and direction on how quality will be managed and verified throughout the project

B Ensures that the degree, type, and visibility of risk management are proportionate to both risks and the importance of the project to the organization and other stakeholders

C Verifies that the project deliverables and work meet the requirements specified by key stakeholders for final acceptance

D Increases the probability of meeting the quality objectives as well as identifying ineffective processes and causes of poor quality

Answer: A

All the answer choices represent benefits of project management processes, but only one is associated with the Plan Quality Management process.

Explanation:

The question implies that the Plan Quality Management process is currently underway. The key benefit of the Plan Quality Management process is that it provides guidance and direction on how quality will be managed and verified throughout the project. All of the other answer choices represent the key benefits of other project management processes.

Details for Each Option:

A Provides guidance and direction on how quality will be managed and verified throughout the project

Correct. This answer choice describes the key benefit of the Plan Quality Management process, which is the process you are performing in the scenario, making this choice the best answer to the question asked.

B Ensures that the degree, type, and visibility of risk management are proportionate to both risks and the importance of the project to the organization and other stakeholders

Incorrect. This answer choice describes the benefit of the Plan Risk Management process which is not the process implied by the scenario, making this choice an incorrect answer.

C Verifies that the project deliverables and work meet the requirements specified by key stakeholders for final acceptance

Incorrect. This answer choice reflects the benefit of the Control Quality process. The Control Quality process is performed as part of the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group, while the question describes activities of a project in planning.

D Increases the probability of meeting the quality objectives as well as identifying ineffective processes and causes of poor quality

Incorrect. This answer choice represents the benefits of the Manage Quality process. The Manage Quality process is performed during project execution, while the question describes activities of a project in planning.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 277

PMP Exam 1

Question 192

Your project to build a sports arena near a coastal city is well underway to being completed ahead of schedule this year. Suddenly, a long-dormant volcano erupts nearby, destroying your arena site. The ashfall and the potential for coastal winds to remobilize ash render your site and

all on-site assets unusable for two years, exceeding your risk threshold and all contingency and management reserves.

What overall project risk strategy should you use?

A Exploit: Embrace the opportunity to keep your employees on payroll and help the city recover.

B Mitigate: For every seismic warning that an earthquake is imminent, physically cover the site.

C Avoid: Since you cannot remove the threats, recommend the termination of the project.

D Increase: Request the increase of the management reserves allocated for the project.

Answer: C

Hint:

Consider the limits of your risk thresholds.

Explanation:

This scenario indicates you are in the Implement Risk Responses process of the Executing process group. When it comes to overall project risk, you have a set of five strategies to consider: avoid, exploit, transfer/share, mitigate/enhance, and accept. In such a disaster where the level of overall project risk is significantly negative and outside the agreed-upon risk thresholds for the project, an avoid strategy may be adopted. Ideally, this involves taking focused action to reduce the negative effect of uncertainty on the project as a whole and bring the project back within the thresholds. An example of avoidance at the overall project level would include removal of high-risk elements of scope from the project. However, where it is not possible to bring the project back within the thresholds, the project may be canceled. This represents the most extreme degree of risk avoidance, and it should be used only if the overall level of threat is, and will remain, unacceptable.

Details for Each Option:

A Exploit: Embrace the opportunity to keep your employees on payroll and help the city recover.

Incorrect. Helping the city recover is a completely different endeavor from building a sports arena and requires its own project charter. Furthermore, the "exploit" strategy is recommended only if the level of overall project risk is significantly positive, which is not the case after a volcanic disaster.

B Mitigate: For every seismic warning that an earthquake is imminent, physically cover the site.

Incorrect. Covering the site at each warning is unlikely to be effective or efficient in reducing the risk from a long-dormant volcano. Certainly, early preventive action to reduce the impact of a threat is often more effective than trying to repair the damage after the threat has occurred. However, at this point in the scenario described, the volcano has already erupted, making it too late for this risk response.

C Avoid: Since you cannot remove the threats, recommend the termination of the project.

Correct. According to the scenario, the disaster exceeds the risk thresholds and all contingency and management reserves. Therefore, it is not possible for any of your risk responses to bring the project back within the risk thresholds identified in the risk management plan. The overall level of the threat is unacceptable and will remain so for two years warranting the termination of the project.

D Increase: Request the increase of the management reserves allocated for the project.

Incorrect. 'Increase' is a made-up term and not a risk response strategy.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 444-446; see also https://www.iii.org/article/volcanic-eruption-coverage

Question 193

You are a project manager working with a new team on a project using Scrum best practices. You know that the team members have little experience in Scrum and will need some training.

Where would you document training needs and strategies required for your team members for this project?

A Team management plan

B Project management plan

C Physical resource management plan

D Team charter

Answer: A

Hint:

This question is tricky and has more than one correct answer, but which one is the best answer?

Explanation:

This question implies that you are involved with the Plan Resource Management process, and the primary output of this process is the resource management plan. The team management plan is a component of the resource management plan and is updated continually during the project to direct ongoing team member acquisition and development actions. Information in the team management plan includes the skills and competencies required, as well as the training needs of the project team. If it is expected that the team members assigned to the project will not have the requested competencies, a detailed training plan can be developed. This training plan can also include ways to help project team members obtain certifications that would benefit the project.

We often receive feedback from our customers arguing that 'team management plan' is not a term specified in the PMBOK® Guide. If you take a look at the pages listed in the reference provided, you will see the following:

- Page 318, "It [the resource management plan] may be divided between the team management plan and physical resource management plan according to the specifics of the project."

- Page 724, "Team Management Plan. A component of the resource management plan that describes when and how team members will be acquired and how long they will be needed."

Details for Each Option:

A Team management plan

Correct. The resource management plan may be divided between the team management plan and the physical resource management plan. The team management plan contains individual skills and capacities required to complete assigned activities, as well as training strategies for team members.

B Project management plan

Incorrect. The project management plan contains many different plans, including the resource management plan and its component, the team management plan. However, this is not the best answer, as it is not the most specific plan that that contains the team's training needs.

C Physical resource management plan

Incorrect. The physical resource management plan is a component of the resource management plan, but it is limited to information concerning physical resources. Some examples of physical assets might include test equipment, multifunction printers, and prototype production gear.

D Team charter

Incorrect. The team charter is a document that details team values, communications guidelines, decision-making criteria, meeting guidelines and other information for use by the team. In many cases, the team charter is developed by the team. However, it does not contain specific training needs.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 318-319, 724

PMP Exam 1

Question 194

To assess the effectiveness of communications activities on your project, you review a matrix, which compares current and desired stakeholder engagement levels.

What tool or technique are you using?

A Stakeholder register

B Inspection

C Data representation

D Expert judgment

Answer: C

Hint:

A stakeholder engagement assessment matrix is an example of what type of tool or technique?

Explanation:

The scenario suggests that the Monitor Communications process is underway. A data representation technique that can be used during the Monitor Communications process is the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix, which is a matrix that compares current and desired stakeholder engagement levels. This matrix can provide information about the effectiveness of the communications activities by reviewing the changes between the desired and current engagement levels and adjusting communications as necessary. Data representation is the best answer to the question asked for two reasons: first, the project manager used the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix (an example of data representation) to assess the effectiveness of communications on the project, and, second, of the available choices, only data representation is a tool or technique used in the Monitor Communications process.

Details for Each Option:

A Stakeholder register

Incorrect. The stakeholder register records the identification, assessment, and classification of project stakeholders. This document may provide some information about the stakeholder engagement levels. However, first, the stakeholder register does not indicate the current and/or the desired level of engagement; and, second, the stakeholder register is a project document, not a tool or technique.

B Inspection

Incorrect. Inspection is a technique to examine a work product to determine whether it conforms to documented standards. In the scenario, you are not examining a work product. Rather, you are reviewing a matrix which compares current and desired stakeholder engagement levels.

C Data representation

Correct. You are reviewing a matrix that compares current and desired stakeholder engagement levels. This matrix is known as the stakeholder engagement assessment matrix and is an example of the data representation technique that can be used during the Monitor Communications process to assess the effectiveness of communications on a project.

D Expert judgment

Incorrect. Expert judgment, as it pertains to the Monitor Communications process implied by the scenario, is concerned with seeking advice from individuals or groups with specialized knowledge in communications. In the scenario, you are performing the work yourself rather than involving experts, unless you are the expert, but this cannot be determined from the question.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 392

PMP Exam 1

Question 195

An unusually harsh winter has caused a project to fall behind schedule, and action must be taken to get the schedule back on track. The agreed-upon risk response for this situation is to compress the schedule by approving overtime pay. The project manager recalls a similar situation from a previous project and wants to understand the effectiveness of that particular response plan.

What should the project manager do to obtain this information?

A Check the lessons learned register

B Consult the risk management plan

C Gather information from the team members who worked on the previous project

D Research the lessons learned repository

Answer: D

Hint:

What organizational process asset contains knowledge gained from past projects?

Explanation:

The question suggests that the project team is performing the project management process of Implement Risk Responses. Organizational process assets including the lessons learned repository serve as an input to the Implement Risk Responses process. The lessons learned repository contains historical information about knowledge gained from past projects which can be used to indicate the effectiveness of particular risk responses.

Details for Each Option:

A Check the lessons learned register

Incorrect. The lessons learned register has lessons learned earlier in the current project but does not have information concerning the effectiveness of a risk response from a past project.

B Consult the risk management plan

Incorrect. The risk management plan describes how risk management activities will be structured and performed. Risk management plans do not contain information regarding the effectiveness of risk response plans.

C Gather information from the team members who worked on the previous project

Incorrect. While the team members from the previous project may have knowledge that can be helpful for the project manager, there is not enough information in the question to determine whether or not these team members are available. Even if they are available, it is not clear if they possess the knowledge or will agree to share it. With so many assumptions, this choice is unlikely to be the best answer to the question asked.

D Research the lessons learned repository

Correct. The lessons learned repository is an organizational process asset that contains historical information about lessons learned from past projects which can be used to indicate the effectiveness of particular risk responses.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 450

PMP Exam 1

Question 196

A_change request to repair or replace a defective component as necessary has been submitted and approved. The cost difference between repairing and replacing the component is negligible. The project manager asks the seven-member team how to proceed, but the team members, after a lengthy discussion, are not able to reach an agreement.

What is the best course of action for the project manager?

A Allow the discussions to continue

B Facilitate a formal meeting with the project team members

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

D Have the project team members vote to reach a decision

Answer: D

What tool or technique associated with the Direct and Manage Project Work process would be most useful in this scenario?

Explanation:

Approved change requests are implemented through the Direct and Manage Project Work process. While voting, as a decision-making technique, is not specified among the tools and techniques of the Direct and Manage Project Work process, prospective PMP aspirants have to remember that the PMBOK® Guide does not prescribe or limit usage of specific tools or techniques while carrying out specific processes. Voting is an effective decision-making technique that can be used in the Direct and Manage Project Work process to make decisions that will help gain the commitment of the team members such as in the situation described in the question. Since the discussion has reached an impasse, the project manager should guide the team to decide on the best way to implement the approved change request. The project team members possess the technical knowledge but are unable to agree, therefore, the best course of action for the project manager in this scenario is to facilitate a group decision by voting. Of the available choices, using voting as a decision-making technique is the best way for the project

manager to break the impasse so that the approved change request can be implemented without further delay to the project.

It is reasonable to ask what happens if the result of the vote is a tie? If you read the question carefully, you will notice that there are seven members on the team. While a tie is possible if an odd number of the team members abstain, the way the question is designed to specifically indicate the number of the members on the team should hint that a tie is not considered an option.

Details for Each Option:

A Allow the discussions to continue

Incorrect. The question describes a situation where project team members are at an impasse on how to implement the approved change request after a lengthy discussion. With tempers beginning to flare, it is appropriate for the project manager to step in and facilitate a resolution before relationships are damaged. Allowing the discussions to continue at this point would be counterproductive.

B Facilitate a formal meeting with the project team members

Incorrect. The question states that the project team members have had a lengthy discussion about the best way to implement the approved change request. Regardless of the informality, this scenario describes a meeting which has reached an impasse. Since a meeting has not been an effective tool in determining the best course of action, the project manager should take another approach.

C Escalate the issue to the project sponsor

Incorrect. The situation described in the scenario does not seem to be severe enough to trigger escalation to the project sponsor. Project managers should have the authority as well as possess the necessary interpersonal and team skills to resolve situations like the one provided.

D Have the project team members vote to reach a decision

Correct. Voting can be used as an effective decision-making technique. Since discussions have reached an impasse, the project manager should guide the team to decide on the best way to implement the approved change request.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 111, 93

PMP Exam 1

Question 197

You are leading a software development project, which is utilizing an agile framework. While monitoring the progress of the project, it is apparent that velocity is trending down, and you are aware of some setbacks that have been encountered by the development team. You want to capture and analyze lessons learned so far during the project to improve the process going forward.

What is the best way to achieve this goal?

A Perform a sprint review

B Schedule a sprint planning meeting

C Conduct an iteration retrospective

D Lessons learned are not utilized on agile projects

Answer: C

During which agile ceremony does the project team discuss what went well and what improvements can be made?

Explanation:

The question is being asked from an agile perspective. Iteration (or sprint) planning, reviews, and retrospectives are all ceremonies which are associated with an agile framework. The iteration retrospective is a specialized meeting that is held by the project team at the end of an iteration. The purpose of the meeting is to discuss what went well during the iteration as well as what improvements can be made for future iterations. Of the available choices, the iteration retrospective is the best way to capture and analyze lessons learned during the project.

Details for Each Option:

A Perform a sprint review

Incorrect. An iteration (or sprint) review is a meeting where the project team demonstrates the product increment that has been built during the iteration in order to get feedback from stakeholders and gain the approval of the product owner. The iteration review is not a meeting that is focused on process improvement.

B Schedule a sprint planning meeting

Incorrect. A sprint planning meeting is a meeting where the project team determines what will be accomplished during the upcoming sprint (iteration) and how the results will be achieved. Process improvement is not a subject of the sprint planning meeting.

C Conduct an iteration retrospective

Correct. An iteration retrospective is a specialized meeting that is held by the project team at the end of an iteration. The purpose of the meeting is to discuss what went well during the iteration as well as what improvements can be made for future iterations. In other words, based on the lessons learned so far in the project, the team tries to improve the process going forward which is what was asked by the question, making this choice the best answer of those provided.

D Lessons learned are not utilized on agile projects

Incorrect. Lessons learned or knowledge gained should be used for continuous improvement on all projects regardless of the framework that is being employed. Without the benefit of learning from past experience, an organization will likely experience the same problems on a recurring basis.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 224; see also https://www.projectmanagement.com/articles/379408/10-Tips-for-Effective-Agile-Retrospectives

PMP Exam 1

Question 198

You are leading a project with some of the deliverables being developed using Scrum while others produced using traditional methods. The project sponsor is replaced midway into project execution. As part of your efforts to bring the new sponsor up to speed, you tell them that the deliverables are produced in a hybrid way. The sponsor requests a confirmation.

What is the best course of action for you to address the sponsor's request?

A Show the project life cycle description to the project sponsor

B Tell the sponsor to talk to the project team so that they can explain how the product is developed

C Suggest reviewing the project charter together with the sponsor

D Show to the sponsor the development approach specified in the project management plan

Answer: D

What document contains the information about the implementation approach taken to produce the project deliverables?

Explanation:

The development approach is one of the components of the project management plan. The development approach describes the development approach taken to produce the product, the service, or the result of the project. Examples of development approaches include predictive, iterative, agile, or hybrid. In the scenario described, some of the deliverables are developed using Scrum (which is an example of agile) while others produced using traditional methods. This implies the project, as a whole, is executed using a hybrid project management approach. Therefore, the project management plan should reflect this information as the development approach selected for the project. For example, during the development of the project management plan, it is possible that the project team determined that there were going to be many changes to some of the project deliverables due to their nature (e.g., a software application) and, therefore, a Scrum framework would be best do develop those deliverables. Going with this example, requirements for other deliverables, on the other hand, were determined upfront favoring the traditional project management approach. Therefore, of the choices provided, showing the development approach within the project management plan to the project sponsor would be the best course of action for the project manager to take to address the sponsor's request.

Details for Each Option:

A Show the project life cycle description to the project sponsor

Incorrect. The project life cycle description provides the series of phases that the project passes through from its initiation to its closure. The project life cycle description does not contain information about the development approach used to produce the project deliverables.

B Tell the sponsor to talk to the project team so that they can explain how the product is developed

Incorrect. Although the project team members are likely to know about the approach they are using to develop the product, sending the sponsor to the team will possibly interrupt the team's work. It's the project manager’s responsibility to communicate with the sponsor and other stakeholders and let the team do their work with as few interruptions as possible.

C Suggest reviewing the project charter together with the sponsor

Incorrect. The project charter is the document that authorizes the existence of a project, names the project manager and provides them with the authority to apply organizational resources to project activities. The project charter is unlikely to have the information about the development approach to be used on the project.

D Show to the sponsor the development approach specified in the project management plan

Correct. The project management plan specifies the development approach (such as predictive, iterative, agile, hybrid) that will be used to produce the product, the service, or the result of the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 88

PMP Exam 1

Question 199

The project work has been completed. You are looking for information about project approval requirements so that you can close the project and move on to your next assignment.

Where would you find this information?

A Project management plan

B Project scope statement

C Quality management plan

D Project charter

Answer: D

Hint:

What input to the Close Project or Phase process will provide you with approval requirements?

Explanation:

The scenario surrounds the Close Project or Phase process. The project charter is one of the inputs to this process and specifies the project success criteria, the approval requirements, and who will sign off on the project, making project charter the best answer to the question asked. While the other answer choices are also among the inputs to the Close Project or Phase process, none of them specify project approval requirements.

Details for Each Option:

A Project management plan

Incorrect. The project management plan is the guiding document used to manage, control and close the project. It does not contain approval requirements.

B Project scope statement

Incorrect. The project scope statement is a written description of the results the project will produce and the constraints and assumptions under which you will be working. It does not contain approval requirements.

C Quality management plan

Incorrect. The quality management plan identifies the quality standards needed for both the project and the product. It does not contain approval requirements.

D Project charter

Correct. The project charter is the document that authorizes the existence of a project and provides the project manager with the authority to use organizational resources on the project. In addition, the project charter contains high-level information such as the project success criteria, the approval requirements, and who will sign off on the project.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 124

PMP Exam 1

Question 200

You are using work performance data generated during execution to determine if new individual project risks have occurred and if your risk management approach is still appropriate. You have also reviewed the contingency reserves to see if they require any modification. As part of your documentation of this process, you have added an issue you discovered to the issue log to ensure it is investigated and resolved.

What else might require an update as part of this process?

A Project schedule

B Cost forecasts

C Enterprise environmental factors

D Organizational process assets

Answer: D

Hint:

What are the policies, procedures, templates, etc., specific to a performing organization called?

Explanation:

In the described scenario, you are using work performance data to determine if new risks have occurred, if your risk management approach is still appropriate, and to review your contingency reserves. All of these functions are part of the Monitor Risks process. You have updated the issue log, which is one of the outputs of the Monitor Risks process. The question is asking which of the other answer choices would also be an output of the Monitor Risks process. Of the choices provided, organizational process assets is the correct answer.

Details for Each Option:

A Project schedule

Incorrect. The project schedule shows linked activities with planned dates, durations, milestones, and resources. As an output of the Plan Risk Responses, the project schedule may be updated with activities relating to agreed-upon risk responses. However, in the scenario described, you are in the Monitor Risks process which does not affect the project schedule.

B Cost forecasts

Incorrect. Cost forecasts are revised budget estimates that may be calculated during the Control Costs process. During risk response planning, the cost forecasts may be updated as a result of the planned risk responses. As described in this scenario, you are monitoring risks for the effectiveness of the risk process, and this would not have any impact on costs.

C Enterprise environmental factors

Incorrect. Enterprise environmental factors are conditions over which a project manager has no control. Enterprise environmental factors are typically updated when they are outputs from processes that deal with human resources, personnel files, performance reviews and so forth.

You are in the Monitor Risks process; therefore, an update to the enterprise environmental factors is not an output.

D Organizational process assets

Correct. Organizational process assets are procedures, knowledge bases, templates, etc., that are specific to and used by the project's performing organization. In this scenario, you are in the Monitor Risks process. An output of this process may be updated templates for the risk register, risk report, and risk management plan, as well as the risk breakdown structure, all of which are organizational process assets.

Reference:

A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition, Project Management Institute Inc., 2017, Page(s) 457-458